

Empiricism — Offline Revision Guide

Philosophy Optional | Paper I | Western Philosophy | Topic 03

Complete retrieval-and-repair guide for Philosophy Optional, Paper I, Western Philosophy. It preserves the canonical Basic teaching, optional advanced depth and consolidated register notes. Markdown is the source of truth; model answers are independent practice, never official UPSC answer keys.

EMPIRICISM REVISION GUIDE

Page numbers are generated from the final layout. PDF bookmarks include finer subheadings.

Syllabus boundary and source map	3	BASIC LEARNING SESSION	5
Closed-book retrieval protocol	3	OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH — NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE	91
Latest-paper addendum — verified 2026 ownership	4	ANSWER	
		CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	93

Syllabus boundary and source map

Syllabus: *Empiricism (Locke, Berkeley, Hume): Theory of Knowledge; Substance and Qualities; Self and God; Scepticism.*

Layer	Canonical source used
Complete teaching	learning_package_final/.../03-Empiricism/Learning-Session.md
MCQs and solved PYQs	learning_package_final/.../03-Empiricism/Solved-Practice-Workbook.md
Rapid retrieval	quick_galance/Philosophy/philosophy-paper-i-western-philosophy-03_Tree-Chart.md
Doctrine and 2026 addendum	upsc-ai-kit/knowledge/Philosophy/paper-1/western/Empiricism.md
Verified PYQs	Western Philosophy ledgers, 2018–2025 and 2026
Visual audit	Empiricism final-package PDF, graphical poster and 48-panel ASCII master flow

Ownership firewall: this topic owns Locke, Berkeley and Hume on the printed syllabus cells. Kant, Hegel, Moore and Russell enter only where a routed comparison demands them. Quine's *Two Dogmas of Empiricism* belongs to Topic 11 and is not duplicate-owned here.

Closed-book retrieval protocol

1. Write the shared rule: simple cognitive content originates in experience; mental operations are retained.
2. Redraw the route Locke: representative realism → Berkeley: immaterialism → Hume: mitigated scepticism.
3. Reconstruct four syllabus rails for each thinker: knowledge; substance/qualities; self/God; scepticism.
4. Recite one complete argument chain and one objection/reply for every doctrine.
5. Attempt the 32 MCQs without notes, then write a PYQ spine before opening the toolkit.

Philosopher-doctrine matrix — reproduce from memory

Axis	Locke	Berkeley	Hume
Cognitive input	sensation + reflection	immediately perceived ideas	impressions; ideas as copies
Knowledge	agreement/disagreement; three degrees	direct knowledge of ideas	fork: relations of ideas / matters of fact
Substance	unknown supporting substratum	material substance denied; spirit retained	material and spiritual substance dissolved

Axis	Locke	Berkeley	Hume
Qualities	primary/secondary distinction	parity collapses distinction	qualities are perceptions/bundles
Self	continuity of consciousness; forensic person	active spirit known by notion	bundle; Appendix problem
God	demonstratively inferred	active cause and guarantor	proofs fail
Scepticism	epistemic humility	anti-sceptical immaterialism	mitigated scepticism

Argument-chain checks

LOCKE KNOWLEDGE:

experience -> simple ideas -> mental operations -> complex ideas
-> perceived agreement/disagreement -> intuitive / demonstrative / sensitive

BERKELEY IMMATERIALISM:

immediate objects are ideas -> likeness fails -> primary/secondary parity
-> unconceived matter cannot be conceived -> material substratum removed
-> active spirit + God explain involuntary ordered ideas

HUME CAUSATION:

copy principle -> search for impression of necessity fails in objects and will
-> repetition produces mental transition -> custom/habit
-> necessity relocated to impression of reflection -> induction lacks rational proof

Comparison axes

- source of ideas; mode and limit of knowledge; status of matter; status of spirit/self; causal necessity; role of God; response to scepticism; strongest internal cost.
- Locke **supposes** what is not positively known; Berkeley **deletes matter but exempts spirit**; Hume **removes the exemption and naturalises belief**.

Delayed-recall checks

- Day 0: roadmap + 32 MCQs + one 10-mark answer.
- Day 1–2: repair high-confidence errors; redraw one Locke, Berkeley and Hume chain.
- Day 7: unseen mixed set + closed-book philosopher matrix.
- Day 21: interleave with Rationalism and Kant.
- Day 45: one timed 15/20-mark comparative answer.

Latest-paper addendum — verified 2026 ownership

Empiricism directly owns **two** 2026 parts.

2026 Q1(b) · 10 marks — Locke's degrees of knowledge

Exact verified wording: "Explain the distinction between Intuitive knowledge and Demonstrative knowledge as propounded by Locke."

Knowledge is the perception of agreement or disagreement among ideas (*Essay* IV.i.2). **Intuitive knowledge** sees that agreement immediately, without a middle idea: it is irresistible and maximally clear (white is not black; one's own existence). **Demonstrative knowledge** reaches it through intermediate ideas or proofs. Each link must be intuitively seen, so demonstration is a **chain of intuitions**, but it is less luminous because it is successive, effortful and memory-dependent. Mathematics and God's existence are Locke's central cases. Mention **sensitive knowledge** as the lowest, anomalous third degree concerning particular external things. Do not call demonstration probable.

2026 Q2(b) · 15 marks — Hume's ideas of reason and Kant's response

Exact verified wording: "How does Hume account for ideas of reason? How does Kant respond to Hume's views in this regard? Critically discuss."

Read "ideas of reason" through Hume's account of ideas and the fork. Ideas are faint copies of impressions, except for the conceded missing-shade case; complex ideas arise through resemblance, contiguity and cause/effect. **Relations of ideas** are discoverable by thought, necessary and deniable only by contradiction, but they do not establish existence. **Matters of fact** depend on experience; their contraries remain conceivable. Thus reason can compare ideas and demonstrate conceptual relations, but cannot generate objective causal necessity.

Kant accepts Hume's challenge to dogmatic causal inference but rejects the conclusion that necessity is merely habitual. Sensibility supplies a manifold; the understanding supplies categories, including causality, and synthetic a priori principles make objective temporal experience possible. Kant therefore turns causal necessity from a copied idea into a condition of possible experience, while limiting it to phenomena. The reply secures objective experience but does not license knowledge of things-in-themselves.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE — ENGLISH FIRST, LATIN IMMEDIATELY AFTER

THE ONE QUESTION ALL THREE MEN ANSWER
WHAT CAN AN EXPERIENCE-ONLY FOUNDATION ACTUALLY JUSTIFY?

|
SHARED RULE: every simple cognitive content must be traceable to
experience - Locke's SENSATION and REFLECTION, Hume's IMPRESSIONS.
The mind's OPERATIONS (compare, combine, abstract) are not denied.

|
THE FOUR TEST CASES THE SYLLABUS PRINTS BY NAME
knowledge | substance and qualities | self and God | scepticism

|-----+-----+-----+
| LOCKE | BERKELEY | HUME |

applies the rule to CONTENT 	applies it to MATTER 	applies it to EVERYTHING
KNOWLEDGE = perceived agreement of ideas; intuitive > demonstra- tive > sensitive 	all knowledge is of ideas immediately perceived; no veil of perception 	perceptions divide into IMPRESSIONS (vivid) and IDEAS (faint copies); the FORK sorts them
QUALITIES: primary (in the object) vs secondary (powers); primary ideas RESEMBLE 	the primary/secondary distinction COLLAPSES - relativity applies to both alike 	no impression of substance at all - material or spiritual
SUBSTANCE = supposed substratum, "something I know not what" 	NO material substance; to be is to be perce- ived (esse est percipi) 	SUBSTANCE dissolved into stable bundles of co-occurring qualities
SELF = continuity of consciousness; a FORENSIC concept 	SELF = active SPIRIT, known by NOTION, not by idea 	SELF = a bundle or collection of different perceptions in flux
GOD = demonstrated from my own existence by causal reasoning 	GOD = the infinite spirit who causes and sustains the ideas of sense 	GOD = no proof survives; cosmological and design arguments both fail
NOT A SCEPTIC: epistemically humble but confident enough for practical life 	ANTI-SCEPTIC: the materialist, not the idealist, invents the unknowable world 	MITIGATED SCEPTIC: nature compels the beliefs reason cannot justify
+-----+-----+-----+		
THE PRICE EACH PAYS: Locke cannot compare an idea with the matter it is said to resemble; Berkeley must know spirits by a faculty his own theory of ideas cannot supply; Hume cannot say what binds the bundle, and says so himself.		

Concept spine: read it downward. One shared rule about the origin of content, applied with increasing severity to four printed test cases — knowledge, substance and qualities, self and God, and scepticism.

🔑 **Mnemonic — the slide "R → I → S".** Representative realism → Immaterialism → mitigated Scepticism. 🔑 **Mnemonic — what each man deletes, "M-S-N".** Berkeley deletes **M**atter; Hume deletes the **S**ubstantial self and objective **N**ecessity. 🔑 **Mnemonic — the three verdicts on scepticism, "H-A-M".** Locke is **H**umble, Berkeley is **A**nti-sceptical, Hume is **M**itigated.

ANSWER-WORTHINESS — WHAT EARNS MARKS AND WHAT DOES NOT

Classification	Content
CORE MAINS	Locke's refutation of innate ideas and the sources of ideas; the degrees of knowledge; representative realism; abstract general ideas and nominal versus real essence; primary and secondary qualities; substance as "something I know not what"; personal identity and the circularity objection; Locke's demonstrative God. Berkeley's attack on abstraction; the five reconstructed arguments for immaterialism; <i>to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)</i> ; spirits known by notion; God as cause and guarantor of continuity; the contrast with Hegel's absolute idealism; the Moore and Russell reactions. Hume's impressions and ideas and the copy principle; the fork; the dissolution of substance; the bundle self and Kant's reply; the analysis of causation and its two definitions; the problem of induction; the failure of the proofs of God; mitigated scepticism
CORE SUPPORTING	The three principles of association; the missing shade of blue; constancy and coherence in the belief in body; the prince-and-cobbler case; Reid's brave officer; the <i>Treatise</i> Appendix retraction; the billiard balls and the bread; the argument against miracles; the comparative tables; citation and provenance discipline
SUPPORTING	Locke's corpuscular talk of "insensible corpuscles"; Berkeley's account of illusion, science and other minds; Berkeley on natural law as the settled grammar of a divine language; the Samuel Johnson stone-kicking anecdote as reception , never as an argument
OPTIONAL ADVANCED	Whether Locke's substratum is a humble realist posit or an empty placeholder; whether the Master Argument proves anything beyond a scope confusion; whether Hume is better read as a destructive sceptic or as a naturalist
NOT OWNED HERE	Descartes', Spinoza's and Leibniz's positive systems (Topic 02); Kant's critical system as a doctrine (Topic 04); Hegel's dialectic as a doctrine (Topic 05); Moore's and Russell's own positive philosophies (Topic 06); Quine's "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" and every question about it (Topic 11); Locke's political philosophy; Berkeley's mathematical controversies; Hume's passions, ethics, history and economics

 **Ownership boundary, stated once.** Kant, Hegel, Moore and Russell appear here **only** because three routed questions — 2020 Q2(a), 2024 Q2(a) and 2018 Q3(a) — explicitly demand the response. In each case the empiricist argument must be completed **before** the reply is reported. The three papers that mention Quine's *Two Dogmas of Empiricism* (2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c) and 2025 Q4(b)) share a word with this item and belong entirely to Topic 11.

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

Every subtopic below runs in the same order, so the shape becomes automatic:

Step	What it gives you
DEFINITION	plain-language definition, then the technical one
ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING	a sentence you can adapt directly as an introduction or a conclusion
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS	the terms that signal control of the topic
Plain-language visual	the idea before the vocabulary
 VISUAL	the diagram that carries the argument
Numbered teaching	the doctrine, argument by argument, with sources
HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH	claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification, written out for this subtopic
Exam link	which PYQ this subtopic answers, and how
UPSC traps	the specific ways candidates lose marks here
Revision notes	the compressed recall list
CLOSING RECALL FLOW	the subtopic reduced to one flow you can redraw from memory

Complete the Basic block first. Interpretive depth is deliberately withheld until the clearly labelled optional block after the practice sections, so that the core doctrine stays easy to learn and immediately usable. Nothing in the optional block is needed to write a complete answer to any of the twelve routed questions.

ORIGIN AND CHRONOLOGY — THE MINIMUM NEEDED TO AVOID ANACHRONISM

British empiricism is not three separate biographies. It is one rule about the origin of cognitive content, read more strictly at each stage, across roughly sixty years of publication.

1632-1704 JOHN LOCKE born Wrington, Somerset; died Oates, Essex

1689 An Essay Concerning Human Understanding is published
CAUTION: the title page prints 1690, and the work is almost always cited as 1690; both dates are correct in their own sense

1690 Essay, 1st edition as dated -> Book I anti-innatism
Book II ideas, qualities, substance
Book III words, abstraction, essence
Book IV knowledge, degrees, God

1694 2nd edition ADDS II.xxvii "Of Identity and Diversity"
CAUTION: personal identity is NOT in the original 1690 text

1700 4th edition -> the text most modern editions follow
(standard scholarly text: Nidditch, Clarendon 1975)

|

1685-1753 GEORGE BERKELEY Irish; Anglican bishop of Cloyne from 1734

1710 A Treatise concerning the Principles of Human Knowledge
Introduction Sec.6-25 -> the attack on abstract general ideas

Sec.1-4 -> objects of knowledge are ideas; the semantic argument
 Sec.3 -> "to be is to be perceived" (esse est percipi)
 Sec.8 -> the likeness principle: an idea can be like only an idea
 Sec.9-15 -> the parity collapse of primary and secondary qualities
 Sec.22-23 -> the Master Argument
 Sec.27, 89, 140 -> spirits are known by NOTION, not by idea
 Sec.6, 30-33, 48 -> God causes and sustains the order of ideas
 1713 Three Dialogues between Hylas and Philonous -> the same case in dialogue
 |
 1711-1776 DAVID HUME born and died in Edinburgh
 1739-40 A Treatise of Human Nature
 I.i.1 -> impressions and ideas; the missing shade of blue
 I.iii.14 -> the search for the impression of necessary connexion
 I.iv.2 -> constancy, coherence and the belief in body
 I.iv.6 -> "a bundle or collection of different perceptions"
 Appendix -> Hume RETRACTS: he cannot explain what unites the bundle
 1748 An Enquiry concerning Human Understanding
 CAUTION: published in 1748 as Philosophical Essays concerning Human Understanding and renamed in 1758; Hume disowned the Treatise as a juvenile work, and the Enquiry DROPS personal identity
 II -> the copy principle | IV -> the problem of induction
 V -> custom, "the great guide of human life"
 VII -> necessary connexion and the TWO definitions of cause
 X -> miracles | XII -> mitigated scepticism; "commit it then to the flames"
 1779 Dialogues concerning Natural Religion (published posthumously)
 -> the critique of the design argument
 |
 18th c. JOSEPH BUTLER and THOMAS REID (Reid 1710-1796) attack Locke on personal identity: the circularity charge and the Brave Officer
 REPORTED Samuel Johnson kicks a stone: "I refute it thus!"
 CAUTION: reception, not an argument. Berkeley's thesis was never that the stone is unreal or unfelt.

-  The order is causal, not merely chronological. Berkeley reads Locke and quotes his general-triangle passage back at him at *Principles*, Introduction §13; Hume then applies Berkeley's own test to substance, self and causal power.
-  **Three cautions that protect marks.** First, never date personal identity to 1690: II.xxvii is a **1694 addition**. Second, never merge the *Treatise* and the *Enquiry* without saying which text you are using, because the *Enquiry* silently drops the bundle theory. Third, the *Dialogues* were published only after Hume's death, so his most damaging attack on natural religion is posthumous.

ONE-SCREEN ROUTE MAP

THE EMPIRICIST RULE, THE FOUR PRINTED TEST CASES, AND WHY THE SEQUENCE MOVES
 -> LOCKE I: THE ATTACK ON INNATE IDEAS, THE BLANK PAGE, SENSATION AND REFLECTION, SIMPLE AND COMPLEX IDEAS

- > LOCKE II: KNOWLEDGE AS PERCEIVED AGREEMENT, THE THREE DEGREES, PROBABILITY, AND REPRESENTATIVE REALISM
- > LOCKE III: ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEAS, NOMINAL AND REAL ESSENCE, AND THE GENERAL TRIANGLE THAT BERKELEY ATTACKS
- > LOCKE IV: PRIMARY AND SECONDARY QUALITIES AND THE UNKNOWN SUBSTRATUM
- > LOCKE V: PERSONAL IDENTITY AS CONTINUITY OF CONSCIOUSNESS, THE CIRCULARITY OBJECTIONS, AND THE DEMONSTRATIVE PROOF OF GOD
- > BERKELEY I: THE DESTRUCTION OF ABSTRACTION AND THE NOMINALIST REPLACEMENT
- > BERKELEY II: THE FIVE ARGUMENTS FOR IMMATERIALISM AND WHAT "TO BE IS TO BE PERCEIVED" DOES AND DOES NOT CLAIM
- > BERKELEY III: SPIRITS, NOTIONS, GOD, CONTINUITY, COMMON SENSE, AND THE MOORE, RUSSELL AND HEGEL COMPARISONS
- > HUME I: IMPRESSIONS AND IDEAS, THE COPY PRINCIPLE, ASSOCIATION, THE FORK, AND THE DISSOLUTION OF SUBSTANCE
- > HUME II: THE BUNDLE SELF, THE APPENDIX RETRACTION, KANT'S REPLY, THE EXTERNAL WORLD, AND THE FAILURE OF THE PROOFS OF GOD
- > HUME III: CAUSATION, THE TWO DEFINITIONS, THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION, KANT'S SECOND ANALOGY, AND MITIGATED SCEPTICISM
- > COMPARISON, CRITICISMS AND REPLIES, ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVE DECODING AND PROVENANCE DISCIPLINE

This is a route map, not a substitute for the thirteen complete Basic subtopics below.

SESSION 1 — THE EMPIRICIST RULE, THE FOUR PRINTED TEST CASES, AND WHY THE SEQUENCE MOVES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Empiricism is the view that the raw materials of thought come from experience, so any idea that cannot be traced back to something experienced is under suspicion — and the three British empiricists disagree about how much of the ordinary world survives that test.

Technical definition: British empiricism is the doctrine that every simple cognitive content originates in experience — Locke's outer *sensation* and inner *reflection*, Hume's *impressions* — while the mind's own operations of comparing, combining and abstracting are retained; applied successively to knowledge, substance and qualities, self and God, it yields Locke's representative realism, Berkeley's immaterialism and Hume's mitigated scepticism.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Empiricism is not three biographies sharing a chapter but one rule about the **origin of content** enforced with rising severity: Locke keeps a material world he admits he cannot know, Berkeley keeps the world by deleting the matter behind it, and Hume keeps only perceptions, custom and the beliefs nature makes unavoidable — so the slide from realism to idealism to scepticism is a measure of the

rule's consistency, not of philosophical decline.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **origin of content, not denial of reason** — the rule governs materials, not operations
- **sensation and reflection** — experience is two-channelled from the start
- **representative realism** → **immaterialism** → **mitigated scepticism**
- **the four printed test cases** — knowledge; substance and qualities; self and God; scepticism
- **the added premise** — each step needs one, and naming it earns the mark
- **natural belief** — what survives when justification does not

How to use them: open with the origin-of-content rule rather than with a caricature of "anti-reason"; name the four printed test cases so the examiner sees the syllabus; then show that each move from Locke to Berkeley to Hume requires **one further premise**, and name it.

Plain-language visual — one rule, three temperaments

THE RULE EVERYONE ACCEPTS		
+-----+		
If you claim an idea, show me the experience it came from.		
+-----+		
LOCKE says:	BERKELEY says:	HUME says:
"Fine - and the ideas of primary qualities resemble the world."	"Then stop talking about MATTER, which no experience ever delivers."	"Then apply it to SUBSTANCE, the SELF and CAUSAL POWER too."
keeps matter but cannot inspect it	keeps the world, deletes the matter behind it	keeps perceptions, loses the substrate, the simple self and objective necessity
v	v	v
REPRESENTATIVE REALISM	SUBJECTIVE IDEALISM	MITIGATED SCEPTICISM

In simple words: three people are handed the same instruction. The first obeys it about *ideas* but quietly exempts *matter*. The second notices the exemption and removes it. The third notices two more exemptions — the self and causal power — and removes those as well. Nobody changes the rule; they only differ about where they stop applying it. That single sentence, written early, converts a list into an argument.

Remember first	Meaning
Origin, not warrant	empiricism is about where content comes from; the rationalist quarrel is about what justifies necessity
Experience is two-channelled	outer sensation and inner reflection, from Locke onward

Remember first	Meaning
Operations survive	comparing, combining and abstracting are never denied
The slide needs premises	each step adds one; state it
Scepticism is the endpoint, not the programme	Hume's conclusion is mitigated, not Pyrrhonian

One-line memory: empiricism disciplines the **materials** of thought, not the **activity** of thinking.

VISUAL — the four printed test cases and the added premise at each step

SYLLABUS PRINTS FOUR TEST CASES - EVERY ANSWER SHOULD SHOW THEM

=====

- | | |
|---------------------------|---|
| 1 THEORY OF KNOWLEDGE | what ideas are, where they come from,
and how far they can be trusted |
| 2 SUBSTANCE AND QUALITIES | what a thing is behind its qualities,
and which qualities are really in it |
| 3 SELF AND GOD | what unites a life, and what can be
proved about the divine |
| 4 SCEPTICISM | how much doubt the rule finally forces |

=====

|
THE SAME RULE, APPLIED THREE TIMES, WITH AN ADDED PREMISE
|

LOCKE ----->

rule + "ideas of primary qualities RESEMBLE their causes"

| ADDED PREMISE: resemblance across the perceptual boundary
v

BERKELEY ----->

rule + "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" (Principles Sec.8)

| ADDED PREMISE: comparability - a resemblance nobody could
| ever check is empty; so matter is not unknown but meaningless
v

HUME ----->

rule + "impressions are separable atoms, so no relation is given
WITH its terms"

| ADDED PREMISE: atomism of impressions; therefore substance,
| self and necessary connexion have no source impression
v

RESULT: bundles, habit, natural belief and MITIGATED scepticism

=====

WHY KANT MATTERS AT ALL HERE: he accepts the negative result and
denies the atomism, which is why he is the routed reply in 2020
and 2025 - and why he is NOT part of the empiricist doctrine.

⚠ **Caption.** The examiner's reward is concentrated in the middle column. A script that reports three positions has described the topic; a script that names the **added premise** at each step has explained it.

1. The rule, stated exactly — and what it does not say

✓ Every **simple** idea traces to experience. Locke's channels are **sensation** (outer sense: colour, sound, warmth, solidity) and **reflection** (inner sense: the mind noticing its own thinking, doubting, willing, believing). Hume's version is the **copy principle**: every simple idea is a faint copy of a corresponding simple impression.

✗ Empiricism is **not** the claim that the mind is inert, that reason is worthless, or that there are no *a priori* truths at all. Hume's own "relations of ideas" are known by thought alone. What is denied is innate **ideas or principles** in Locke's target sense — not native faculties.

2. The four printed test cases, and where each thinker lands

Test case	Locke	Berkeley	Hume
Theory of knowledge	knowledge is the perceived agreement or disagreement of ideas; three degrees	all knowledge is of ideas immediately perceived; no veil	perceptions split into impressions and ideas; the fork sorts all enquiry
Substance and qualities	primary versus secondary qualities; substratum is "something I know not what"	the distinction collapses; there is no material substance at all	no impression of substance, so it is a fiction of the imagination
Self and God	self is continuity of consciousness; God is demonstrated causally	self is an active spirit known by notion; God causes and sustains the ideas of sense	self is a bundle of perceptions; every proof of God fails
Scepticism	rejected; humility, not doubt	explicitly refuted, and blamed on the materialist	embraced, but mitigated by nature and custom

3. Why the sequence moves — the mechanism in four lines

1. Locke's ideas of primary qualities are said to **resemble** qualities in bodies.
2. Berkeley points out that resemblance is a relation between comparable items, and nothing unperceivable is comparable — so the resemblance claim is not merely unverified, it is **unintelligible** (*Principles* §8).
3. Removing matter leaves ideas and the minds that have them, so Berkeley must supply an active cause for the involuntary order of sense: **God**.
4. Hume then asks Berkeley's question about **spirit** and about **causal power**, finds no impression of either, and the sequence terminates in bundles, habit and mitigated scepticism.

⚠ Each arrow is an argument, not a historical drift. This is why "Locke → Berkeley → Hume" must be presented as a **pressure test** of one premise, and why it is legitimate to say the endpoint reveals the premise to be incomplete — which is exactly the diagnosis Kant makes.

4. What the three men actually share

- ✓ A **genetic** method: explain a concept by exhibiting the experience that produced it.

-  A hostility to *unexperienceable* explanatory posits, whether scholastic forms or Cartesian innate content.
-  A conviction that philosophy should describe the human understanding rather than legislate for it — Locke's "under-labourer" modesty, Berkeley's appeal to the plain man, Hume's science of human nature.
-  What they do **not** share is a verdict on how much of ordinary life survives, which is why calling them "the empiricists" without an internal differentiation loses marks in every comparative question.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

Claim. The movement from Locke to Hume is generated by consistency, not by disagreement about the empiricist rule itself. **Named evidence.** All three accept that simple content originates in experience; Locke nevertheless asserts at *Essay* II.viii that ideas of primary qualities resemble their causes, Berkeley answers at *Principles* §8 that "an idea can be like nothing but an idea", and Hume's search at *Treatise* I.iii.14 for an impression of necessary connexion finds only a determination of the mind. **Analysis.** Each successor removes an exemption his predecessor had quietly granted: Locke exempts matter, Berkeley exempts spirit and causal agency, and Hume exempts nothing, so the terminal scepticism is the rule's own shadow rather than an external attack on it. **Qualification.** The sequence is a reconstruction for exam use, and each step needs an additional premise — comparability for Berkeley, the atomism of impressions for Hume — so it demonstrates the rule's severity without proving that the rule is true.

Exam link

- Every comparative question in this item — 2018 Q3(a), 2024 Q2(a) — opens more strongly if the added premise is named in the first paragraph.
- **2022 Q4(c)** and **2023 Q2(c)** both begin from the rule stated in §1; the innate-ideas material in Session 2 is the second half of that answer.
- The four printed test cases in §2 are the safest available structure for any unexpected "Empiricism in general" question.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Empiricists deny reason"	They restrict the origin of content ; Hume's relations of ideas are known by thought alone
"Experience means the five senses"	Locke's reflection is inner experience of the mind's own operations
Presenting the slide as decline	Each step is the previous position taken consistently, which is why Kant treats it as a diagnosis
Treating the three as interchangeable "empiricists"	The whole examinable content lies in the differences
Importing Quine's <i>Two Dogmas of Empiricism</i>	That is Topic 11; sharing the word "empiricism" creates no ownership

Revision notes

- One rule: every simple content traces to experience — sensation and reflection, impressions and ideas.
- Operations are never denied; innate **ideas and principles** are.
- Four printed test cases: knowledge; substance and qualities; self and God; scepticism.
- Added premises: resemblance (Locke) → comparability (Berkeley) → atomism of impressions (Hume).
- Landing points: representative realism → subjective idealism → mitigated scepticism.
- Kant is the routed reply, never part of the doctrine.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — THE EMPIRICIST RULE AND THE PRESSURE SEQUENCE

```
RULE: EVERY SIMPLE CONTENT TRACES TO EXPERIENCE (SENSATION + REFLECTION)
|
v
FOUR PRINTED TEST CASES: KNOWLEDGE | SUBSTANCE+QUALITIES | SELF+GOD | SCEPTICISM
|
+--> LOCKE  + resemblance of primary-quality ideas -> REPRESENTATIVE
REALISM
|
cost: the resemblance can never be inspected
+--> BERKELEY + "an idea can be like only an idea" -> IMMATERIALISM
|
cost: spirits need a faculty (notion) outside the idea theory
+--> HUME    + atomism of impressions -> BUNDLES, HABIT, MITIGATED
SCEPTICISM
|
cost: nothing explains what unites the bundle
|
v
KANT ENTERS ONLY AS THE ROUTED REPLY (2020, 2025): he keeps the negative
result and attacks the atomism
TRAP: not anti-reason | not five senses only | not three biographies
ANSWER LINE: the slide measures the rule's consistency, not philosophy's decline
```

SESSION 2 — LOCKE I: THE ATTACK ON INNATE IDEAS, THE BLANK PAGE, AND THE CONSTRUCTION OF IDEAS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Locke argues that we are not born knowing anything; the mind starts as unwritten paper, experience writes on it through the outer senses and through our awareness of our own mental operations, and everything complex is then built by the mind out of those simple deliveries.

Technical definition: Locke's genetic epistemology denies innate ideas and innate practical or speculative principles, derives all ideas from **sensation** and **reflection**, distinguishes passively received **simple ideas** from actively constructed **complex ideas** — sorted as **modes, substances and relations** — and thereby makes the origin of an idea the test of its legitimacy.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's refutation of innate ideas is not an appeal to nursery observation but a demand for redundancy: since every idea alleged to be innate can be shown to arrive through sensation or reflection, and since "to be in the mind" means for Locke "to be perceived by the mind", the innatist hypothesis explains nothing that experience has not already explained and posits something the theory of ideas cannot contain.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **universal assent refuted** — children and the cognitively impaired lack the alleged content
- **no unconscious ideas** — an unperceived thought is a contradiction in Locke's sense
- **the redundancy or genetic argument** — experience suffices, so innateness is idle
- **white paper, void of all characters** — Locke's own words at II.i.2
- **blank slate (tabula rasa)** — a **later label**, not Locke's phrase
- **sensation and reflection** — the two fountains of knowledge
- **simple** → **complex: modes, substances, relations**

How to use them: give the three grounds in order, then the decisive premise about what "in the mind" means, then the concession that Descartes' *dispositional* innatism survives it — that concession is what separates a first-class answer from a textbook one.

Plain-language visual — three ways to attack an inborn idea

CLAIM UNDER ATTACK: "Some ideas are stamped on the mind at birth."

ATTACK 1 UNIVERSAL ASSENT

```
+-----+
| If it were inborn,      |
| EVERYONE would have it. |
| Children and the        |
| cognitively impaired    |
| do not.                 |
+-----+
```

ATTACK 2 NO HIDDEN IDEAS

```
+-----+
| "There is an idea in your |
| mind you have never      |
| thought" is, for Locke,  |
| a contradiction: to be in |
| the mind IS to be        |
| perceived by the mind.   |
+-----+
```

\ /
 \ /

ATTACK 3 REDUNDANCY

```
+-----+
| Every "innate" idea can be |
| traced to sensation or     |
| reflection. If experience  |
| already explains it, the   |
| inborn hypothesis is idle. |
+-----+
```

In simple words: Locke never claims that babies are stupid. He claims that if you say an idea was inside all along but nobody noticed, you have described nothing that experience cannot describe better — and you have used the phrase "in the mind" in a way that, on his account of ideas, has no meaning. Attack 3 is the one that does the philosophical work; attacks 1 and 2 clear the ground for it.

Remember first	Meaning
Target	innate ideas and principles , not native faculties
"White paper"	Locke's own words; <i>tabula rasa</i> is the tradition's label
Sensation	ideas from external objects acting on the senses
Reflection	ideas from noticing the mind's own operations
Simple ideas	passively received; the mind cannot invent a new one
Complex ideas	actively made: modes, substances, relations

One-line memory: the mind supplies the **workmanship**; experience supplies the **stock**.

VISUAL — the pipeline from experience to knowledge, with the limit marked

EXPERIENCE, IN TWO CHANNELS

=====

SENSATION (outer)

colour, sound, taste, smell,
warmth, solidity, extension,
figure, motion, number

REFLECTION (inner)

thinking, doubting, believing,
willing, reasoning, knowing
- the mind observing ITSELF

=====

\ /
v v

SIMPLE IDEAS (PASSIVELY RECEIVED)

the mind can neither make nor destroy one

|

ACTIVE OPERATIONS: combine | compare | abstract

|

v

COMPLEX IDEAS - three kinds

+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+
MODES	SUBSTANCES	RELATIONS	
dependent com-	supposed independent	produced by	
binations, e.g.	bearers, represented	comparing one	
triangle,	through clusters of	thing with another:	
gratitude,	co-occurring qualities	cause, identity,	
number	(gold, man, lead)	moral relation	
+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+

|

v

WHAT LOCKE HAS BOUGHT: a theory in which the ORIGIN of an idea licenses its use - and a bill he must pay in Book IV, because knowledge is now confined to relations among IDEAS.

=====

THE LIMIT, STATED HONESTLY: the genetic argument shows innateness is UNNECESSARY, not that it is IMPOSSIBLE. Descartes' dispositional innatism - a capacity elicited by experience - slips past all three attacks, and 2023 Q2(c) is decided on exactly this point.

⚠ **Caption.** Read the diagram as an account with a debt. Sessions 3 and 4 collect the debt: if knowledge is the perception of agreement among ideas, the external world must be reached by an inference the theory has made difficult.

1. The three grounds of refutation, in Locke's order

Ground	Locke's argument	The target
Universal assent fails	If certain ideas or principles were innate, every human being — including children and "idiots" — would possess them; manifestly they do not	The standard innatist appeal to universal agreement
No unconscious ideas	A thought the mind does not think is self-contradictory, because for Locke "to be in the mind" is "to be perceived by the mind"	The retreat to ideas present but unnoticed
A genetic account is available	Every idea claimed as innate — God, identity, non-contradiction — can be shown to arise from sensation or reflection; if experience suffices, innateness is idle	All alleged innate content, speculative and practical

✓ Ground 2 is the decisive one. Grounds 1 and 3 are empirical and can be conceded by a determined innatist; ground 2 is a **stipulation about what "in the mind" means**, and it is that stipulation, not the nursery evidence, that closes the escape route.

2. The blank page — the exact words and the exact provenance

- ✓ Locke writes that the mind is "**white paper, void of all characters**" (*Essay* II.i.2).
- ⚠ **Provenance mark worth free marks:** *tabula rasa* is **not Locke's phrase**. It is Scholastic and Aristotelian vocabulary applied to him by the tradition. Write: "the mind as 'white paper, void of all characters' — the doctrine traditionally labelled *tabula rasa*."
- ✗ The blank-page thesis does **not** say the mind is passive. It denies innate **content**; it leaves the faculties of perceiving, remembering, comparing, combining and abstracting entirely intact.

3. The two fountains, and why reflection matters

- **Sensation** delivers ideas from external objects impinging on the senses.
- **Reflection** delivers ideas of the mind's own operations — thinking, doubting, willing, believing.

- ⚠️ Reflection is the single most under-used word in weak answers. It is what allows Locke to be an empiricist about **logic, mathematics and the self** without appealing to innate content, and it is what Hume later exploits when he locates the impression of necessary connexion **internally**.

4. Simple and complex ideas — the workmanship of the understanding

- ✅ **Simple ideas** are passively received and unanalysable; the mind cannot invent a wholly new simple sensory content, which is why a person born blind has no idea of scarlet.
- ✅ **Complex ideas** are actively formed by combining, comparing and abstracting:
- **modes** — dependent combinations such as triangle, gratitude or number;
- **substances** — supposed independently existing bearers, represented through clusters of qualities;
- **relations** — ideas produced by comparing one thing with another, such as cause, identity or moral relation.
- ⚠️ The classification is not decoration. "Substance" appearing as a *complex idea* is already the admission that Session 5 exploits: what we have is a cluster plus a supposition, never an inspected substratum.

5. The reply Locke must face — and the honest verdict

- ❓ **Descartes' dispositional reply.** Innate ideas were never claimed to be consciously present from birth; they are **capacities** of the intellect, elicited on an appropriate occasion, in the way a family disease is innate before it appears.
- ⚠️ **Adjudication.** Against a **naïve** innatism of consciously possessed inborn propositions, Locke wins outright. Against the **dispositional** innatism Descartes actually held, ground 1 misses and ground 3 is inconclusive, so everything turns on ground 2 — and ground 2 is a stipulation, not a discovery.
- ✅ **The line that earns the mark:** Leibniz's later formula — nothing is in the intellect that was not first in the senses, **except the intellect itself** — shows that innatism survives Locke as a thesis about *structure*, which is precisely the form Kant will vindicate.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

Claim. Locke's refutation of innate ideas succeeds against the doctrine as he states it and leaves the dispositional version standing. **Named evidence.** *Essay* Book I mounts three attacks — the failure of universal assent, the impossibility of an idea in the mind that the mind does not perceive, and the availability of a genetic account through sensation and reflection — while II.i.2 replaces innate content with "white paper, void of all characters". **Analysis.** The empirical grounds can be absorbed by an innatist who claims only a capacity, so the weight falls on Locke's premise that to be in the mind is to be perceived by it; that premise is a decision about the meaning of "idea" rather than an observation, and once it is questioned the refutation loses its grip. **Qualification.** The dispute is therefore not empirical but conceptual, and Leibniz's rejoinder that the intellect itself is what the senses never supplied shows the surviving form of innatism to be structural — the form Kant later develops, and the reason 2023 Q2(c) cannot be answered by listing Locke's points alone.

Exam link

- **2022 Q4(c), 15 marks** — "Why and how does John Locke refute the innate ideas? Elucidate the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology." §§1–4 are the whole answer, with Session 3 supplying the degrees of knowledge.
- **2023 Q2(c), 15 marks** — routed to Rationalism, but the Locke half is §1 and §5; the dispositional reply is compulsory there.
- Any question on empiricist method opens from §2 and §3.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
Quoting " <i>tabula rasa</i> " as Locke's words	His words are "white paper, void of all characters"; the Latin tag is the tradition's
"Blank slate means the mind is passive"	Only simple ideas are passive; complex ideas are the workmanship of the understanding
Giving only the children-and-idiots argument	That is the weakest ground; the decisive one is that nothing can be in the mind unperceived
Omitting reflection	Without it Locke cannot explain ideas of thinking, willing or the self, and the answer looks like crude sensationalism
Presenting the refutation as complete	Dispositional innatism survives; say so and grade the verdict

Revision notes

- Three grounds: universal assent fails · no unconscious ideas · genetic account available.
- Decisive premise: "in the mind" = "perceived by the mind" — a stipulation.
- II.i.2: "white paper, void of all characters"; *tabula rasa* is a later label.
- Two fountains: sensation (outer) and reflection (inner).
- Simple ideas passive; complex ideas = modes, substances, relations.
- Verdict: naive innatism destroyed; dispositional innatism survives; Leibniz's "except the intellect itself" states the survivor.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — LOCKE I: INNATE IDEAS AND THE SOURCES OF IDEAS

INNATIST CLAIM: SOME IDEAS ARE STAMPED ON THE MIND AT BIRTH

|

+++> GROUND 1 universal assent fails (children, the impaired)

+++> GROUND 2 no idea can be in the mind unperceived <-- DECISIVE

+++> GROUND 3 experience already explains every candidate

|

v

REPLACEMENT: "WHITE PAPER, VOID OF ALL CHARACTERS" (Essay II.i.2)

label caution: *tabula rasa* is the tradition's phrase, not Locke's

|

v

TWO FOUNTAINS: SENSATION (outer) + REFLECTION (inner operations)

```

|
v
SIMPLE IDEAS (passive) --combine/compare/abstract--> COMPLEX IDEAS
  MODES | SUBSTANCES | RELATIONS
  |
  v
RESIDUAL: dispositional innatism survives; Leibniz - "except the intellect
itself"; Kant later vindicates the structural form
TRAP: tabula rasa as a quotation | passivity | omitting reflection
ANSWER LINE: Locke shows innateness is unnecessary, not impossible

```

SESSION 3 — LOCKE II: KNOWLEDGE AS PERCEIVED AGREEMENT, THE THREE DEGREES, PROBABILITY AND THE VEIL OF PERCEPTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: For Locke, to know something is to see that two of your own ideas do or do not fit together; that seeing comes in three strengths, and everything below the weakest strength is not knowledge but reasonable belief.

Technical definition: Locke defines knowledge as the perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas, grades it as **intuitive**, **demonstrative** and **sensitive**, assigns everything beyond these grades to **probability** and judgement, and combines this with **representative realism** — the doctrine that we perceive ideas which represent external objects, generating the epistemic gap his successors exploit.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's theory of knowledge is generous in its account of where ideas come from and severe in its account of what may be called knowledge: because knowing is the perception of agreement **between ideas**, the existence of the external world can be reached only by the weakest of his three degrees, and that structural asymmetry — rich origins, thin certification — is what makes representative realism unstable enough for Berkeley to attack.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas**
- **intuitive, demonstrative, sensitive** — the three degrees, in that order of certainty
- **probability and judgement** — the vast domain below knowledge
- **representative realism** — ideas represent; objects are inferred
- **the veil of perception** — the gap the theory creates
- **sensitive knowledge** — Locke's own weakest degree, and the exam pressure point

How to use them: define knowledge first, then the three degrees with one example each, then show that the external world sits at the bottom of the ladder — and finish by naming the veil objection rather than waiting for the examiner to name it.

Plain-language visual — a ladder with a shaky bottom rung

HOW SURE CAN LOCKE BE?		
+-----+		
INTUITIVE	"white is not black"	most
	the mind sees the agreement IMMEDIATELY	certain
+-----+		
DEMONSTRATIVE	proofs in mathematics; the existence of God	
	agreement seen through INTERVENING ideas	
+-----+		
SENSITIVE	"there is a sheet of paper before me now"	least
	the existence of PARTICULAR external things	certain
+-----+		
	----- below this line is not knowledge -----	
PROBABILITY	testimony, analogy, everyday expectation,	
	the whole of natural history and much science	
+-----+		

In simple words: Locke is not a sceptic, but he is a minimalist about the word "knowledge". Most of what we confidently believe — that the sun will rise, that this medicine works, that a friend is trustworthy — is not knowledge on his definition at all; it is well-grounded probability. Saying this early shows the examiner that you understand the **scale** of his restriction, which is the point Hume will later exploit without mercy.

Remember first	Meaning
Knowledge	perceived agreement or disagreement of ideas
Intuitive	immediate, no middle term
Demonstrative	mediated by intervening ideas; a chain of intuitions
Sensitive	that particular things exist; the weakest degree
Probability	judgement, not knowledge; where most of life happens
Representative realism	we perceive ideas that represent objects

One-line memory: rich sources, **narrow** certification — and the world sits on the bottom rung.

 VISUAL — the causal chain, the representation claim, and the gap it opens

```
THE CHAIN LOCKE ACCEPTS  
=====
```

EXTERNAL BODY ---acts on---	SENSE ORGAN ---produces--->	IDEA IN MIND
(has primary qualities; real essence unknown)	(mechanically affected)	(the only thing ever inspected)

```
=====
```

|
KNOWLEDGE OPERATES ONLY HERE:

agreement AMONG IDEAS	
THE REPRESENTATION CLAIM: ideas of PRIMARY qualities RESEMBLE their causes; ideas of SECONDARY qualities do not resemble anything.	
v	
THE VEIL OBJECTION - state it yourself before the examiner does:	
+-----+	
To check that an idea resembles its cause I must compare the two.	
But I can only ever inspect the IDEA. So the resemblance is a	
claim I am, in principle, unable to test.	
+-----+	
LOCKE'S REPLIES	WHAT SURVIVES
1 the involuntariness and coherence of sense	a CAUSAL and STRUCTURAL claim (this idea was produced by that body) is defensible; the further QUALITATIVE likeness claim is the exposed one -and it is precisely what Berkeley attacks at Principles Sec.8
2 the agreement of different senses about the same body	
3 God is no deceiver	
4 sensitive knowledge is "as certain as our frame can attain"	
=====	

⚠ **Caption.** Do not present the veil as a knock-down refutation. Present it as the **cost** of an otherwise powerful theory, list Locke's four replies, and then say exactly which part of the representation claim survives. That is the difference between reporting a criticism and adjudicating one.

1. The definition, and why it constrains everything after it

✅ **Knowledge is the perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas.** Everything Locke can subsequently say about the world must be expressed as a relation among ideas — which is why the existence of things outside the mind is the hardest thing for his system to certify, and why he must introduce a third, weaker degree specially for it.

2. The three degrees, with their examples

Degree	Mechanism	Example	Certainty
Intuitive	the agreement is seen immediately, with no intervening idea	"white is not black"; "a circle is not a triangle"; my own existence	highest
Demonstrative	the agreement is seen through a chain of intervening ideas, each link intuitive	mathematical proof; the existence of God	high, but liable to error in long chains
Sensitive	the existence of particular things now affecting the senses	"there is a sheet of paper before me"	lowest of the three, "though still reliable"

✓ Naming **sensitive knowledge** as Locke's own term, and admitting it is his weakest degree, is what allows you to explain the internal pressure on the system without misrepresenting him as a sceptic.

3. Probability — the domain Locke does not call knowledge

- ⚠️ Beyond the three degrees lies **judgement**, governed by probability: the conformity of a claim with our own experience, and the testimony of others weighed by number, integrity, skill and consistency.
- ✓ This is where most of natural philosophy, all history and all everyday reasoning live. Locke's epistemic humility is not doubt; it is a careful refusal to inflate belief into knowledge.
- ? The unresolved tension: sensitive knowledge and high probability shade into one another, and Locke never draws the boundary sharply.

4. Representative realism, and the four defences

- ✓ We do not perceive objects directly; we perceive **ideas** that represent external objects.
- ⚠️ The gap is real, and Locke does not ignore it. His defences are: sense ideas are **involuntary**; different senses **agree** about the same body; pleasure and pain accompany real bodies in ways imagination cannot reproduce; and God would not construct us to be systematically deceived in what matters for the conduct of life.
- ✓ **What survives the veil objection:** a **causal** and **structural** representation claim — that this idea was produced by that body, and that measurable structure corresponds. What is exposed is the further **qualitative resemblance** claim, and that is the exact target of *Principles* §8.

5. Why Locke is not a sceptic

- ✓ He denies that we can know **real essences** or the intrinsic nature of substance; he does not deny that we know enough for "the conveniences of life and the information of virtue".
- ⚠️ The famous image is the plumb line: our candle burns bright enough for our purposes, and complaining that it is not the sun is a misuse of the faculties we have.
- ✗ Never write that Locke "leads to scepticism" as though he endorsed it. Write that his structure **makes a sceptical challenge available**, and that Berkeley claims to remove the challenge by removing the veil.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

Claim. Locke's epistemology is generous about the origin of ideas and severe about the certification of knowledge, and that asymmetry rather than any sceptical intention is what destabilises representative realism. **Named evidence.** Knowledge is defined as the perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas and graded as intuitive, demonstrative and sensitive, with the existence of particular external things assigned to the weakest degree, while everything else — testimony, analogy, natural history — is relegated to probability and judgement. **Analysis.** Because all certification is internal to ideas, the claim that ideas of primary qualities resemble their causes cannot be checked by the only procedure the system allows, so Berkeley's later objection is not an external attack but a demand that Locke apply his own standard to his own thesis. **Qualification.** The damage is nevertheless limited: the involuntariness and inter-sensory agreement of sense support a causal and

structural representation claim, and only the qualitative resemblance thesis is genuinely exposed — which is why Locke should be read as an epistemically humble realist rather than as an unwilling sceptic.

Exam link

- **2022 Q4(c), 15 marks** — the second limb, "the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology", is answered from §§1–3.
- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** — the veil and the resemblance thesis in §4 are what Berkeley's rejection of primary qualities exploits.
- **2021 Q1(c), 10 marks** — Berkeley's "immediately perceived" is defined against Locke's mediated perception, so §4 is the contrast this answer needs.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Locke is a sceptic"	He is a moderate realist with a narrow definition of knowledge
Listing the three degrees without examples	The examples are what show you understand the mechanism
Ignoring probability	Most of Locke's own epistemic life happens below the knowledge line
Treating the veil as Locke's own doctrine	"Veil of perception" is the critics' image, not his phrase
Saying representation is refuted outright	Causal and structural representation survives; qualitative resemblance does not

Revision notes

- Knowledge = perceived agreement or disagreement of ideas.
- Degrees: intuitive (immediate) → demonstrative (chained) → sensitive (particular existents).
- Below knowledge: probability and judgement — testimony, analogy, natural history.
- Representative realism: ideas represent; objects are inferred.
- Four defences: involuntariness · inter-sensory agreement · pleasure and pain · divine non-deception.
- Survives: causal and structural representation. Exposed: qualitative resemblance.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW — LOCKE II: KNOWLEDGE, DEGREES AND THE VEIL

```

KNOWLEDGE = PERCEIVED AGREEMENT OR DISAGREEMENT OF IDEAS
|
+--> INTUITIVE      immediate: "white is not black"
+--> DEMONSTRATIVE  chained: mathematics; the existence of God
+--> SENSITIVE      particular external things - WEAKEST DEGREE
|
v
BELOW THE LINE: PROBABILITY AND JUDGEMENT (testimony, analogy, science)
|
v

```

REPRESENTATIVE REALISM: body -> sense organ -> IDEA (the only inspectable item)
claim: primary-quality ideas RESEMBLE; secondary-quality ideas do NOT
|
+--> VEIL OBJECTION: the comparison can never be made
+--> LOCKE'S REPLIES: involuntariness | inter-sensory agreement |
pleasure and pain | God is no deceiver
|
v
SURVIVES: causal + structural representation | EXPOSED: qualitative likeness
TRAP: Locke as sceptic | degrees without examples | veil as his own phrase
ANSWER LINE: generous about origins, severe about certification

SESSION 4 — LOCKE III: ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEAS, NOMINAL AND REAL ESSENCE, AND THE GENERAL TRIANGLE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Everything that exists is a particular thing, yet almost every word we use is general; Locke explains the gap by saying the mind strips away what makes ideas particular and keeps a stripped-down idea that stands for a whole class — and the class-name then means that stripped-down idea, not the hidden inner nature of the things.

Technical definition: Locke's doctrine of **abstract general ideas** holds that words become general by signifying general ideas, and ideas become general by **abstraction** — separation from the circumstances of time, place and all concomitant ideas — producing a "general representative" that is the **nominal essence** annexed to a sortal name, as distinct from the unknown **real essence** or internal constitution of the thing.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's doctrine of abstraction is the hinge of the whole empiricist quarrel about language: because he holds that everything existing is particular, that words are general only by signifying general ideas, and that classification is therefore "the workmanship of the understanding", the general idea of a triangle must be "all and none" of the determinate triangles at once — a concession he makes himself at *Essay* IV.vii.9, and the concession on which Berkeley builds his entire immaterialism.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **everything that exists is particular** (*Essay* III.iii.1)
- **abstraction** — separation from "circumstances of time and place"
- **general representative** — the abstract idea's job
- **nominal essence** versus **real essence**
- **conceptualism, not Platonic realism** — universals are creatures of the understanding
- **"something imperfect, that cannot exist"** — Locke's own admission

How to use them: state the eight-step argument, produce the triangle passage, and then — before any objection is raised — distinguish an idea with a feature **left undetermined** from an idea with **contradictory features assigned**. That distinction is Locke's best defence and it decides the 2025 answer.

Plain-language visual — how one idea can stand for many things

THE PROBLEM

things that exist: this dog | that dog | the other dog (all particular)

```
words we use:      "dog"                (general)
```

^

1

LOCKE'S SOLUTION: SUBTRACTION

| Take the idea of THIS dog. Remove: the time you saw it, the

```
| place, its colour, its size, its bark, its owner...
```

| What is left is a stripped idea that can stand for ANY dog.

| That stripped idea IS the meaning of the word "dog".

1

BERKELEY'S REPLY: SELECTION, NOT SUBTRACTION

Keep the idea of THIS dog, complete and determinate. Simply

| ATTEND to what it shares with others, and let it STAND FOR

| all of them. The geometer draws this black inch-long line and

```
| proves a theorem about all lines.
```

In simple words: the whole dispute is whether generality lives in a **special stripped idea** or in the **use** to which an ordinary idea is put. Locke says the idea is special; Berkeley says the use is special. Once you can say that sentence, you can answer the 2025 question in your first line.

Remember first	Meaning
Particularity	everything that exists is particular
Abstraction	strip time, place and concomitants
General representative	the stripped idea standing for the sort
Nominal essence	the abstract idea annexed to the general name
Real essence	the internal constitution producing observable properties
Conceptualism	universals are inventions of the understanding, not things

One-line memory: we classify by **nominal** essence and are ignorant of **real** essence — so sorting is our workmanship, not nature's dictation.

VISUAL — the eight-step argument, the triangle, and the two essences

LOCKE'S ARGUMENT, NUMBERED (Essay III.iii and IV.vii.9)

- ```
=====
1 Everything that exists is PARTICULAR III.iii.1
2 A separate name for every particular is impossible -
 memory could not hold them and communication would fail III.iii.2-4
3 Therefore language requires GENERAL TERMS
4 Words are general only by being signs of GENERAL IDEAS III.iii.6
5 Ideas become general when the mind SEPARATES them from
 circumstances of time, place and every concomitant idea III.iii.6-9
6 What remains serves as a "GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE" of all
 particulars of the same sort
7 The abstract idea annexed to a sortal name IS the
 NOMINAL ESSENCE by which we classify III.iii.15
8 "General and universal belong not to the real existence
 of things; they are the inventions and creatures of the
 understanding" III.iii.11
=====
```

```

|
THE CANONICAL EXAMPLE - AND THE ADMISSION Essay IV.vii.9
+-----+
```

```
| The general idea of a triangle "must be neither oblique nor
| rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but
| all and none of these at once."
| Locke concedes it is "something IMPERFECT, THAT CANNOT EXIST",
| and that framing it "requires some pains and skill."
+-----+
```

```

|
TWO ESSENCES - KEEP THEM APART
+-----+
```

| NOMINAL ESSENCE              | REAL ESSENCE                |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| the abstract idea annexed to | the internal constitution   |
| the name: "gold" = yellow,   | (Locke's "insensible        |
| heavy, malleable, soluble in | corpuscles") from which the |
| aqua regia                   | observable properties flow  |
| KNOWN - we made it           | UNKNOWN - we posit it       |
| fixes CLASSIFICATION         | fixes NOTHING we can use    |

```
+-----+
```

```

|
FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS THE ARGUMENT NEEDS
```

- P1 meaning is IDEATIONAL - a word signifies by standing for an idea
- P2 ideas are IMAGISTIC and particular in origin
- P3 mental SUBTRACTION leaves something still contentful
- P4 ONE IDEA PER GENERAL WORD - generality lives in the idea, not the use

⚠️ **Caption.** Presuppositions P1 and P4 are the load-bearing ones. Berkeley's attack in Session 6 destroys P2 and P3; Wittgenstein's later attack destroys P1 and P4, which is why the deepest verdict on this dispute is that the casualty is the **ideational theory of meaning**, not abstraction as such.

## 1. Why Locke needs the doctrine at all

The doctrine is not an optional flourish. Without it, Locke has no account of how a mind furnished only with particular ideas can use general words, and therefore no account of classification, of definition, or of the nominal essences on which the whole of Book III depends. Berkeley understood this exactly, which is why he attacks abstraction **first**, in the Introduction, before saying a word about matter.

## 2. The two essences, applied

- ✓ **Real essence** = the internal constitution of a thing — for Locke, the arrangement of its "insensible corpuscles" — that gives rise to all its observable properties. We usually do not know it.
- ✓ **Nominal essence** = the abstract idea associated with a general name. Classification proceeds by nominal essence.
- ⚠️ Consequence worth stating: because we sort by nominal essence, **species boundaries are conventional in their sharpness though not arbitrary in their materials**. Locke is agnostic about real essences without denying that things have them; that is epistemic humility, not anti-realism.

## 3. Locke as a conceptualist

- ✓ Universals are neither Platonic Forms subsisting apart nor mere noises: they are ideas made by the understanding for its own use, and they "concern only signs" (III.iii.11).
- ⚠️ This places Locke between Plato and the strict nominalist. Naming the position — **conceptualism** — is a one-word gain in precision that most scripts never make.

## 4. The concession that decides the dispute

- ✓ Locke himself says the abstract general idea of a triangle is "**something imperfect, that cannot exist**". Berkeley quotes the passage **verbatim** at *Principles*, Introduction §13.
- ⚠️ **Locke's best available reply** — the distinction that saves him: an abstract idea is **partial**, not **contradictory**. It is the idea of three-sidedness with the specific angles **left undetermined**, not with contradictory angles **assigned**. Determinables need not be determinate.
- ? **The price of that reply**: it requires giving up the imagistic model of ideas that Locke elsewhere retains. Modern commentators generally accept the determinable reading, but it turns the abstract idea into a non-imagistic act of the understanding — and then it is no longer an "idea" in Locke's own official sense.

## 5. The verdict to carry into Session 6

⚠️ **Executable verdict:** Berkeley wins against the **imagistic** Locke and loses against the **determinable** Locke. The lasting damage is not to abstraction but to the ideational theory of meaning that made abstraction necessary — which is why the argument's true heir is not Hume but Wittgenstein's family-resemblance treatment of generality.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** Locke's doctrine of abstract general ideas is an answer to a genuine problem about generality, and it is vulnerable only on a particular reading of what an idea is. **Named evidence.** *Essay* III.iii.1–15 argues that all existents are particular, that words are general by signifying general ideas, that ideas become general by separation from circumstances of time and place, and that the resulting nominal essence is what classification uses, while IV.vii.9 concedes that the general triangle is "all and none" of the determinate triangles and is "something imperfect, that cannot exist". **Analysis.** The concession is fatal only if ideas must be images, for an image cannot be indeterminate; if the abstract idea is instead a determinable with its specific angles left unassigned, the alleged contradiction dissolves and Berkeley's *Principles* Introduction §13 objection misses its target. **Qualification.** The rescue is not free, since a non-imagistic determinable is not an idea in Locke's own official sense, so the dispute ends by exposing the ideational theory of meaning itself — the presupposition both men share and neither examines.

### Exam link

- **2025 Q4(c), 15 marks** — "Explain Berkeley's doctrine of nominalism and his refutation of Abstract ideas." The refutation cannot be explained without the doctrine refuted; this session is the first half of that answer.
- **2022 Q4(c), 15 marks** — nominal essence is part of "the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology".
- Any question on Locke's account of language or classification is answered from §§1–3.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                                     | Correction                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Confusing nominal with real essence                      | Nominal is the idea we made and use; real is the internal constitution we do not know     |
| Calling Locke a Platonic realist about universals        | He is a <b>conceptualist</b> : universals are creatures of the understanding              |
| Reporting the triangle as Berkeley's example             | It is <b>Locke's own</b> , quoted back at him at <i>Principles</i> Intro §13              |
| Treating abstraction as obviously absurd                 | The determinable reading is a serious defence; grade it                                   |
| Forgetting that abstraction is the base of immaterialism | Berkeley's "matter" is an abstract general idea; kill abstraction and matter goes with it |

### Revision notes

- All existents particular; general words need general ideas; ideas made general by abstraction.
- Abstraction = separation from time, place and concomitants → **general representative**.
- Nominal essence = abstract idea annexed to the name; real essence = unknown internal constitution.
- Locke is a **conceptualist**; universals "concern only signs" (III.iii.11).
- IV.vii.9: the general triangle is "all and none" and "imperfect, that cannot exist".

- Best reply: **partial, not contradictory** — determinable versus determinate.
- Four presuppositions: ideational meaning · imagistic ideas · possible subtraction · one idea per word.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — LOCKE III: ABSTRACTION AND ESSENCE

```

ALL EXISTENTS ARE PARTICULAR (III.iii.1) BUT WORDS ARE GENERAL
|
v
WORDS ARE GENERAL BY SIGNIFYING GENERAL IDEAS (III.iii.6)
|
v
ABSTRACTION: strip time, place, concomitants -> GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE
|
+--> NOMINAL ESSENCE: the abstract idea annexed to the name (known)
+--> REAL ESSENCE: internal constitution producing properties (unknown)
|
v
CONCEPTUALISM: universals are "inventions and creatures of the understanding"
|
v
THE TRIANGLE (IV.vii.9): "all and none"; "imperfect, that cannot exist"
|
+--> BERKELEY quotes it verbatim at Principles Intro Sec.13
+--> LOCKE'S BEST REPLY: partial, NOT contradictory (determinable)
+--> PRICE: the abstract idea stops being imagistic
|
v
VERDICT: Berkeley beats imagistic Locke, loses to determinable Locke; the real
casualty is the IDEATIONAL THEORY OF MEANING
TRAP: nominal vs real | Platonic misreading | triangle attributed to Berkeley
ANSWER LINE: classification is our workmanship, not nature's dictation

```

## SESSION 5 — LOCKE IV: PRIMARY AND SECONDARY QUALITIES AND THE UNKNOWN SUBSTRATUM

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Locke separates the features a body really has whatever anyone thinks — its solidity, size, shape, motion and number — from the features that are only its power to make us see colours, hear sounds or feel warmth; and behind both he supposes a support he admits he cannot describe.

**Technical definition:** Locke's doctrine of qualities distinguishes **primary qualities**, which are inseparable from body and whose ideas **resemble** them, from **secondary qualities**, which are powers grounded in primary-quality configurations to produce sensations in us and whose ideas resemble nothing in the

object; both are borne by a supposed **substratum** of which we have "no positive idea" — the famous "something, I know not what" of *Essay* II.xxiii.2.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's distinction between primary and secondary qualities is not a claim about which perceptions are pleasant but a claim about which properties do **explanatory work**: solidity, extension, figure, motion and number are the properties a corpuscular physics must attribute to any body however small, while colour and warmth are powers relative to a perceiver — and it is because Locke adds to this defensible distinction a further **resemblance** thesis, and beneath it an admittedly unknown substratum, that Berkeley finds two targets rather than one.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **primary qualities** — solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number
- **secondary qualities** — colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold
- **powers** — the exact word for secondary qualities
- **resemblance thesis** — ideas of primary qualities resemble; ideas of secondary qualities do not
- **inseparability test** — every fragment of a body retains the primary qualities
- **substratum** — "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" (II.xxiii.2)

**How to use them:** give the list, then the **basis** of the distinction (inseparability plus explanatory role), then the resemblance thesis **separately**, because the resemblance thesis is what Berkeley refutes and the explanatory distinction is what survives him.

## Plain-language visual — divide the sugar cube

TAKE A CUBE OF SUGAR AND CUT IT IN HALF. AGAIN. AND AGAIN.

+-----+

| Every piece, however small, still has: |

| SOLIDITY   EXTENSION   FIGURE   MOTION OR REST   NUMBER |

| -> these are PRIMARY QUALITIES: inseparable from body itself |

+-----+

| But its SWEETNESS is not "in" the fragment the way its shape is. |

| Sweetness is the POWER of that shape-and-texture arrangement to |

| produce a taste in a creature with a tongue like ours. |

| -> COLOUR, SOUND, TASTE, SMELL, WARMTH are SECONDARY |

+-----+

|

AND UNDERNEATH? Locke says: something must SUPPORT these qualities.

But when he looks for it he finds no idea at all -

only "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities".

**In simple words:** the test is not "can I sense it?" but "would a body still have it if I sliced it to invisibility?". Shape survives the slicing; sweetness does not, because sweetness was always a relation to a taster. The substratum question is different again: it asks what **has** the shape — and Locke's honest answer is that he does not know.

| Remember first    | Meaning                                                        |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary           | inseparable from body; enter physical explanation              |
| Secondary         | <b>powers</b> in the object to produce sensations in us        |
| Resemblance       | primary-quality ideas resemble; secondary-quality ideas do not |
| Substratum        | supposed support of co-occurring qualities                     |
| "I know not what" | its <b>nature</b> is unknown; its existence is not denied      |
| Not idealism      | Locke never says the qualities are all in the mind             |

**One-line memory:** primary qualities **explain**; secondary qualities are **powers**; the substratum is a **posit**, not an observation.

### **VISUAL — the two-quality table, the two claims, and the two attacks they invite**

#### THE TABLE

|                              |                                 |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| =====                        |                                 |
| PRIMARY QUALITIES            | SECONDARY QUALITIES             |
| solidity, extension, figure, | colour, sound, taste, smell,    |
| motion/rest, number          | warmth/cold                     |
| really IN the object         | POWERS in the object to produce |
|                              | sensations in us                |
| our ideas of them RESEMBLE   | our ideas do NOT resemble       |
| the qualities themselves     | anything in the object          |
| inseparable from body: every | depend on the perceiver's       |
| fragment retains them        | sense-organs                    |
| =====                        |                                 |

CLAIM A: an EXPLANATORY claim  
(which properties a physics  
must attribute to bodies)

CLAIM B: a RESEMBLANCE claim  
(ideas of the first group  
picture their causes)

#### BERKELEY'S TWO ATTACKS

- 1 PARITY (Principles Sec.9-15): every  
relativity argument used against secondary  
qualities - variation with observer, organ,  
medium - applies to primary ones too:  
apparent size with distance, motion with  
frame, shape with angle

```
| 2 LIKENESS (Sec.8): "an idea can be like
| nothing but an idea"
v
WHAT SURVIVES: the explanatory distinction, restated as
measurable-structural versus response-dependent properties -
which is why physics still uses it and Locke's version does not.
=====
BENEATH BOTH GROUPS: THE SUBSTRATUM
+-----+
| We meet clusters that regularly go together - yellow + heavy + |
| malleable = "gold" - and SUPPOSE a support for them. |
| Essay II.xxiii.2: "a supposition of he knows not what support of |
| such qualities." |
| LOCKE DENIES KNOWLEDGE OF ITS NATURE, NOT ITS EXISTENCE. |
| Berkeley's move: an unknowable support is an ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEA |
| (being + supporting), so if abstraction fails, "matter" is not |
| mysterious but MEANINGLESS. |
+-----+
```

⚠ **Caption.** Separating Claim A from Claim B is the single highest-value move in the 2024 answer. Berkeley destroys Claim B and merely embarrasses Claim A; a script that treats them as one claim cannot explain why the distinction survives in modern science.

1. The lists, and the basis of the division

| Primary qualities                                          | Secondary qualities                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number        | Colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold             |
| Really <i>in</i> the object                                | <b>Powers</b> in the object to produce sensations in us |
| Our ideas of them <b>resemble</b> the qualities themselves | Our ideas do <b>not</b> resemble anything in the object |
| Inseparable from body — every fragment retains them        | Depend on the perceiver's sense-organs                  |

✓ **Basis:** primary qualities are those that *any* body must have no matter how small; they are objective in the sense of entering the explanation of what bodies do. Secondary qualities are **relational** — the result of primary-quality configurations *acting on* our sense-organs.

2. The word that keeps the doctrine accurate

⚠ Secondary qualities are **powers**, not illusions and not "things in the mind". The sugar really does have the power to taste sweet to us; what it does not have is a sweetness resembling our sensation. Writing "secondary qualities are subjective" without the word *power* is the most common way of misstating Locke in this item.

### 3. Real essence, again — the link to Session 4

- ✓ Behind the primary qualities lies the **real essence**, the arrangement of insensible corpuscles that produces all observable properties. We know *that* things have internal constitutions; we do not know *what* they are.
- ⚠️ So Locke's physics-friendly distinction is combined with a confession of ignorance about the very level at which the explanation would have to be completed. That combination is the honest shape of his empiricism, and it is what makes him vulnerable rather than incoherent.

### 4. The substratum — stated exactly, and defended fairly

- ✓ We experience clusters of qualities that regularly go together — yellow, heavy, malleable, soluble in aqua regia — and suppose there is an underlying **substratum** that *supports* them.
- ✓ We have **no positive idea** of what this substratum is: it is "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" (*Essay* II.xxiii.2).
- ⚠️ **Locke does not deny that substance exists.** He denies that we can know its nature. This is representative realism with an epistemic ceiling, not idealism and not scepticism.
- ⚠️ **The fairest defence:** the substratum is an **explanatory posit** tied to the stability of qualities and kinds, not a claimed object of intuition. Qualities do not float; something is qualified. Berkeley's reply is that "support" here is a dead metaphor borrowed from pillars and floors, and that stripping the metaphor leaves the abstract idea of *being in general* plus the relative notion of *supporting* — which is precisely an abstract general idea.

### 5. The two attacks, and the exact adjudication

| Attack                                                        | Berkeley's form                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Verdict                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Parity</b> ( <i>Principles</i> §§9–15; <i>Dialogues</i> I) | Extension cannot be conceived without colour; motion and rest are relative to the observer; figure is inseparable from extension. Every relativity argument Locke accepts for secondary qualities applies to primary ones | ⚠️ <b>Objection to the objection:</b> perceptual relativity does not entail mind-dependence. That a thing looks different from different positions is exactly what one should expect of a mind- <i>independent</i> thing with a real shape                                            |
| <b>Likeness</b> ( <i>Principles</i> §8)                       | "An idea can be like nothing but an idea"; and if the supposed originals are unperceivable, no comparison is even possible, so a resemblance-claim we could never in principle check is empty                             | ✓ <b>This lands.</b> The qualitative resemblance thesis is indefensible. <b>But</b> structural or mathematical resemblance — isomorphism — does not require qualitative likeness: a map resembles terrain without being terrain-coloured. That is the standard modern rescue of Locke |

⚠️ **Executable verdict:** the distinction survives as a distinction between *measurable-structural* and *response-dependent* properties, but not as Locke's **resemblance** thesis. Locke's mistake was to make the distinction depend on a picture rather than on explanatory role; reconstructed as a claim about which properties enter physical explanation, it is defensible — which is why it survives in science while Locke's version does not.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** Locke's quality distinction contains two separable theses, and only one of them is destroyed by Berkeley. **Named evidence.** *Essay* II.viii lists solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest and number as inseparable from body while classifying colour, sound, taste, smell and warmth as powers to produce sensations, and adds that ideas of the first group resemble their qualities while ideas of the second resemble nothing; II.xxiii.2 then places both on a substratum that is only "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities". **Analysis.** Berkeley's parity argument at *Principles* §§9–15 shows only that primary qualities are perceptually relative, which a realist can accept, whereas the likeness principle at §8 shows that a resemblance between an idea and an unperceivable quality could never be checked and is therefore empty — so the explanatory thesis stands and the pictorial thesis falls. **Qualification.** What survives is a distinction between measurable-structural and response-dependent properties defended by isomorphism rather than by likeness, and Locke's substratum survives only as an explanatory posit whose intelligibility depends on the doctrine of abstraction that Berkeley attacks first.

### Exam link

- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** — "Is rejection of Locke's notion of primary qualities instrumental in Berkeley's leaning towards idealism?" This session is the first limb; the answer is **yes, but through the likeness principle and the anti-abstraction argument, not through relativity alone**.
- **2021 Q1(c), 10 marks** — Berkeley's "immediately perceived" presupposes the collapse of the quality distinction.
- Any "substance" question in this item begins from §4.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                           | Correction                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Secondary qualities are illusions"            | They are <b>powers</b> ; the object really has them, relative to perceivers                  |
| "Locke denies substance"                       | He denies <b>knowledge of its nature</b> ; he affirms its existence                          |
| Treating relativity as decisive                | Relativity alone does not entail mind-dependence; the likeness principle is the sharp weapon |
| Merging the explanatory and resemblance claims | Only the resemblance claim falls; say which                                                  |
| Quoting the substratum phrase loosely          | The words are "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" (II.xxiii.2)    |

### Revision notes

- Primary: solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number — inseparable, explanatory.
- Secondary: colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold — **powers** relative to perceivers.
- Resemblance thesis: primary ideas resemble; secondary ideas do not.
- Substratum II.xxiii.2: "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities".
- Berkeley: parity (§§9–15) plus likeness (§8); likeness is the one that lands.

- Survives: measurable-structural versus response-dependent, defended by isomorphism.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — LOCKE IV: QUALITIES AND SUBSTANCE

```

QUALITY = THE POWER IN A BODY TO PRODUCE AN IDEA IN US
|
+--> PRIMARY: solidity, extension, figure, motion/rest, number
| inseparable from body; ideas RESEMBLE; enter physical explanation
+--> SECONDARY: colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth/cold
 POWERS grounded in primary configurations; ideas resemble nothing
|
v
TWO SEPARABLE THESES: (A) EXPLANATORY DIVISION (B) RESEMBLANCE PICTURE
|
+--> BERKELEY PARITY (Sec.9-15) attacks A -> answered: relativity is
| what a real shape would produce
+--> BERKELEY LIKENESS (Sec.8) attacks B -> LANDS: an unverifiable
 resemblance is empty; rescue = isomorphism, not likeness
|
v
BENEATH BOTH: SUBSTRATUM = "a supposition of he knows not what support of
such qualities" (II.xxiii.2) - NATURE unknown, EXISTENCE not denied
|
v
BERKELEY'S NEXT STEP: an unknowable support is an ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEA;
kill abstraction and "matter" becomes meaningless, not mysterious
TRAP: illusions | denial of substance | relativity as decisive
ANSWER LINE: the explanatory distinction survives; the picture does not

```

## SESSION 6 — LOCKE V: PERSONAL IDENTITY AS CONTINUITY OF CONSCIOUSNESS, THE OBJECTIONS, AND THE DEMONSTRATIVE PROOF OF GOD

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** For Locke, what makes you the same person as the child in an old photograph is not the same body and not the same soul but the fact that your present consciousness can reach back and claim that child's experiences as your own — which is why "person" is fundamentally a term about responsibility.

**Technical definition:** Locke's account of personal identity, added at *Essay* II.xxvii in the second edition of 1694, distinguishes the identity of a **substance**, a **human animal** and a **person**; personal identity consists in the extension of **consciousness** backwards over past thoughts and actions, with **memory** as its chief vehicle and evidence, making "person" a **forensic** term tied to accountability.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's most radical move on personal identity is not the appeal to memory but the prior separation of three questions that his predecessors ran together: the identity of a substance, of a living human organism, and of a person are three different identities with three different criteria, and once "person" is defined as "a thinking intelligent being that can consider itself as itself in different times and places", identity of person must be settled by consciousness — which is why the doctrine is best judged as a theory of accountability rather than as a theory of metaphysical substance.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **person, human animal (man), substance** — three identities, three criteria
- **continuity of consciousness** — the constitutive notion
- **memory as vehicle and evidence** — not as the definition
- **appropriation** — consciousness claiming a past act as its own
- **forensic** — Locke's own word for the concept of person
- **prince and cobbler** — the case that separates person from man
- **circularity (Butler, Reid)** and the **Brave Officer** (Reid)

**How to use them:** state the three-fold distinction first, then define person, then the criterion, then the prince-and-cobbler case, then the two objections and Locke's repair. A script that opens with "memory theory" and never separates person from man has already lost the structure of the answer.

### Plain-language visual — three questions people confuse

THE SAME WHAT?

|                         |                                  |  |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------|--|
| +-----+-----+           |                                  |  |
| SAME SUBSTANCE          | is it the same underlying stuff, |  |
|                         | material or immaterial?          |  |
| +-----+-----+           |                                  |  |
| SAME MAN (human animal) | is it the same continuing living |  |
|                         | organism?                        |  |
| +-----+-----+           |                                  |  |
| SAME PERSON             | can this present consciousness   |  |
|                         | APPROPRIATE that past thought or |  |
|                         | action as its own?               |  |
| +-----+-----+           |                                  |  |

THE PRINCE AND THE COBBLER

prince's consciousness --transferred into--> cobbler's body

RESULT: the PERSON who wakes up is the prince

the MAN who wakes up is the cobbler

THEREFORE: personal identity is neither bodily nor substantial identity.

**In simple words:** Locke's question is not "what am I made of?" but "whose deeds are mine?". Punishment, praise, promise-keeping and reward all presuppose that a present self can own a past act. Locke builds the concept of person to fit that job, and then follows the criterion wherever it leads — even into a thought-experiment where a prince wakes up in a cobbler's body.

| Remember first | Meaning                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Person         | "a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places" (II.xxvii.9) |
| Criterion      | extension of consciousness, not sameness of substance                                                                                                                  |
| Memory         | the vehicle and evidence of that extension                                                                                                                             |
| Forensic       | a term of law and morals, tied to accountability                                                                                                                       |
| 1694           | the chapter is a <b>second-edition addition</b>                                                                                                                        |

**One-line memory:** same substance, same animal and same person are **three** questions; only the third is settled by consciousness.

## VISUAL — the criterion, the two objections and the repair

### LOCKE'S CRITERION

Essay II.xxvii

=====

PRESENT CONSCIOUSNESS -----appropriates-----> PAST THOUGHT OR ACTION

|

+--- as far as this reaches, the PERSON extends -----+

MEMORY is how the reach is exercised and evidenced, but the  
CONSTITUTIVE notion is CONSCIOUSNESS. Reducing the theory to bare  
memory INTENSIFIES the circularity problem - do not do it.

=====

|

OBJECTION 1 - CIRCULARITY (Butler, Reid)

+-----+

| I can remember only MY OWN experiences. So "genuine memory" |

| already presupposes identity. If identity is then DEFINED by |

| memory, the definition is circular. |

+-----+

REPLY: distinguish the CONSTITUTIVE criterion (consciousness) from the  
EVIDENTIAL criterion (memory). Contested - the objector answers that  
"consciousness of X as mine" smuggles the same ownership back in.

|

OBJECTION 2 - TRANSITIVITY: REID'S BRAVE OFFICER

+-----+

| BOY (flogged at school) <--remembers-- YOUNG OFFICER |

| YOUNG OFFICER <--remembers-- OLD GENERAL |

| BOY <--NOT remembered by-- OLD GENERAL |

|                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| So: boy = officer, officer = general, but boy $\neq$ general.<br>Identity is transitive. Locke's criterion is not. |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

+-----+  
 REPAIR: OVERLAPPING CHAINS of consciousness - identity is the  
 ANCESTRAL of direct appropriation. Locke's criterion is thereby saved  
 at the price of no longer being a simple episodic-memory criterion.

|  
 OBJECTION 3 - GAPS: dreamless sleep, anaesthesia, amnesia  
 REPLY: continuous CAPACITY for appropriation, not constant recollection.  
 RESIDUAL: capacity-talk strains the account, and Locke concedes that  
 whether the same substance persists through a gap is unknowable to us.  
 =====

⚠ **Caption.** The examiner's word in 2021 Q1(d) is "**Examine**". That directive requires the doctrine **and** the test; an answer that states the criterion and stops has performed only half the instruction.

### 1. The definition, and why it is built the way it is

✅ A person is "**a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places**" (*Essay* II.xxvii.9). Self-reflexive awareness is written into the definition, so the identity condition must be an awareness-condition.

### 2. The three identities, kept apart

- ✅ **Same substance** — sameness of the material or immaterial bearer. Unknowable to us in the immaterial case.
- ✅ **Same man (human animal)** — participation in one continued life of the same organised living body.
- ✅ **Same person** — the extension of present consciousness over past thoughts and actions.
- ⚠ Locke's radicalism is precisely this **separation**. It is what allows him to say that the same man may be two persons, or the same person two men — and it is what makes a purely bodily or purely substantial criterion unavailable.

### 3. Consciousness, memory and appropriation

- ✅ Personal identity extends as far as present consciousness can **appropriate** a past thought or action as its own.
- ✅ **Memory is the chief mechanism and evidence** of this backward extension, but the constitutive notion is consciousness. ⚠ Reducing the theory to bare memory intensifies the circularity problem, so the precise formulation is itself a defensive move.
- ✅ **Forensic concept:** Locke ties personal identity to **moral responsibility** — we are accountable only for acts we can appropriate. "Person" belongs, in his own words, to law and to reward and punishment.

#### 4. The prince and the cobbler

✓ If the prince's consciousness, carrying the memory of his princely life, enters and informs the cobbler's body, then the **person** is the prince while the **man** is the cobbler. The case is decisive because it shows in one stroke that personal identity is neither bodily nor substantial identity, and it does so without requiring any metaphysical commitment about souls.

#### 5. The objections, and the honest verdict

| Objection                                       | Source                 | Force                                                                                                                                                                                         | Best reply                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Circularity</b>                              | Butler, Reid (18th c.) | Memory presupposes identity — I can remember only <i>my own</i> experiences, so identity must already be settled before memory can confirm it                                                 | Distinguish the <b>constitutive</b> criterion (consciousness) from the <b>evidential</b> criterion (memory). ? Contested: "consciousness of it <i>as mine</i> " may reintroduce ownership |
| <b>Transitivity failure — the Brave Officer</b> | Reid (1710–1796)       | Boy → young officer → old general. The officer remembers the boy; the general remembers the officer but not the boy. By the criterion, general ≠ boy, yet officer = boy and general = officer | <b>Overlapping chains:</b> identity is the ancestral of direct appropriation. ⚠ Saves transitivity, but abandons the simple episodic reading                                              |
| <b>Gaps in consciousness</b>                    | Critics generally      | Dreamless sleep and amnesia would interrupt the person                                                                                                                                        | Continuous <b>capacity</b> for appropriation rather than constant recollection. ⚠ This strains the account, and Locke himself admits the substance question is undecidable for us         |

⚠ **Executable verdict:** Locke's theory is best defended as a **repaired psychological-continuity** account, and on that reading it survives Reid; but the repaired version is no longer the simple memory criterion the textbooks attribute to him, and the circularity charge remains genuinely open. Saying exactly this is what "examine" requires.

#### 6. Locke on God — the demonstrative proof

- ✓ God's existence is known by **demonstration** — not by intuition and not by sensitive knowledge. The chain runs: something cannot come from nothing; I exist and I know that I exist with intuitive certainty; therefore there has existed from eternity a most powerful and most knowing being.
- ⚠ It is a **cosmological-style** argument conducted inside an empiricist framework, and it is consistent with Locke's own ladder: God is reached at the **second** degree of knowledge, above the external world and below self-knowledge.
- ⚠ **The exposed premise** is the causal principle that nothing comes from nothing — precisely the principle Hume will later refuse to certify, because there is no impression of causal necessity. This is the cleanest single link between Locke's God and Hume's scepticism, and it belongs in any comparative answer on God in this item.

- ✗ There is no innate idea of God for Locke; that was one of the candidates Book I dismissed.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** Locke's theory of personal identity is a theory of accountability, and it survives its classic objections only in a repaired form. **Named evidence.** *Essay* II.xxvii, added in the second edition of 1694, defines a person as a thinking intelligent being that can consider itself as itself in different times and places, separates the identity of person from that of man and of substance, illustrates the separation with the prince and the cobbler, and calls "person" a forensic term. **Analysis.** Butler's and Reid's circularity charge and Reid's Brave Officer case both attack the criterion where it is stated as bare episodic memory, so the defensible Lockean position must locate identity in consciousness rather than recollection and must define it through overlapping chains of appropriation rather than through single acts of remembering. **Qualification.** That repair preserves transitivity at the cost of the simple memory criterion, and it does not silence the circularity objection, since consciousness *of a past act as mine* may already presuppose the identity it is meant to constitute — which is why the honest verdict grades the theory as forensically indispensable and metaphysically incomplete.

### Exam link

- **2021 Q1(d), 10 marks** — "Examine the concept of personal identity by Locke." Doctrine from §§1–4, objections from §5, and a graded verdict.
- **2020 Q2(a), 20 marks** — Locke's account is the position Hume dismantles; the contrast belongs in the first paragraph of that answer.
- Locke's God in §6 supplies the comparative material for any "God in the empiricists" question.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                          | Correction                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Calling it simply "the memory theory"         | The constitutive notion is <b>consciousness</b> ; memory is vehicle and evidence |
| Ignoring the person/man/substance distinction | It is the structural core of the chapter                                         |
| Dating the doctrine to 1690                   | II.xxvii is a <b>1694</b> second-edition addition                                |
| Reporting objections without a reply          | "Examine" requires the repair and a verdict                                      |
| Saying Locke has an innate idea of God        | Book I explicitly denies it; the proof is <b>demonstrative</b>                   |

### Revision notes

- Person defined at II.xxvii.9; chapter added 1694.
- Three identities: substance · man (living organism) · person.
- Criterion: extension of consciousness; memory is vehicle and evidence; appropriation is the key verb.
- Prince and cobbler: person follows consciousness, man follows organism.
- Objections: Butler/Reid circularity; Reid's Brave Officer transitivity; gaps.
- Repair: overlapping chains; capacity rather than constant recollection.

- God: demonstrative, cosmological-style; rests on the causal principle Hume later attacks.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — LOCKE V: SELF AND GOD

```

QUESTION: WHAT MAKES THE PERSON AT T2 THE SAME AS THE PERSON AT T1?
|
v
SEPARATE THREE IDENTITIES: SUBSTANCE | MAN (organism) | PERSON
|
v
PERSON (II.xxvii.9, added 1694) = thinking intelligent being that can
consider itself as itself in different times and places
|
v
CRITERION: present consciousness APPROPRIATES a past act
memory = vehicle and evidence, NOT the definition
FORENSIC: the concept is built for accountability
|
+--> PRINCE AND COBBLER: person = prince, man = cobbler
|
+--> BUTLER/REID CIRCULARITY -> constitutive vs evidential (contested)
+--> REID'S BRAVE OFFICER -> OVERLAPPING CHAINS restore transitivity
+--> GAPS -> continuous CAPACITY, not constant recollection
|
v
GOD: demonstrative, not intuitive or sensitive; nothing comes from nothing;
I exist -> an eternal most powerful and most knowing being
EXPOSED PREMISE: the causal principle Hume will refuse to certify
TRAP: "memory theory" | 1690 dating | omitting the objections
ANSWER LINE: forensically indispensable, metaphysically incomplete

```

## SESSION 7 — BERKELEY I: THE DESTRUCTION OF ABSTRACTION AND THE NOMINALIST REPLACEMENT

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Berkeley says you cannot form an idea of a colourless extension or of a triangle that is no particular triangle; what you can do is take one perfectly ordinary particular idea and let it stand for all the others of its kind — and once you accept that, the word "matter" turns out to name nothing at all.

**Technical definition:** Berkeley's **nominalism** denies the existence of abstract general ideas while affirming general **ideas**: an idea becomes general not by being stripped of determinations but "by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort" (*Principles*, Introduction §12), and since Locke's *material substance in general* is precisely an abstract general idea, the failure of abstraction makes "matter" a **meaningless expression** rather than an unknown thing.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Berkeley's nominalism is not a side-issue in his system but its foundation: he places the attack on abstract general ideas in the **Introduction** to the *Principles*, before a single word about matter, because his immaterialism is a corollary of it — Locke's "material substance in general" is the abstract idea of being conjoined with the relative notion of supporting, so if no such idea can be framed, matter is not a mysterious unknown but an expression without content.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **separation of what can exist apart** — the abstraction Berkeley allows
- **abstraction proper** — separating what cannot exist apart; this he denies
- **"all and none of these at once"** — Locke's triangle, quoted at Intro §13
- **"made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort"** (Intro §12)
- **selective attention** — the positive mechanism
- **language does not always stand for ideas** (Intro §§19–20)
- **matter as an abstract general idea** — the metaphysical payload

**How to use them:** run the seven numbered steps, then give the positive replacement with the geometer example, then the payload — and only then move to *to be is to be perceived*. The order matters: abstraction first, matter second.

### Plain-language visual — two kinds of "separating"

| WHAT BERKELEY ADMITS HE CAN DO | WHAT HE SAYS NOBODY CAN DO |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------|
| +-----+                        | +-----+                    |
| Imagine a HAND without the     | Imagine EXTENSION with no  |
| rest of the body.              | colour at all.             |
| Imagine a HEADLESS torso.      | Imagine MOTION with no     |
|                                | determinate speed.         |
| These parts COULD exist        | Imagine A MAN who has no   |
| apart, so the separation is    | stature and no complexion. |
| legitimate.                    | These CANNOT exist apart,  |
|                                | so the "idea" is empty.    |
| +-----+                        | +-----+                    |
| \                              | /                          |
| v                              | v                          |

AND LOCKE'S TRIANGLE IS THE WORST CASE:

"neither oblique nor rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but all and none of these at once." -> that is not an idea; it is a contradiction.

**In simple words:** Berkeley is not saying imagination is weak. He is saying that "separating" only makes sense where the separated items could exist on their own. You can picture a hand by itself because hands can be severed; you cannot picture extension by itself because nothing extended is colourless. Then he

turns to Locke's own sentence and lets it do the work.

| Remember first | Meaning                                                       |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Allowed        | separating parts that could exist apart                       |
| Denied         | separating what cannot exist apart                            |
| The quotation  | Locke's triangle, at <i>Principles</i> Intro §13              |
| Replacement    | a determinate particular idea <b>made to stand for</b> a sort |
| Mechanism      | selective attention to a respect of resemblance               |
| Payload        | "matter" is an abstract general idea; so it means nothing     |

**One-line memory:** generality lives in the **use of a sign**, not in a stripped-down picture.

### **VISUAL — the seven steps, the replacement and the payload**

BERKELEY'S DEMOLITION, NUMBERED                      Principles, Introduction 6-25

- =====
- 1 I concede I can imagine particular things I have perceived, and compound and divide such ideas - a hand without a body, a headless torso. This is SEPARATION OF PARTS THAT COULD EXIST APART.
  - 2 But abstraction PROPER requires separating what CANNOT exist apart: extension without any colour; motion without a determinate speed; "man" without any determinate stature or complexion.
  - 3 Locke's own triangle - neither equilateral nor scalene, yet all and none at once - is SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY; no such idea can be framed. (Berkeley quotes the passage VERBATIM at Intro Sec.13.)
  - 4 THEREFORE there are no abstract general ideas.
  - 5 POSITIVE REPLACEMENT: an idea is general not by being abstract but "by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort" (Intro Sec.12). A determinate particular idea, SELECTIVELY ATTENDED TO, does duty for a class: the geometer draws THIS black inch-long line and proves a theorem about ALL lines.
  - 6 COROLLARY AGAINST THE WHOLE TRADITION: words do not always stand for ideas at all; language also raises passion, prompts action and disposes the mind (Intro Sec.19-20).
  - 7 METAPHYSICAL PAYLOAD: Locke's MATERIAL SUBSTANCE IN GENERAL and SUBSTRATUM are precisely abstract general ideas - the abstract idea of BEING plus the relative notion of SUPPORTING. If abstraction is impossible, "matter" is not a mysterious unknown but a MEANINGLESS EXPRESSION. Immaterialism therefore RESTS ON the nominalism.

=====

|  
THE COUNTER-PRESSURE YOU MUST ALSO KNOW

+-----+

|                                                                    |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| If a particular idea stands for a class, what fixes WHICH respect  |  |
| it is attended to under? The resemblance-respect looks like the    |  |
| abstract idea returning under another name. This is the standard   |  |
| modern rejoinder, and it makes the dispute far less one-sided than |  |
| textbooks suggest.                                                 |  |
| +-----+                                                            |  |

⚠ **Caption.** Step 6 is the step almost no script contains, and it is a genuine anticipation of the later Wittgensteinian point that meaning is use. Flagging it converts a descriptive answer on nominalism into one that shows the argument's reach.

### 1. What the doctrine denies, and what it does not

- ✓ Berkeley denies **abstract general ideas**; he does not deny **general ideas**, general words, or general knowledge. Geometry proceeds perfectly well on his account.
- ✗ He is therefore not a "nominalist" in the crude sense of denying that classification is possible. His nominalism is about the **vehicle** of generality, not about its legitimacy.

### 2. The argument's dependence on the imagistic reading

⚠ Step 3 works because Locke's idea is treated as an **image**, and an image cannot be indeterminate. Locke's best reply — that the abstract idea is **partial** rather than **contradictory**, with the angles left undetermined instead of contradictorily assigned — was set out in Session 4. Berkeley's argument therefore proves what it proves **only against imagistic Locke**, and a first-class answer says so.

### 3. The positive account, and its unpaid bill

- ✓ **Selective attention:** I consider *this* determinate triangle only in respect of its three-sidedness, and my proof is valid for all triangles because nothing in it depends on the features I ignored.
- ? **The bill:** what fixes the respect? If the answer is "a further idea of the respect", the abstract idea has returned; if the answer is "a practice of use", Berkeley has moved beyond the theory of ideas altogether — which is exactly the direction step 6 points.

### 4. Why this is the base of immaterialism

✓ The order of Berkeley's own book is the order of his argument. Abstraction is destroyed in the Introduction so that in §§1–4 the identification of a sensible thing with a collection of ideas cannot be resisted by appeal to an abstract "something" underlying them. **Berkeley's immaterialism rests on his nominalism, not the reverse** — say this sentence in the 2025 answer and the whole structure becomes visible.

### HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** Berkeley's refutation of abstract ideas is the foundation of his immaterialism rather than an independent thesis about psychology. **Named evidence.** In the Introduction to the *Principles* he concedes the separation of parts that could exist apart, denies the separation of what cannot, quotes Locke's own admission at IV.vii.9 that the general triangle is "all and none" of the determinate

triangles, replaces abstraction with a determinate idea "made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort" at §12, and observes at §§19–20 that words need not stand for ideas at all. **Analysis.** Because Locke's *material substance in general* is compounded from the abstract idea of being and the relative notion of supporting, the collapse of abstraction converts matter from an unknown thing into an expression with no content, which is why the attack precedes the metaphysics in Berkeley's own order of exposition. **Qualification.** The argument succeeds only against an imagistic conception of ideas, and Berkeley's positive account owes an explanation of what fixes the respect under which a particular idea represents its class — so the durable casualty is the ideational theory of meaning shared by both men rather than generality itself.

### Exam link

- **2025 Q4(c), 15 marks** — "Explain Berkeley's doctrine of nominalism and his refutation of Abstract ideas." This session is the answer; Session 4 supplies the doctrine refuted.
- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** — the payload in §4 is why rejecting Locke's primary qualities is *instrumental* rather than merely contributory.
- **2018 Q3(a), 20 marks** — "Mind and its ideas alone are real" is unintelligible without the anti-abstraction ground clearing.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                      | Correction                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Berkeley denies general ideas"           | He denies <b>abstract</b> general ideas; particular ideas made to stand for a sort are general |
| Presenting nominalism after immaterialism | Berkeley's own order is the reverse, and the order is the argument                             |
| Giving the conclusion without the steps   | "Explain" demands the derivation, not a synonym for the conclusion                             |
| Omitting §§19–20                          | The claim that words need not stand for ideas is the argument's longest reach                  |
| Treating the refutation as complete       | The determinable reading of Locke and the respect-of-representation problem both survive       |

### Revision notes

- Allowed: separating parts that could exist apart. Denied: separating what cannot.
- Locke's triangle quoted verbatim at *Principles* Intro §13.
- Replacement at §12: a particular idea "made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort".
- Mechanism: selective attention; example: the geometer's inch-long line.
- §§19–20: words also raise passion, prompt action, dispose the mind.
- Payload: matter = abstract idea of being + relative notion of supporting → meaningless.
- Counter-pressure: what fixes the respect of representation?

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — BERKELEY I: ANTI-ABSTRACTION

LOCKE: GENERALITY LIVES IN A STRIPPED-DOWN ABSTRACT IDEA

|

v

BERKELEY, PRINCIPLES INTRODUCTION Sec.6-25

1 separation of parts that COULD exist apart: ALLOWED

2 separation of what CANNOT exist apart: IMPOSSIBLE

3 Locke's triangle "all and none" is self-contradictory (quoted, Sec.13)

4 therefore NO abstract general ideas

5 REPLACEMENT (Sec.12): a determinate particular idea "made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort"

- selective attention; the geometer's inch-long line

6 words do not always stand for ideas at all (Sec.19-20)

7 PAYLOAD: matter = abstract idea of BEING + relative notion of SUPPORTING

-> not unknown but MEANINGLESS

|

v

IMMATERIALISM RESTS ON NOMINALISM, NOT THE REVERSE

|

+--> LIMIT 1: works only against IMAGISTIC Locke (determinable reply)

+--> LIMIT 2: what fixes the RESPECT of representation?

TRAP: "denies general ideas" | wrong order | conclusion without derivation

ANSWER LINE: generality lives in the use of a sign, not in a stripped picture

## SESSION 8 — BERKELEY II: THE FIVE ARGUMENTS FOR IMMATERIALISM AND WHAT "TO BE IS TO BE PERCEIVED" CLAIMS

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Berkeley holds that a chair is nothing more than the collection of sights, sounds and feels you get from it, that for such things existing just *is* being perceived, and that the extra "matter" philosophers place behind them is an empty word — so the chair is exactly as real as it ever was, and only the philosopher's ghost has been removed.

**Technical definition:** Berkeley's **immaterialism** or **subjective idealism** holds that sensible things are collections of ideas immediately perceived, that for sensible things *to be is to be perceived* (*esse est percipi*) (*Principles* §3), and that "material substance" — an unperceiving, unperceivable substratum — is an incoherent abstraction; reality consists of **spirits** and their **ideas**.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

*To be is to be perceived* is a conclusion, not a slogan, and the difference between an average and a first-class answer on Berkeley is whether the five supporting arguments are named: the **semantic** identification of sensible things with ideas, the **likeness** principle, the **parity** collapse of the quality

distinction, the **Master Argument** about conceiving the unconceived, and the argument from **continuity** to an infinite spirit — five arguments where the average script asserts one Latin tag.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **sensible things** — things immediately perceived by sense
- **collection of ideas** — the identification that carries the system
- **to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)** — *Principles* §3, Berkeley's own Latin
- **likeness principle** — "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" (§8)
- **parity argument** — relativity applies equally to primary qualities (§§9–15)
- **Master Argument** — conceive an unconceived body (§§22–23)
- **absolute existence without relation to being perceived** — the phrase Berkeley calls unintelligible

**How to use them:** name all five arguments, give the presupposition of each, and give the strongest objection to at least two. That structure alone answers 2018 Q3(a) and 2021 Q1(c) and half of 2024 Q2(a).

## Plain-language visual — what is actually being denied

| THE ORDINARY PERSON'S PICTURE                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | THE PHILOSOPHER'S ADDITION |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| +-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | +-----+                    |
| I see the table.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Behind the table there     |
| I feel the table.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | is MATTER: an unthinking,  |
| The table is there.                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | unperceivable substance    |
| +-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | that "supports" the        |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | qualities and causes my    |
| BERKELEY KEEPS ALL OF THIS <-----                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ideas.                     |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | +-----+                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | BERKELEY DELETES ONLY THIS |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                            |
| RESULT: "The table I write on, I say, exists; that is, I see and feel it." ( <i>Principles</i> Sec.3) The table is not less real. The philosopher's ghost behind it is gone - and with it, Berkeley claims, the scepticism that ghost generated. |                            |

**In simple words:** Berkeley thinks the materialist invented an unknowable world and then worried about whether we can reach it. Remove the unknowable world and the worry disappears. This is why he calls himself the defender of common sense and calls the materialist the sceptic — a reversal that must be stated in any answer or the position will be misdescribed.

| Remember first          | Meaning                                                  |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Sensible thing          | what is <b>immediately</b> perceived by sense            |
| The identification      | an apple, a stone, a tree, a book = collections of ideas |
| <i>Esse est percipi</i> | for <b>sensible things</b> , existence = being perceived |
| What is denied          | matter as an unperceiving substratum                     |

| Remember first      | Meaning                                                        |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| What is kept        | tables, chairs, the order of nature, science, other minds, God |
| Direction of attack | the materialist is the sceptic, not Berkeley                   |

**One-line memory:** Berkeley deletes the **substratum**, never the **table**.

## **VISUAL — five arguments, five presuppositions, three objections**

### ARGUMENT 1 - SEMANTIC / ANALYTIC

Principles Sec.1-4

- 1 The objects of human knowledge are ideas: (a) imprinted on the senses, (b) perceived by attending to the passions and operations of the mind, (c) formed by memory and imagination.
- 2 "Sensible things" MEANS things immediately perceived by sense.
- 3 An apple, a stone, a tree, a book are nothing but collections of such immediately perceived ideas.
- 4 It is impossible that ideas should exist unperceived - their esse is percipi.
- 5 THEREFORE for sensible things esse est percipi, and "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is unintelligible.

PRESUPPOSITION: step 3 is a DEFINITION, not a discovery. Grant it and immaterialism follows in four lines; deny it and nothing follows.

### ARGUMENT 2 - THE LIKENESS PRINCIPLE

Principles Sec.8

- 1 Locke says ideas of primary qualities RESEMBLE qualities in bodies.
- 2 But "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" - a colour or figure can be like nothing but another colour or figure.
- 3 If the supposed originals are unperceivable, no comparison with them is even possible; a resemblance we could never check is empty.
- 4 THEREFORE the representative-realist resemblance is unintelligible.

PRESUPPOSITION: resemblance requires comparability by a perceiver.

OBJECTION: structural/mathematical resemblance (ISOMORPHISM) needs no qualitative likeness - a map resembles terrain without being terrain-coloured. This is the standard modern rescue of Locke.

### ARGUMENT 3 - PARITY

Principles Sec.9-15; Dial. I

Every relativity argument Locke accepts for secondary qualities - variation with observer, with organ, with medium - applies equally to primary ones: apparent size with distance, motion with frame of reference, shape with angle. So ALL qualities are ideas, and nothing is left for "material substance" to be.

PRESUPPOSITION: perceptual relativity entails mind-dependence.

OBJECTION: it does not - looking different from different positions is what one should expect of a mind-INDEPENDENT thing with a real shape.

-----  
ARGUMENT 4 - THE MASTER ARGUMENT

Principles Sec.22-23

- 1 Conceive one extended movable body existing unconceived, and Berkeley concedes materialism.
  - 2 You reply: I easily conceive a tree standing alone in a park with nobody by.
  - 3 But in doing so YOU are conceiving it - you have framed ideas in your own mind and have not conceived the tree UNCONCEIVED at all.
  - 4 THEREFORE the supposition is self-refuting.
- PRESUPPOSITION (the fatal one): that conceiving "X existing unconceived" requires the act of conceiving to be part of the CONTENT conceived.
- OBJECTION (Russell; refined by Prior and Gallois): a SCOPE or use-mention confusion. What is inconceivable is "I conceive of X THAT IT IS NOT CONCEIVED BY ME"; what is required is only "I conceive THAT X exists and is not conceived" - perfectly coherent, exactly as I can think ABOUT an unthought-of number.
- BERKELEY'S BEST REPLY: for him there is no object over and above the idea, so the distinction the objector needs is precisely what is at issue - the argument begs the question only if immaterialism is already false.
- 

ARGUMENT 5 - GOD AS GUARANTOR OF CONTINUITY Sec.6, 30-33, 48; Dial. II

- 1 Ideas are passive and inert; they cannot cause anything.
  - 2 Yet the ideas of sense come to me INVOLUNTARILY, in steady order.
  - 3 Whatever produces them must be an ACTIVE SPIRIT whose power and wisdom exceed mine.
  - 4 THEREFORE God. The "laws of nature" are the settled grammar of God's language of ideas: regularities are SIGNS, not causes.
  - 5 THEREFORE objects persist unperceived by finite minds because they are always perceived by the infinite Mind.
- PRESUPPOSITION: only spirits are active causes (Berkeley's voluntarism).
- OBJECTION: this makes "existence unperceived" a hypothesis about an unobserved being - the very move Berkeley forbade Locke.
- REPLY: spirit is known not by IDEA but by NOTION (Sec.27, 89, 140) - an asymmetry critics call ad hoc, but which Berkeley holds is forced, since an idea, being passive, could never picture activity.

⚠ **Caption.** Naming the five arguments — semantic, likeness, parity, master, continuity — is the single largest available differentiator on this sub-topic. Add one presupposition and one objection and the answer is already in the top band.

## 1. The formula, stated with its scope

- ✓ For **sensible things**, existence is being perceived: "The table I write on, I say, exists; that is, I see and feel it" (*Principles* §3).
- ⚠ The scope restriction is not a technicality. *Esse est percipi* applies to **sensible ideas**; spirits are active perceivers and willers, and are known by **notion**, not as passive perceived ideas.

- ⚠️ **Provenance mark:** the expanded formula "to be is to be perceived or to perceive" (*esse est percipi aut percipere*) is a **later commentators' expansion** to accommodate spirits. Do not present it as Berkeley's quoted Latin.

## 2. What immaterialism deletes and what it keeps

- ❌ Deleted: **material substance** — an unthinking, unperceiving, unperceivable substratum.
- ✅ Kept: tables and chairs (as orderly collections of ideas), the distinction between real things and imagination, natural law, science, other minds, and God.
- ✅ **Reality = minds (spirits) + their ideas.** This is subjective idealism, also called immaterialism.

## 3. Berkeley "saves" common sense — the reversal

- ✅ Berkeley insists he is not denying the reality of tables and chairs; he denies only the **philosopher's fiction** of matter. The ordinary person never believed in Locke's veil of perception: they believe they perceive things *directly* — and so does Berkeley.
- ✅ He accuses the **materialists** of undermining common sense by positing an unknowable world behind appearances, and of thereby manufacturing the sceptical problem they then fail to solve.
- ⚠️ **Assessment worth including:** the defence is strong about *objects* and weaker about *causes*, because the plain man does think fire heats water, whereas for Berkeley fire is a sign and God is the cause.

## 4. Illusion, science and other minds — the four objections he must answer

| Objection                                               | Berkeley's answer                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What distinguishes reality from imagination?            | Ideas of sense are involuntary, vivid, coherent and law-governed; ideas of imagination are comparatively voluntary and irregular                                               |
| What about illusions — the bent oar, the distant tower? | The presented idea genuinely exists; error lies in the <b>judgment</b> about which further ideas will follow, not in the existence of what is perceived                        |
| Does this destroy science?                              | No. Natural laws describe stable sequences in God's language of ideas and support prediction; what is denied is material efficient power behind them, not empirical regularity |
| Does this leave only me — solipsism?                    | Other finite spirits are not perceived as ideas but inferred by <b>analogy</b> from purposive signs and behaviour, while God explains the comprehensive involuntary order      |

⚠️ Honest residual: this blocks crude solipsism, but knowledge of other spirits and of God is **less immediate** than awareness of one's own activity and of the ideas presented.

## 5. Why Berkeley is an anti-sceptic

- ✅ He claims to **refute** scepticism: it is the materialist who produces doubt by positing an unknowable world behind ideas. By identifying reality with ideas immediately perceived, Berkeley claims certainty, and God guarantees continuity.
- ✅ His idealism is therefore **dogmatic theistic idealism** — a metaphysical thesis about what exists, not a doubt about knowledge.

- **✗** Never classify Berkeley as a sceptic, and never write that he denies the external world.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — **claim** → **named evidence** → **analysis** → **qualification**

**Claim.** Berkeley establishes that minds and their ideas alone are real by five distinct arguments, only one of which is the notorious challenge about conceiving an unconceived object. **Named evidence.**

*Principles* §§1–4 identify sensible things with collections of immediately perceived ideas; §8 denies that an idea can be like anything but an idea; §§9–15 extend Locke's own relativity arguments from secondary to primary qualities; §§22–23 challenge the reader to conceive an unconceived body; and §§6, 30–33 and 48 infer an infinite active spirit from the involuntary, law-governed order of sense.

**Analysis.** The arguments are not redundant: the semantic argument fixes what a sensible thing is, the likeness principle removes the representative relation, the parity argument removes the last quality that might have belonged to matter, the Master Argument blocks the intuitive rejoinder, and the continuity argument supplies the positive metaphysics that replaces the deleted substratum.

**Qualification.** Each rests on a contestable premise — the identification in §3 is a definition, relativity does not entail mind-dependence, and the Master Argument arguably confuses conceiving *that* an object is unconceived with conceiving *of* it as unconceived — so the system is best judged as internally economical rather than as demonstratively established.

### Exam link

- **2021 Q1(c), 10 marks** — "Sensible things are those only which are immediately perceived by sense." Argument 1 is the direct answer; the word **immediately** is the hinge.
- **2018 Q3(a), 20 marks** — "How does Berkeley establish that Mind and its ideas alone are real?" is answered by naming all five arguments before turning to Moore and Russell.
- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** — arguments 2 and 3 are the "rejection of Locke's primary qualities" limb.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                                                              | Correction                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Berkeley denies the external world"                                              | He denies <b>matter</b> ; the world of tables and chairs remains, as ideas sustained by God |
| Quoting <i>esse est percipi aut percipere</i> as Berkeley's Latin                 | The expansion is a later commentators' gloss; §3 gives only <i>esse est percipi</i>         |
| Reducing the case to the Master Argument                                          | It is the weakest of the five and the easiest to answer                                     |
| Answering "immediately perceived" without contrasting Locke's mediated perception | The whole point of <i>immediately</i> is the denial of the veil                             |
| Calling him a sceptic                                                             | He is an <b>anti-sceptic</b> who blames scepticism on the materialist                       |

### Revision notes

- Five arguments: semantic (§§1–4) · likeness (§8) · parity (§§9–15) · master (§§22–23) · continuity (§§6, 30–33, 48).
- *Esse est percipi* at §3, scoped to **sensible things**; spirits are known by notion.

- Deletes matter; keeps objects, science, other minds, God.
- Reality distinguished from imagination by involuntariness, vividness, coherence and law.
- Illusion concerns judgment, not the existence of the presented idea.
- Anti-sceptic: the materialist invents the unknowable world.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — BERKELEY II: THE FIVE ARGUMENTS

SENSIBLE THING = WHAT IS IMMEDIATELY PERCEIVED BY SENSE

|

v

FIVE ARGUMENTS FOR "MIND AND ITS IDEAS ALONE ARE REAL"

1 SEMANTIC (Sec.1-4): objects = collections of ideas -> esse est percipi

2 LIKENESS (Sec.8): an idea can be like only an idea

3 PARITY (Sec.9-15): relativity hits primary qualities too

4 MASTER (Sec.22-23): you cannot conceive the unconceived

5 CONTINUITY (Sec.6, 30-33, 48): involuntary order -> infinite active spirit

|

+-> PRESUPPOSITIONS: definition | comparability | relativity=dependence |  
| content of conceiving | only spirits act

+-> OBJECTIONS: isomorphism rescues Locke | relativity is what a real  
shape produces | scope/use-mention confusion (Russell, Prior,

Gallois)

|

v

DELETES: material substratum    KEEPS: tables, science, other minds, God

REALITY vs IMAGINATION: involuntary, vivid, coherent, law-governed

ILLUSION: error is in JUDGMENT, not in the existence of the idea

|

v

ANTI-SCEPTIC: the materialist invented the unknowable world

TRAP: "denies the world" | percipere as Berkeley's Latin | master-argument-only

ANSWER LINE: Berkeley deletes the substratum, never the table

## SESSION 9 — BERKELEY III: SPIRITS, NOTIONS, GOD, CONTINUITY, AND THE MOORE, RUSSELL AND HEGEL COMPARISONS

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Having deleted matter, Berkeley must say what is left: active minds, which he calls spirits, and the ideas they perceive; we know minds not by having a picture of them but by a different kind of awareness he calls a notion, and the biggest mind of all — God — is what keeps the world running when nobody human is looking.

**Technical definition:** Berkeley's positive ontology consists of **spirits** — active, indivisible substances that perceive and will — and their **ideas**, which are passive and inert; spirits are known by **notion** rather than by idea (*Principles* §§27, 89, 140), and the infinite spirit, **God**, causes the involuntary order of sense and secures the continued existence of sensible things unperceived by finite minds.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Berkeley's God is not a piece of piety appended to an epistemology but the load-bearing member of it: having argued that ideas are passive and that only spirits act, he must explain why the ideas of sense arrive involuntarily and in a settled order, and the infinite spirit that supplies both the cause and the continuity is doing exactly the work Locke's matter had done — which is why the strongest criticism of immaterialism is not that it is impious but that it replaces an unknowable **substance** with an unperceivable **spirit**.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **spirit** — active, perceiving, willing; the only substance Berkeley retains
- **notion** — the non-idea awareness by which spirit is known
- **passivity of ideas** — the premise that forces an external cause
- **language of nature** — laws are the settled grammar of signs, not causes
- **continuity** — unperceived things persist because God perceives them
- **subjective idealism** versus **absolute idealism**
- **act-object distinction** — Moore's line of attack
- **logical construction** — Russell's alternative

**How to use them:** derive God from the passivity of ideas rather than asserting him; then take the two comparisons the papers actually demand — Moore and Russell in 2018, Hegel in 2024 — and treat them as matched axes, not as separate essays.

### Plain-language visual — why Berkeley cannot stop at "ideas"

STEP 1 Look at what you perceive right now. You did not choose it.  
You cannot make the window vanish by willing it.

STEP 2 Ideas are PASSIVE - a colour does not do anything.  
So an idea cannot be the cause of another idea.

STEP 3 Something ACTIVE must be producing them.  
Not me: I did not choose them, and I cannot stop them.

STEP 4 Only SPIRITS are active. So an OTHER spirit is producing them,  
one whose power and wisdom exceed mine.

STEP 5 That spirit is GOD - and because he always perceives, the tree  
in the quad does not blink out when you leave the quadrangle.

NOTE THE COST: Berkeley now knows something he cannot have an idea of.  
He answers: spirit is known by NOTION, not by idea, because an idea is passive and could never picture an activity. Critics call this ad hoc.

**In simple words:** Berkeley's argument for God is an argument from **involuntariness plus order**. It is not "somebody must be watching or things would vanish" as a nervous afterthought; it is the only available cause once ideas are declared inert. Present it as a derivation and the answer looks structural rather than devotional.

| Remember first | Meaning                                                               |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ideas          | passive, inert, cannot cause                                          |
| Spirits        | active; perceive and will; not perceived as ideas                     |
| Notion         | the awareness we have of spirit, of relations and of activity         |
| God            | the infinite spirit; cause of sense-ideas and guarantor of continuity |
| Laws of nature | the settled grammar of a divine language; <b>signs</b> , not causes   |
| Other minds    | inferred by analogy from purposive signs                              |

**One-line memory:** ideas are **inert**, so the order of nature needs an **agent** — and that agent, not matter, is what sustains the unperceived.

 **VISUAL — the ontology, the two comparisons and the exact contrasts**

|                                                                      |                            |                                |  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------|--|
| BERKELEY'S FINAL ONTOLOGY                                            |                            |                                |  |
| =====                                                                |                            |                                |  |
| SPIRITS (active substances)                                          |                            | IDEAS (passive)                |  |
| +-----+                                                              |                            | +-----+                        |  |
| GOD infinite spirit                                                  |                            | ideas of SENSE                 |  |
| +-----+                                                              |                            | involuntary,                   |  |
|                                                                      |                            | vivid,coherent,                |  |
| sustains continuity                                                  |                            | law-governed                   |  |
| v                                                                    |                            | +-----+                        |  |
| +-----+                                                              |                            | +-----+                        |  |
| FINITE SPIRITS                                                       |                            | ideas of                       |  |
| known: my own by                                                     |                            | IMAGINATION                    |  |
| inner awareness;                                                     |                            | voluntary,                     |  |
| others by ANALOGY                                                    |                            | faint,irregular                |  |
| +-----+                                                              |                            | +-----+                        |  |
| KNOWN BY: notion (Sec.27, 89, 140)                                   |                            | KNOWN BY: immediate perception |  |
| =====                                                                |                            |                                |  |
| COMPARISON A - THE 2018 QUESTION: MOORE AND RUSSELL AGAINST BERKELEY |                            |                                |  |
| +-----+                                                              |                            |                                |  |
| AXIS                                                                 | MOORE                      | RUSSELL                        |  |
| +-----+                                                              |                            |                                |  |
| Core attack                                                          | the idealist conflates the | idealism mistakes              |  |
|                                                                      | ACT of awareness with its  | the data of sense              |  |
|                                                                      | OBJECT: awareness of blue  | for the whole of               |  |

|                    |                                              |                                   |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
|                    | is not identical with blue                   | the object                        |
| Positive result    | DIRECT REALISM: the object                   | LOGICAL CONSTRUCTION: objects are |
|                    | is presented THROUGH but                     |                                   |
|                    | not CONSTITUTED BY                           | inferred or built                 |
|                    | consciousness                                | from sense-data,                  |
|                    | (transparency of sensation)                  | perspectives and                  |
|                    |                                              | relations                         |
| Method             | analysis of common-sense                     | analysis into                     |
|                    | certainties                                  | structure                         |
| Shared ground      | both refuse to reduce object to act or idea  |                                   |
| The DIFFERENCE     | Moore keeps the ordinary object and calls it |                                   |
| the examiner wants | directly known; Russell REPLACES it with a   |                                   |
|                    | construction and keeps only STRUCTURAL       |                                   |
|                    | objectivity                                  |                                   |

+-----+-----+-----+

=====

#### COMPARISON B - THE 2024 QUESTION: BERKELEY VERSUS HEGEL

| AXIS            | BERKELEY - SUBJECTIVE                        | HEGEL - ABSOLUTE    |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Basic reality   | finite spirits, God, ideas                   | self-developing     |
|                 |                                              | Absolute Spirit     |
| Why objects are | sensible existence CONSISTS                  | objectivity is a    |
| mind-dependent  | in being perceived                           | MOMENT within       |
|                 |                                              | dialectical self-   |
|                 |                                              | development         |
| Role of the     | an infinite PERCEIVER who                    | not an external     |
| divine/system   | causes and coordinates                       | perceiver           |
|                 | ideas                                        | preserving private  |
|                 |                                              | idea-collections    |
| Method          | anti-abstraction plus                        | dialectical         |
|                 | immaterialist argument                       | development through |
|                 |                                              | determinate         |
|                 |                                              | negation            |
| VERDICT         | both reject self-subsisting matter as final  |                     |
|                 | reality, but theistic SUBJECTIVE idealism is |                     |
|                 | NOT an early version of OBJECTIVE/ABSOLUTE   |                     |
|                 | idealism - the difference is in KIND         |                     |

+-----+-----+-----+

⚠ **Caption.** Both comparisons are examiner-set, and both are lost by scripts that write two separate mini-essays. Use matched axes: attack, positive result, method, verdict.

### 1. Spirit — the one substance that survives

- ✓ The perceiving mind is a **real active substance**: it is the perceiver, not a bundle of perceptions. Berkeley **keeps the self**, which is exactly where Hume will refuse to follow him.

- ✓ We have no **idea** of spirit, because ideas are passive and the mind is active; we have a **notion** of it — a direct awareness that does not fit the impression-to-idea schema.
- ⚠ **The asymmetry and its defence:** critics call the notion doctrine ad hoc. Berkeley's reply is that it is *forced*: an idea, being passive, could never picture an activity, so if activity is known at all it must be known otherwise. The reply is principled; whether it is sufficient is ? genuinely disputed.

## 2. God — derived, not assumed

1. Ideas are passive and inert; they cannot cause anything.
  2. Yet the ideas of sense come to me involuntarily and in a steady, regular order.
  3. Whatever produces them must be an active spirit, and one whose power and wisdom exceed mine.
  4. Therefore God, and the "laws of nature" are the settled grammar of God's **language** of ideas — regularities are **signs**, not causes.
  5. Therefore objects persist unperceived by finite minds because they are always perceived by the infinite Mind.
- ✓ "Does the tree exist when no one perceives it?" — **Yes**, because God always perceives it.
  - ✓ Berkeley thus uses empiricist premises to **defend theism**: the material world is replaced by God's continual ideation, and his idealism is **theocentric**, not sceptical.
  - ⚠ **The strongest objection:** this makes "existence unperceived" into a hypothesis about an unobserved being — the very move Berkeley forbade Locke. His answer is the notion doctrine of §1.

## 3. Common sense, and the honest limit of the defence

- ✓ Berkeley claims to be closer to common sense than the representative realist, because the plain man believes he perceives things directly and never believed in a veil.
- ⚠ The claim is strong about **objects** and weaker about **causes**: the plain man also believes that fire heats water, whereas for Berkeley fire is a sign and God is the agent. Concede this and the answer reads as an assessment rather than a defence brief.
- ⚠ **The Johnson anecdote** — kicking a stone with "I refute it thus!" — is **reception, not refutation**. Berkeley never denied that the stone is felt; the kick confirms an idea of resistance, which is precisely what he says a stone is.

## 4. Moore and Russell — the 2018 comparison, decided

- ✓ **Moore** attacks the idealist inference from "experienced" to "dependent on experience" by distinguishing an **act of awareness** from its **object**: the awareness of blue is not identical with blue. His transparency argument supports **direct realism** — the object is presented *through*, but not constituted by, consciousness.
- ✓ **Russell** also rejects Berkeleyan idealism, but develops an **analytical reconstruction**: ordinary physical objects are inferred or logically constructed from sense-data, perspectives and relations rather than accepted through Moorean direct realism.
- ⚠ **Common ground:** both resist reducing object to act or idea. **The difference:** Moore stresses the act-object distinction and common-sense directness; Russell stresses logical construction and structural objectivity — so Moore *defends* the ordinary object while Russell *replaces* it.

## 5. Berkeley and Hegel — the 2024 comparison, decided

- ✓ For Berkeley, reality is ideas in **finite and divine minds**; for Hegel, reality is the self-development of **Absolute Spirit** through dialectic.
- ✓ Berkeley's idealism is **subjective** — mind-dependence of sensible existence; Hegel's is **objective or absolute** — Mind developing itself as the world's substance.
- ⚠ **The verdict sentence:** they agree only in refusing independently self-subsisting matter as final reality. Berkeley's God is an infinite **perceiver** who coordinates idea-collections; Hegel's Absolute is not an external perceiver at all. Calling Berkeley "an early Hegel" is a category error, and 2024 Q2(a) is testing exactly that discrimination.

### HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** Berkeley's God is a structural requirement of immaterialism rather than a devotional addition, and this is what fixes both the strength and the vulnerability of his idealism. **Named evidence.** *Principles* §§6, 30–33 and 48 argue that ideas are passive, that the ideas of sense arrive involuntarily in a settled order, and that only an active spirit of greater power and wisdom can produce them, while §§27, 89 and 140 introduce the doctrine that spirits are known by notion rather than by idea. **Analysis.** Since the infinite spirit both causes sense-ideas and secures their continuity when finite minds look away, God performs precisely the two functions Locke had assigned to matter, so immaterialism should be assessed as a substitution of explanatory posits rather than as their elimination. **Qualification.** The substitution is not obviously an advance, because an unperceivable spirit known only by notion is exposed to the same complaint Berkeley levelled at an unperceivable substratum — although his reply that a passive idea could never picture an activity gives the asymmetry a principled and not merely convenient basis.

### Exam link

- **2018 Q3(a), 20 marks** — §§1–2 establish "Mind and its ideas alone are real"; §4 supplies both reactions **and** the difference between them, which is the third limb of that question.
- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** — §5 is the second limb, and it must be answered on matched axes.
- **2021 Q1(c), 10 marks** — §3 supplies the common-sense framing that makes "immediately perceived" more than a slogan.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                         | Correction                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Treating God as an afterthought              | God is derived from the passivity of ideas; present the derivation                          |
| Saying Berkeley has an <i>idea</i> of spirit | He has a <b>notion</b> ; ideas are passive and cannot picture activity                      |
| Using Johnson's stone as a refutation        | It is reception; the felt resistance is exactly what Berkeley calls the stone               |
| Writing Moore and Russell as one reaction    | 2018 explicitly asks for the <b>difference</b> : direct realism versus logical construction |

| Trap                            | Correction                                                     |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Calling Berkeley an early Hegel | Subjective versus absolute idealism differ in kind, not degree |

## Revision notes

- Ontology: spirits (active) + ideas (passive); no third category.
- Spirit known by **notion** (§§27, 89, 140), not by idea.
- God derived: inert ideas + involuntary order → an active infinite spirit; continuity follows.
- Laws of nature = the settled grammar of a divine language; signs, not causes.
- Other minds by analogy; solipsism blocked but knowledge of spirits is less immediate.
- Moore: act-object distinction, direct realism. Russell: logical construction, structural objectivity.
- Berkeley subjective and theistic; Hegel absolute and dialectical — different in kind.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — BERKELEY III: SPIRITS, GOD AND THE COMPARISONS

```

IDEAS ARE PASSIVE -> THEY CANNOT CAUSE ANYTHING
 |
 v
SENSE-IDEAS ARRIVE INVOLUNTARILY AND IN SETTLED ORDER
 |
 v
ONLY SPIRITS ACT -> AN INFINITE SPIRIT PRODUCES THEM = GOD
 |
 +--> CONTINUITY: the unperceived persists because God perceives it
 +--> LAWS OF NATURE = the grammar of a divine language; SIGNS not causes
 +--> SPIRIT KNOWN BY NOTION (Sec.27, 89, 140), not by idea
 +--> OTHER MINDS by ANALOGY from purposive signs
 |
 v
OBJECTION: an unperceivable spirit repeats the fault of an unknowable substratum
REPLY: a passive idea could never picture activity - the asymmetry is forced
 |
 v
2018 COMPARISON: MOORE act-object distinction -> DIRECT REALISM
 RUSSELL sense-data + relations -> LOGICAL CONSTRUCTION
 difference: Moore DEFENDS the object, Russell REPLACES it
2024 COMPARISON: BERKELEY subjective + theistic vs HEGEL absolute + dialectical
 different in KIND, not degree
TRAP: God as afterthought | "idea of spirit" | Johnson's stone as refutation
ANSWER LINE: God does matter's old job, which is the real question about the
system

```

## SESSION 10 — HUME I: IMPRESSIONS AND IDEAS, THE COPY PRINCIPLE, ASSOCIATION, THE FORK, AND THE DISSOLUTION OF SUBSTANCE

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Hume divides everything in the mind into vivid originals and faint copies, insists that every simple copy must have had an original, sorts all enquiry into two boxes — what can be worked out by thinking alone and what must be found out by experience — and then asks which box "substance" belongs in. It fits neither.

**Technical definition:** Hume's science of human nature divides all **perceptions** into forceful **impressions** and their faint **ideas**, states the **copy principle** that every simple idea derives from a corresponding simple impression, explains the mind's connections by three principles of **association** — resemblance, contiguity and cause and effect — and demarcates enquiry by the **fork** between **relations of ideas** and **matters of fact**, with the consequence that "substance", lacking any source impression, is a **fiction of the imagination**.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Hume's forensic method has a single form that he applies to substance, to the self and to causal power alike: name the alleged idea, demand the impression from which it is copied, and if none can be produced, reclassify the idea as a fiction produced by the imagination — so the destructive results are not separate discoveries but one instrument used three times, and the instrument itself, the copy principle, is an empirical generalisation Hume admits admits an exception.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **perceptions** → **impressions and ideas** — the exhaustive division
- **force and vivacity** — the criterion distinguishing them
- **copy principle** — every simple idea copies a simple impression
- **missing shade of blue** — the exception Hume concedes
- **association: resemblance, contiguity, cause and effect**
- **relations of ideas** versus **matters of fact** — the fork
- **"commit it then to the flames"** — *Enquiry* XII, aimed at divinity or school metaphysics
- **fiction of the imagination** — the verdict on substance

**How to use them:** state the division and the copy principle, then apply the test to substance in three lines, then set out the fork as a table, and finally concede the missing shade **before** the examiner can use it against you.

### Plain-language visual — the test, run once

| THE HUMEAN AUDIT                                    | applied here to "SUBSTANCE" |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| +-----+                                             |                             |
| Q1 What idea are you claiming to have?              |                             |
| -> "an underlying something that HAS the qualities" |                             |

```

+-----+
| Q2 From which IMPRESSION was that idea copied? |
| -> Look. You find yellow. Heavy. Malleable. Shiny. |
| You never find the HAVER, only the HAD. |
+-----+
| Q3 No impression? Then what produced the idea? |
| -> The imagination. Qualities that constantly go together |
| are grouped, and a "support" is INVENTED for them. |
+-----+
| VERDICT: "substance" is a FICTION OF THE IMAGINATION - |
| and this applies to MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance |
| alike. Berkeley kept spirit; Hume does not. |
+-----+

```

**In simple words:** Hume does not argue that there is no substance. He argues that you cannot say what you mean by it, because you cannot produce the experience the word was supposed to name. That is a claim about **content**, and keeping it a claim about content rather than about existence is what protects the answer from the standard misreading.

| Remember first     | Meaning                                                      |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Impressions        | vivid, forceful originals: sensations, passions, emotions    |
| Ideas              | faint copies used in thinking and remembering                |
| Copy principle     | every <b>simple</b> idea derives from a simple impression    |
| Association        | resemblance · contiguity in time or place · cause and effect |
| Relations of ideas | a priori, necessary; denial is self-contradictory            |
| Matters of fact    | a posteriori, contingent; the contrary is always conceivable |

**One-line memory:** no impression, no legitimate idea — and no third box beyond the fork.

## VISUAL — the architecture of the mind, the fork and the first casualty

ALL CONTENTS OF THE MIND = PERCEPTIONS

=====

| IMPRESSIONS (force and vivacity) |        | IDEAS (faint copies) |
|----------------------------------|--------|----------------------|
| +-----+                          |        | +-----+              |
| of SENSATION: colours,           | copied | memory: retains      |
| sounds, tastes, pains            | -----> | order and vivacity   |
| of REFLECTION: passions,         |        | imagination: free    |
| emotions, the felt               |        | to separate and      |
| determination of the mind        |        | recombine            |
| +-----+                          |        | +-----+              |

COPY PRINCIPLE: every SIMPLE idea derives from a corresponding SIMPLE impression. COMPLEX ideas may be new combinations (a golden mountain).

CONCEDED EXCEPTION - THE MISSING SHADE OF BLUE (Treatise I.i.1; Enquiry II):  
a man acquainted with every shade of blue but one, shown the spectrum with  
a gap, can form the idea of the missing shade from imagination alone.

Hume calls the instance "so singular" that he will not alter the maxim.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR MARKS: it shows the copy principle is an EMPIRICAL  
GENERALISATION, not an analytic truth - so the demolitions of substance,  
self and necessary connexion rest on a premise Hume admits has an exception.

HUME'S AVAILABLE REPLY: the shade is generated by INTERPOLATION BETWEEN  
impressions actually had, so the principle's SPIRIT survives its LETTER.

=====

THE THREE PRINCIPLES OF ASSOCIATION - the mind's gentle force

RESEMBLANCE | CONTIGUITY in time/place | CAUSE AND EFFECT

These are not logical relations; they are the psychological mechanism  
that later explains BOTH the fiction of the self AND causal belief.

=====

HUME'S FORK

|                              |                               |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| +-----+-----+                |                               |
| RELATIONS OF IDEAS           | MATTERS OF FACT               |
| known a priori, by thought   | known a posteriori, require   |
| alone                        | experience                    |
| necessary and certain;       | contingent; the contrary is   |
| denial is self-contradictory | always conceivable            |
| "2+2=4"; "a bachelor is      | "the sun will rise tomorrow"; |
| unmarried"                   | "fire causes heat"            |
| do not depend on what exists | depend on how the world       |
| in the world                 | actually is                   |
| +-----+-----+                |                               |

CONSEQUENCE: anything that is NEITHER is meaningless - "commit it then  
to the flames" (Enquiry XII), aimed at divinity or school metaphysics.

ANCESTRY: this is the direct ancestor of the logical positivists'  
verification principle - a link worth one clause, not a paragraph.

=====

FIRST CASUALTY: SUBSTANCE

no impression of a substrate -> "substance" is a FICTION OF THE  
IMAGINATION -> both MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance dissolve ->  
an object is a stable BUNDLE of co-occurring qualities

⚠ **Caption.** The fork must be drawn as a table, because the 2018 question is decided by placing two sentences correctly inside it. Do not let it become prose.

## 1. The division, and the criterion

- ✓ All contents of the mind are **perceptions**, dividing into **impressions** — vivid, forceful, original experiences (sensations, passions) — and **ideas**, their faint copies used in memory and imagination.
- ⚠ The criterion is **force and vivacity**, a difference of degree. Hume accepts that in fever or madness the difference can blur; the classification is a working psychology, not a definition by essence.

## 2. The copy principle, stated with its exception

- ✓ Every simple **idea** traces back to a corresponding simple **impression**. If no source impression can be located, the alleged idea is suspect, obscure or fictitious.
- ⚠ Note the precision that protects marks: for Hume the failure makes the idea **fictitious or obscure**, not automatically "meaningless" in the later logical-positivist sense. The stronger reading belongs to Topic 07.
- ? **The missing shade of blue** (*Treatise* I.i.1; *Enquiry* II) is Hume's own conceded counter-example, and he calls it "so singular" that it is not worth altering his general maxim for it.
- ⚠ **Why it earns marks:** deploying it converts a descriptive answer into a critical one, because it shows the copy principle to be an empirical generalisation rather than an analytic truth. **Hume's available reply:** the missing shade is generated by interpolation *between* impressions actually had, so the principle's spirit survives even if its letter does not.

## 3. Association — the engine of everything that follows

- ✓ Ideas are ordinarily connected through **resemblance, contiguity in time or place, and cause and effect**.
- ⚠ Association is a **psychological** mechanism, not a logical relation, and it is decisive later: resemblance and causation together produce the fiction of a unified self, and repeated conjunction produces the felt determination that Hume identifies as the source of the idea of necessary connexion. Naming association early makes the later sessions look inevitable rather than surprising.

## 4. The fork, and the 2018 question it decides

| Relations of ideas                               | Matters of fact                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Known a priori; discoverable by thought alone    | Known a posteriori; require experience                     |
| Necessary, certain; denial is self-contradictory | Contingent; the contrary is always conceivable             |
| Examples: "2+2=4"; "a bachelor is unmarried"     | Examples: "the sun will rise tomorrow"; "fire causes heat" |
| Do not depend on what exists in the world        | Depend on how the world actually is                        |

- ✓ **Consequence:** any proposition that is neither a relation of ideas nor a matter of fact is meaningless — "commit it then to the flames" (*Enquiry* XII).
- ⚠ **The 2018 answer in one line:** "2+2=4" is a relation of ideas whose denial is contradictory; "the sun will rise tomorrow" is a matter of fact whose denial remains perfectly conceivable. They are **not** of the same necessity, and saying they are equally probable is the error the question is designed to catch.
- ? **The reflexive objection:** is the fork itself a relation of ideas or a matter of fact? If neither, it refutes itself. Hume's available answer is that it is a clarification of the meanings of terms — a meta-level classification rather than a first-order claim.

## 5. Substance dissolved

- ✓ Apply the copy principle: do we have an impression of substance? **No**. We have only impressions of particular qualities — redness, hardness, sweetness — never of an underlying substrate.

- ✓ Therefore "substance" is a **fiction of the imagination**: the mind's habit of grouping constantly conjoined qualities and *inventing* a support for them.
- ✓ Hume dissolves **both** material and spiritual substance; neither has a corresponding impression. **This is exactly where he passes Berkeley**, who retained spirit.
- ✓ **Qualities without substance**: there are only bundles of perceptions — qualities that co-occur regularly. The "object" is a stable bundle; the "self" is a flowing bundle.

## 6. The external world — constancy, coherence and the double-existence theory

- ✓ Sense presents only **interrupted** perceptions; it does not present an object existing continuously while unperceived, or existing distinctly beyond perception.
- ✓ **Constancy** of similar perceptions and **coherence** in their reappearance lead the imagination to feign continued objects and to smooth perceptual gaps.
- ✓ Philosophers respond with a **double-existence theory** — private perceptions representing independently existing objects — but this cannot be verified, because all comparison remains within perceptions.
- ⚠ **The crucial qualification**: Hume does **not** demonstrate that no external world exists. Sceptical reflection undermines the rational justification, while nature restores the unavoidable belief in bodies during ordinary life.
- ✓ This is the pattern of Humean naturalism, and it recurs in every later session: explain why a belief is psychologically inevitable **after** showing that reason cannot establish its metaphysical object.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** Hume's dissolution of substance is the first application of a single instrument rather than an independent metaphysical thesis. **Named evidence.** The *Treatise* divides perceptions into impressions and ideas by force and vivacity and states that every simple idea copies a simple impression; introspection yields impressions of redness, hardness and sweetness but never of a bearer; and the *Enquiry* classifies all enquiry as relations of ideas or matters of fact, consigning what fits neither to the flames. **Analysis.** Because the demand for a source impression is a demand about **content** rather than about existence, the conclusion is that "substance" names no clear idea and is supplied instead by the imagination's habit of grouping constantly conjoined qualities — a result that applies with equal force to Berkeley's spirit, which is why Hume's empiricism is more consistent than his predecessor's. **Qualification.** The instrument is itself an empirical generalisation to which Hume concedes the missing shade of blue as an exception, so the demolition of substance is only as secure as a maxim its author admits is not exceptionless — although interpolation between impressions actually had preserves the principle's spirit if not its letter.

## Exam link

- **2018 Q1(a), 10 marks** — "Are the two truths ... of the same necessity for Hume?" is decided entirely by §4.
- **2020 Q2(a), 20 marks** and **2021 Q1(e), 10 marks** — §§1–3 are the machinery those answers presuppose.
- Any "substance" question across the item uses §5, and any "external world" material uses §6.

## UPSC traps

| Trap                                                   | Correction                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Hume denies that anything exists"                     | He denies the <b>content</b> of the idea of substance, not the existence of perceptions |
| Treating impressions and ideas as a difference in kind | The difference is <b>force and vivacity</b> , a difference of degree                    |
| Ignoring the missing shade                             | The examiner may raise it; concede it first and supply the interpolation reply          |
| Collapsing relations of ideas into matters of fact     | This is the exact error 2018 Q1(a) is built to catch                                    |
| Saying Hume proves there is no external world          | He shows reason cannot justify the belief; nature imposes it anyway                     |

## Revision notes

- Perceptions = impressions (vivid) + ideas (faint copies); criterion is force and vivacity.
- Copy principle: every simple idea copies a simple impression; missing shade of blue is the conceded exception.
- Association: resemblance · contiguity · cause and effect — psychological, not logical.
- Fork: relations of ideas (a priori, necessary) versus matters of fact (a posteriori, contingent).
- "Commit it then to the flames" — *Enquiry* XII, aimed at divinity or school metaphysics.
- Substance: no impression → fiction of the imagination; material **and** spiritual alike.
- External world: constancy + coherence → feigned continuity; double existence unverifiable; nature restores belief.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — HUME I: THE INSTRUMENT AND ITS FIRST CASUALTY

```
ALL PERCEPTIONS = IMPRESSIONS (vivid) + IDEAS (faint copies)
 |
 v
COPY PRINCIPLE: every SIMPLE idea copies a SIMPLE impression
 CONCEDED EXCEPTION: the missing shade of blue (Treatise I.i.1; Enquiry II)
 REPLY: interpolation between impressions actually had - spirit survives
 |
 v
ASSOCIATION: RESEMBLANCE | CONTIGUITY | CAUSE AND EFFECT (psychological)
 |
 v
THE FORK
 RELATIONS OF IDEAS: a priori, necessary, denial contradictory ("2+2=4")
 MATTERS OF FACT: a posteriori, contingent, contrary conceivable
 ("the sun will rise tomorrow")
 NEITHER? -> "commit it then to the flames" (Enquiry XII)
 |
 v
APPLY TO SUBSTANCE: no impression of a bearer -> FICTION OF THE IMAGINATION
 dissolves MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance alike (Berkeley kept spirit)
```

|  
v

EXTERNAL WORLD: interrupted perceptions -> CONSTANCY + COHERENCE ->  
imagination feigns continued bodies; double existence unverifiable;  
reason cannot justify, NATURE compels  
TRAP: "nothing exists" | fork collapse | ignoring the missing shade  
ANSWER LINE: one instrument, three casualties - substance, self, necessity

## SESSION 11 — HUME II: THE BUNDLE SELF, THE APPENDIX RETRACTION, KANT'S REPLY, AND THE FAILURE OF THE PROOFS OF GOD

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** When Hume looks inside for the self he finds only a rapid succession of particular experiences and never the experiencer; so the self, like substance, becomes a collection rather than a thing — and he later admits, with unusual honesty, that he cannot say what holds the collection together.

**Technical definition:** Hume's **bundle theory** holds that the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions, which succeed each other with an inconceivable rapidity, and are in a perpetual flux and movement" (*Treatise* I.iv.6); the apparent unity is a fiction produced by **resemblance** and **causation** among perceptions, and the Appendix to the *Treatise* records Hume's own failure to explain the principle that unites them.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Hume's statement that he can never catch himself without a perception is not a report of introspective bad luck but the copy principle applied to the perceiver: if every legitimate idea must be traced to an impression, and introspection delivers only particular perceptions in flux, then the simple continuing self is a fiction of the imagination — and the fact that Hume's own Appendix confesses he cannot say what binds the bundle is the strongest evidence that the fault lies in the atomism of impressions rather than in the self.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **"I never can catch myself"** — the introspective report the 2020 paper quotes
- **bundle or collection of different perceptions** — the exact formula
- **perpetual flux** — the phrase that rules out a simple identity
- **fiction of identity** — produced by resemblance and causation
- **the Appendix retraction** — "all my hopes vanish"
- **transcendental unity of apperception** — Kant's formal condition, not an entity
- **design argument, cosmological argument, miracles** — the three fronts on God

**How to use them:** answer the self question with doctrine, then the Appendix, then Kant — in that order, because 2020 Q2(a) requires the empiricist argument to be *complete* before the reply is reported.

## Plain-language visual — looking for the looker

CLOSE YOUR EYES AND LOOK FOR YOURSELF.

```
+-----+
| You find: a twinge in the knee | the sound of a fan | the memory |
| of breakfast | irritation | a patch of red behind the eyelids |
+-----+
| You do NOT find: the one who is finding them. |
+-----+
```

|  
SO WHY DOES IT FEEL LIKE ONE CONTINUOUS "I"?

```
+-----+
| RESEMBLANCE: today's ideas resemble yesterday's memories, and |
| the imagination slides easily between them. |
| CAUSATION: each perception seems to produce the next; memory |
| links them into a chain. |
| -> The EASY TRANSITION is mistaken for an IDENTICAL OBJECT. |
+-----+
```

|  
AND THEN, IN THE APPENDIX, HUME ADMITS DEFEAT:  
"all my hopes vanish when I come to explain the principles that  
unite our successive perceptions."

**In simple words:** Hume's argument has two halves and most scripts write only the first. The first half says there is no impression of a self. The second half explains why we nevertheless believe in one. The Appendix then adds a third element that no examiner expects: Hume says the explanation does not work. Include all three and the answer is complete.

| Remember first  | Meaning                                                         |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| The report      | "I never can catch myself at any time without a perception"     |
| The thesis      | the self is a bundle in perpetual flux                          |
| The explanation | resemblance and causation produce a felt continuity             |
| The confession  | the Appendix cannot state the uniting principle                 |
| What is denied  | a <b>simple, identical self-substance</b> , not the perceptions |
| Kant's reply    | a formal condition of unified experience, not an observed ego   |

**One-line memory:** Hume finds the **perceptions** and loses the **owner** — and says so himself.

### VISUAL — the bundle, the fiction, the confession and the reply

THE ARGUMENT

Treatise I.iv.6

=====

1 COPY PRINCIPLE applied to the self: which impression is the self

copied from? It would have to be constant and invariable through the whole course of a life.

2 INTROSPECTION delivers only particular perceptions - heat, cold, light, shade, love, hatred, pain, pleasure - in perpetual flux.

3 NO constant impression is found.

4 THEREFORE the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions, which succeed each other with an inconceivable rapidity, and are in a perpetual flux and movement."

=====

BUT WHY THE ILLUSION OF UNITY?

RESEMBLANCE ---+

+--> the imagination passes SMOOTHLY along the

CAUSATION ---+ series and MISTAKES an easy transition for an identical object -> the FICTION of self

=====

THE APPENDIX RETRACTION - the page that earns marks

+-----+

| Hume cannot explain what BINDS the bundle: "all my hopes vanish |  
| when I come to explain the principles that unite our successive |  
| perceptions." |

| DIAGNOSIS: he has denied BOTH a substance AND any real connexion |  
| between distinct existences, so he has removed in advance every |  
| resource a principle of unity could have used. |

| THEREFORE the honest verdict: the failure indicts the ATOMISM OF |  
| IMPRESSIONS, not the self. |

+-----+

=====

KANT'S REPLY - the 2020 second limb, stated exactly

+-----+

| 1 Kant ACCEPTS that no impression or inner intuition reveals a |  
| simple soul-substance. He is not restoring Descartes' ego. |

| 2 He argues instead that the "I THINK" must be able to accompany |  
| ALL my representations if they are to belong to ONE experience. |

| 3 The TRANSCENDENTAL UNITY OF APPERCEPTION is therefore a FORMAL |  
| CONDITION of synthesising a manifold under rules - not another |  
| perceived item inside the bundle. |

| 4 LIMIT: this answers the missing unity at the level of POSSIBLE |  
| EXPERIENCE; it does not prove an immortal soul or settle every |  
| practical question of identity through time. |

| 5 HUMEAN REJOINDER: Kant has stated a condition of DESCRIPTION |  
| rather than discovered an ENTITY. Kant accepts the non-entity |  
| point and insists that rule-governed unity is PRESUPPOSED by |  
| judgment. |

+-----+

CROSS-TRADITION BRIDGE (one clause, not a paragraph): the bundle strikingly resembles the Buddhist no-self doctrine (nairatmyavada).

⚠️ **Caption.** Step 1 of Kant's reply is the step that separates a good answer from a wrong one. A script that reports Kant as "proving the soul exists" has inverted his position and will lose the second limb of the 2020 question entirely.

### 1. The argument, and the exact formula

- ✅ Apply the copy principle to the self: **introspect, and you never find an impression of a "self"** — only particular perceptions in constant flux.
- ✅ The self is "**nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions, which succeed each other with an inconceivable rapidity, and are in a perpetual flux and movement**" (*Treatise* I.iv.6).
- ⚠️ **What is denied:** a *simple, identical self-substance*. What is **not** denied: the perceptions, which are real. The trap is to write "Hume says the self does not exist" — he says there is no **owner** behind the perceptions.

### 2. Why we believe in a self anyway

- ✅ The imagination produces the fiction through **resemblance** — present ideas resemble past memories, creating a felt continuity — and through **causation**, since one perception seems to produce the next and memory links them.
- ⚠️ The mechanism is the same association introduced in Session 10; the identity we ascribe is therefore a **fictitious** identity, imposed on a succession because the transition between its members is smooth.

### 3. The Appendix — Hume's own retraction

- ✅ In the Appendix to the *Treatise*, Hume confesses that he cannot satisfactorily explain what **binds** the bundle together: "all my hopes vanish when I come to explain the principles that unite our successive perceptions."
- ⚠️ **The diagnosis worth stating:** having denied both a substance and any real connexion between distinct existences, Hume has removed every resource a principle of unity might have used, so the failure is a symptom of the **atomism of impressions**, not of the self.
- ✅ This honest confession is philosophically significant and is the single most quotable page in any answer on Hume's self.
- ⚠️ Note also that the *Enquiry* silently **drops** the personal-identity discussion — a textual fact worth one clause, because it shows Hume's own dissatisfaction.

### 4. Kant's response, stated without distortion

- ✅ Kant **accepts** that no impression or inner intuition reveals a simple soul-substance.
- ✅ He argues instead that the "**I think**" must be able to accompany all representations if they are to belong to one experience at all.
- ✅ The **transcendental unity of apperception** is a **formal condition** of synthesising a manifold under rules, not another perceived item inside the bundle.
- ⚠️ This answers Hume's missing unity at the level of **possible experience**; it does not prove an immortal Cartesian soul or by itself settle every practical question of personal identity through time.

- **?** The Humean can reply that Kant has stated a condition of **description** rather than discovered an entity; Kant accepts the non-entity point but insists that rule-governed unity is presupposed by judgment.
- **⚠️ Cross-tradition parallel**, worth one clause: the bundle theory strikingly resembles the Buddhist doctrine of no-self (*nairātmyavāda*), a bridge some examiners reward — but it is a **parallel**, not an influence, and must not be inflated.

## 5. God — the three fronts, all lost

| Front                                                                         | Hume's argument                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Consequence                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cosmological / causal</b>                                                  | We have no impression of a "first cause" or of causation as necessary connexion, so we cannot legitimately infer from experienced effects to an unexperienced transcendent cause                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | The argument Locke used at <i>Essay</i> IV is cut off at its premise |
| <b>Design / teleological</b> ( <i>Dialogues concerning Natural Religion</i> ) | The analogy — universe : designer :: watch : watchmaker — is weak, because the universe is not sufficiently similar to a manufactured artifact; even if granted it proves at most a <b>finite</b> architect working on given matter, not an omnipotent, omniscient, morally perfect creator; order might arise from natural principles without intelligence; and the problem of evil undermines any inference to a perfectly good designer | The design argument survives, if at all, only as a weak analogy      |
| <b>Miracles</b> ( <i>Enquiry</i> X)                                           | A miracle violates the laws of nature; testimony in favour of a miracle is always less probable than the testimony being false                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | It is never rational to believe miracle-reports on testimony alone   |

- **⚠️ Ownership note**: the miracle argument is secondary enrichment here; Hume's **critique of the proofs** is core, because "God" is printed in the syllabus clause.
- **⚠️ Cross-paper link**: the design-argument critique is also the required content for Paper II questions on proofs for God's existence; the argument is the same, the paper is different.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** Hume's bundle theory dissolves the substantial self without denying the reality of experience, and its most important feature is that its author declares it incomplete. **Named evidence.** *Treatise* I.iv.6 reports that introspection never delivers a constant and invariable impression but only heat, cold, light, shade, love, hatred, pain and pleasure in perpetual flux, and concludes that the self is a bundle or collection of different perceptions; the Appendix then confesses that all his hopes vanish when he comes to explain the principles that unite them. **Analysis.** The unity we experience is produced by resemblance and causation, which let the imagination pass smoothly along the series and mistake an easy transition for an identical object; but because Hume has denied both a substance and any real connexion between distinct existences, no principle of unity remains available to him, so the failure indicts his atomism of impressions rather than the self. **Qualification.** Kant's transcendental unity of apperception addresses precisely this gap by treating the "I think" as a formal condition of unified

experience rather than as a discovered entity, which is why it is a reply to Hume and not a return to Descartes — though the Humean may fairly answer that a condition of description is not yet the discovery of a subject.

### Exam link

- **2020 Q2(a), 20 marks** — the quoted sentence is answered by §§1–3, and the Kant limb by §4. The empiricist argument must be complete before Kant appears.
- **2025 P-II** proofs-for-God questions draw directly on §5, and the same material supports any Paper I comparison of God across the three empiricists.
- **2021 Q1(d)** gains its contrast from placing Locke's forensic person beside Hume's bundle.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                                   | Correction                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Hume says the self does not exist"                    | He denies a <b>simple identical self-substance</b> ; the perceptions are real |
| Omitting the Appendix                                  | The retraction is the most valuable single item in this session               |
| "Kant proves the soul exists"                          | Kant supplies a <b>formal condition</b> , and explicitly not a soul-substance |
| Making the Buddhist parallel a paragraph               | It is a bridge in one clause; the syllabus owner is Indian Philosophy         |
| Reporting the design argument as merely "weak analogy" | Give the four separate objections, including the finite-architect point       |

### Revision notes

- No constant impression of a self; only perceptions in perpetual flux.
- *Treatise* I.iv.6: "a bundle or collection of different perceptions".
- Fiction of unity produced by **resemblance** and **causation**.
- Appendix: "all my hopes vanish" — the uniting principle cannot be stated; the *Enquiry* drops the topic.
- Kant: the "I think" must be able to accompany representations; transcendental unity of apperception is **formal**.
- God: cosmological cut at the premise; design weak, at most a finite architect, plus the problem of evil; miracles never rationally credible on testimony.

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW — HUME II: THE SELF AND GOD

COPY PRINCIPLE APPLIED TO THE PERCEIVER

|

v

INTROSPECTION: only particular perceptions in PERPETUAL FLUX; no constant and invariable impression of a self

|

v  
 SELF = "A BUNDLE OR COLLECTION OF DIFFERENT PERCEPTIONS" (Treatise I.iv.6)  
 |  
 +--> WHY IT FEELS UNIFIED: RESEMBLANCE + CAUSATION -> easy transition  
 | mistaken for an identical object -> FICTION of identity  
 +--> APPENDIX: "all my hopes vanish" - no uniting principle available  
 | DIAGNOSIS: the ATOMISM of impressions is at fault, not the self  
 +--> the Enquiry silently DROPS personal identity  
 |  
 v  
 KANT (2020 second limb): accepts there is no soul-substance; the "I THINK"  
 must be able to accompany all representations; TRANSCENDENTAL UNITY OF  
 APPERCEPTION = a FORMAL CONDITION, not an entity  
 HUMEAN REJOINER: a condition of description, not a discovered subject  
 |  
 v  
 GOD - THREE FRONTS, ALL LOST  
 CAUSAL: no impression of a first cause or of necessary connexion  
 DESIGN (Dialogues): weak analogy | at most a FINITE architect | natural  
 order without intelligence | the problem of evil  
 MIRACLES (Enquiry X): testimony is always less probable than its falsehood  
 TRAP: "self does not exist" | omitting the Appendix | Kant as soul-prover  
 ANSWER LINE: Hume finds the perceptions and loses the owner - and admits it

## SESSION 12 — HUME III: CAUSATION, THE TWO DEFINITIONS, THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION, KANT'S RESPONSE AND MITIGATED SCEPTICISM

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Watch one billiard ball strike another as often as you like: you will see one move, then the other, always in that order and always touching — but you will never see the pushing itself. Hume says the "must" we feel is a habit inside us that repetition has installed, not a link we have observed in the world.

**Technical definition:** Hume's analysis of causation replaces objective **necessary connexion** with three observable elements — **constant conjunction**, **temporal priority** and **spatial contiguity** — plus an **impression of reflection**, the felt determination of the mind to pass from the idea of the cause to that of the effect; from this follow his **two definitions of cause**, the sceptical **problem of induction**, and the positive doctrine of **mitigated scepticism**.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Hume does not deny causation; he **relocates necessity** — from the objects, where no impression of a power or tie is ever given, to the observer, in whom repetition installs a felt determination to pass from cause to effect — and because that relocation converts the foundation of every factual inference

into a habit, it produces the problem of induction, which is why the same doctrine answers a question about causation and a question about the limits of reason.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **constant conjunction, temporal priority, contiguity** — the three observables
- **no impression of necessary connexion** — the negative result
- **impression of reflection** — the felt determination of the mind
- **custom or habit** — "the great guide of human life" (*Enquiry* V)
- **two definitions of cause** — the philosophical and the natural
- **the Uniformity Principle** — and the dilemma that traps it
- **mitigated scepticism** versus **excessive or Pyrrhonian scepticism**

**How to use them:** run the negative argument in numbered steps, produce **both** definitions, then run induction as a formal dilemma, then Kant's Second Analogy, then close on mitigated scepticism. Naming both definitions is the single highest-value move available in this sub-topic.

## Plain-language visual — what you actually see, and what you add

| THE BILLIARD TABLE                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Enquiry IV, VII |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| +-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                 |
| BALL A moves ---> touches BALL B ---> BALL B moves                                                                                                                                                                                          |                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |
| WHAT THE SENSES DELIVER:                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                 |
| PRIORITY     A moves first                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                 |
| CONTIGUITY   they touch                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                 |
| CONSTANT     every time so far, B has followed A                                                                                                                                                                                            |                 |
| CONJUNCTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |
| WHAT THE SENSES NEVER DELIVER:                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                 |
| the POWER, the FORCE, the TIE, the "must"                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                 |
| +-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |
| REPETITION ADDS NOTHING TO THE OBJECTS. The hundredth collision is qualitatively no different from the first, as far as the balls go.                                                                                                       |                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |
| BUT REPETITION CHANGES *ME*. After constant conjunction, my mind is DETERMINED to pass from the idea of A to the idea of B. THAT felt determination is an IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION - and the idea of necessary connexion is copied from it. |                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |
| CONCLUSION: necessity "is something that exists in the mind, not in objects." Causation is not denied; NECESSITY IS RELOCATED.                                                                                                              |                 |

**In simple words:** the argument is an audit, exactly like the audits of substance and self. Name the idea, demand its impression, search outside, search inside, and follow the search where it goes. Hume even checks the most promising internal case — the will moving a limb — and finds no impression of the mechanism there either.

| Remember first     | Meaning                                                                 |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Observed           | priority, contiguity, constant conjunction                              |
| Not observed       | power, force, necessary connexion                                       |
| Source of the idea | an <b>impression of reflection</b> : the felt determination of the mind |
| Mechanism          | <b>custom or habit</b> , not rational demonstration                     |
| Result             | necessity is <i>projected onto</i> objects, not read off them           |
| Not the result     | that causal inference should stop; nature compels it                    |

**One-line memory:** the necessity is real — it is just in the **spectator**, not in the **collision**.

## VISUAL — the two arguments, the two definitions and the dilemma

- (A) THE NEGATIVE ARGUMENT ON NECESSARY CONNEXION    Treatise I.iii.14;  
Enquiry VII
- 1 COPY PRINCIPLE: every simple idea derives from a simple impression.
  - 2 So if we have a genuine idea of NECESSARY CONNEXION, locate its source impression.
  - 3 EXTERNAL SEARCH: in any single instance of causation, sense delivers only priority, contiguity and the succession of qualities. No impression of a POWER or TIE is given.
  - 4 Repetition adds no new quality TO THE OBJECTS: the hundredth collision is qualitatively no different from the first.
  - 5 INTERNAL SEARCH: volition does no better. I have no impression of HOW the will moves the limb; nerve and muscle are unknown to consciousness. This rules out the Cartesian and the occasionalist appeal alike.
  - 6 But repetition DOES change THE MIND: after constant conjunction the mind is DETERMINED to pass from the idea of A to the idea of B. That felt determination is an IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION.
  - 7 THEREFORE the idea of necessary connexion is copied from that internal impression. Necessity "is something that exists in the mind, not in objects."
  - 8 THEREFORE TWO DEFINITIONS OF CAUSE FOLLOW:
- |                                |                                |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| +-----+                        | +-----+                        |
| (i) OBJECTIVE / PHILOSOPHICAL  | (ii) SUBJECTIVE / NATURAL      |
| an object followed by another, | an object followed by another, |
| where all objects similar to   | whose appearance CONVEYS THE   |

|                               |                         |  |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------|--|
| the first are followed by     | THOUGHT to the other    |  |
| objects similar to the second |                         |  |
| regularity, external          | psychological, internal |  |

+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+

NAMING BOTH IS THE HIGHEST-VALUE MOVE IN ANY HUME-ON-CAUSATION ANSWER.  
 TENSION worth flagging: the two pull apart and Hume never reconciles them - the origin of the modern regularity-versus-projectivist debate.  
 PRESUPPOSITIONS: P1 the copy principle is exceptionless; P2 single and repeated instances can be compared for ADDED content; P3 impressions are atomic and separable, so no relation is given WITH its terms; P4 "necessity" must be either observed or projected - no third option such as an inferred theoretical posit.  
 CANONICAL EXAMPLES: the two billiard balls (Enquiry IV, VII); bread nourishing the body (Enquiry IV) - the sensible qualities of bread give no clue to its nutritive power.

=====

- (B) THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION AS A FORMAL DILEMMA Enquiry IV
- 1 All reasoning about matters of fact beyond present sense and memory rests on the relation of cause and effect.
  - 2 Causal inference rests on the UNIFORMITY PRINCIPLE (UP): the future will resemble the past; unobserved cases resemble observed ones.
  - 3 UP can be established only DEMONSTRATIVELY or PROBABLY. <-- THE FORK APPLIED REFLEXIVELY; this exhaustive division is the vulnerable step.
  - 4 NOT DEMONSTRATIVELY: "the course of nature may change" implies no contradiction - it is perfectly conceivable.
  - 5 NOT PROBABLY: every probable or experiential argument already PRESUPPOSES UP, so the argument would be circular.
  - 6 THEREFORE UP has no rational foundation.
  - 7 THEREFORE inductive inference is produced not by reason but by CUSTOM OR HABIT - "the great guide of human life" (Enquiry V).

EVERY SERIOUS REPLY ATTACKS STEP 3:

KANT supplies a THIRD category - the synthetic a priori  
 POPPER denies that science needs induction at all  
 STRAWSON argues that demanding a justification of induction AS A WHOLE misapplies the very standards induction constitutes

=====

- (C) KANT'S RESPONSE - the routed reply in 2025 Q2(c)
- Kant AGREES that necessary connection is not copied from a sensory impression.
  - SECOND ANALOGY: the category of cause is an A PRIORI RULE required to distinguish OBJECTIVE event-succession from the merely SUBJECTIVE succession of my perceptions.
  - "Every event has a cause" is therefore SYNTHETIC A PRIORI for possible experience: the understanding supplies necessary temporal ordering to phenomena.
  - LIMIT: this rescues objective empirical causation WITHOUT claiming knowledge of causality among things in themselves.

- HUMEAN CHALLENGE: has Kant PROVED the category, or BUILT it into the definition of objective experience? KANT'S REPLY is transcendental - without such rule-governed synthesis, experience of an EVENT would not be possible at all.

=====

(D) MITIGATED SCEPTICISM - the positive doctrine                      Enquiry XII  
 EXCESSIVE / PYRRHONIAN: total suspension of judgment - UNLIVEABLE  
 MITIGATED: limit enquiry to what experience can answer; avoid speculation beyond possible experience; proportion belief to evidence; accept the natural beliefs custom compels

⚠ **Caption.** Diagram (A) step 5 is the step scripts omit. Hume does not merely say we see no power in billiard balls; he closes the *internal* escape route, and that closure is what makes the conclusion general rather than anecdotal.

### 1. The elements, tabulated

| Element                                   | Hume's analysis                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What we observe                           | constant conjunction (A always followed by B) + temporal priority (A precedes B) + spatial contiguity                                                                                   |
| What we do <b>not</b> observe             | a <i>necessary connexion</i> between cause and effect                                                                                                                                   |
| Source of the idea of necessary connexion | not any impression of objects; an <b>impression of reflection</b> — a <i>feeling</i> in the mind, a determination to pass from the idea of A to the idea of B after repeated experience |
| Mechanism                                 | <b>custom or habit:</b> after repeated observation of A → B the mind <i>expects</i> B on seeing A; this expectation is a <b>psychological compulsion</b> , not a rational demonstration |
| Conclusion                                | causal necessity is not <i>in</i> objects; it is <b>projected onto</b> them by the mind's habitual association                                                                          |

### 2. Is there any element of necessity in causal relations? — the 2019 answer in two lines

- ✓ **In objects themselves — NO.** There is no impression of objective necessity.
- ✓ **In the mind — YES,** in a psychological sense: the impression of reflection, the felt compulsion to expect B after A, is a kind of **subjective necessity**. But this is a fact about *us*, not about *nature*.
- ⚠ The directive in 2019 Q4(b) is "Is there any element...?", which demands a **yes-and-no with a distinction**, never a flat "no". Answer in the first line, then explain.

### 3. The two definitions — and why both must appear

- ✓ **(i) Objective or philosophical:** an object followed by another, where all objects similar to the first are followed by objects similar to the second.
- ✓ **(ii) Subjective or natural:** an object followed by another, whose appearance **conveys the thought** to the other.
- ⚠ The two pull apart: the first is regularity-based and external, the second psychological and internal, and Hume never reconciles them. That unreconciled tension is the origin of the modern debate between regularity and projectivist accounts of causation, and naming it turns exposition

into assessment.

#### 4. Induction — the dilemma, and where every reply must strike

The seven steps are set out in diagram (B). The examinable point is that **step 3 is the vulnerable one**: it assumes the exhaustiveness of the demonstrative/probable dichotomy, which is Hume's own fork applied reflexively. Kant breaks that horn with the synthetic a priori; Popper denies science needs induction; Strawson dissolves the demand.

⚠️ **Executable verdict on induction:** the sceptical conclusion depends on the exhaustiveness of a dichotomy that is itself the fork, so Hume's scepticism about induction is not a discovery about the world but the shadow cast by his classification of propositions — which is exactly why it survives only as long as the fork does.

#### 5. Kant's response, and how far it goes

- ✓ Kant **agrees** that necessary connection is not copied from a sensory impression — so he is not contradicting Hume's negative result, he is accepting it.
- ✓ In the **Second Analogy** he argues that the category of cause is an *a priori* rule required to distinguish **objective** event-succession from the merely **subjective** succession of perceptions. Without a rule, the difference between a ship drifting downstream and my eye wandering over a house cannot be drawn.
- ✓ "Every event has a cause" is therefore **synthetic a priori** for possible experience: the understanding supplies necessary temporal ordering to phenomena.
- ⚠️ Kant rescues objective empirical causation **without** claiming knowledge of causality among things in themselves.
- ? Hume can challenge whether Kant proves the category or builds it into the definition of objective experience; the Kantian reply is transcendental — without such rule-governed synthesis, experience of an *event* would not be possible.
- ⚠️ **Ownership discipline:** Kant is the routed reply, not the doctrine under examination. In 2025 Q2(c) the Hume limb must be complete before the Kant limb begins.

#### 6. Mitigated scepticism — the positive recommendation

- ✓ Hume does **not** recommend suspending all belief; that would be unliveable. He distinguishes:
- Excessive or Pyrrhonian scepticism** — total suspension of judgment, impossible in practice;
- Mitigated scepticism** — a cautious, modest attitude: limit enquiry to what experience can answer, avoid speculation about things beyond possible experience (substance, God, the soul), and proportion belief to evidence.
- ✓ This is Hume's positive doctrine: philosophical humility plus reliance on the natural beliefs custom compels.
- ? **The standing objection:** mitigated scepticism looks inconsistent, since Hume *uses* induction while denying its rational basis. **His reply:** nature forces belief on us; philosophy reveals its groundlessness; both can be true without practical contradiction. ⚠️ The position is stable **only if** natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification — which concedes that not all belief needs reason.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** Hume's account of causation relocates necessity from the world to the observer, and the problem of induction is the immediate consequence rather than a separate scepticism. **Named evidence.** *Treatise* I.iii.14 and *Enquiry* VII search for an impression of necessary connexion, find only priority, contiguity and constant conjunction in the billiard-ball case, close the internal route by noting that we have no impression of how the will moves a limb, and locate the idea in the mind's determination to pass from cause to effect, yielding the two definitions of cause; *Enquiry* IV then shows that the Uniformity Principle can be established neither demonstratively, since its denial implies no contradiction, nor probably, since every experiential argument presupposes it. **Analysis.** Because the very habit that produces the idea of necessity is also the mechanism of all factual inference, the analysis of causation and the problem of induction are one result stated twice, and custom becomes the great guide of human life precisely where reason has been shown to be silent. **Qualification.** The result follows from the atomism of impressions rather than from experience itself — if perceptions are separable atoms, no relation can be perceived and the conclusion is guaranteed by the premise — so Kant's Second Analogy is correctly aimed when it attacks the atomism, though the Humean may still ask whether the category has been proved or presupposed.

### Exam link

- **2023 Q2(a), 20 marks** — "Critically analyse Hume's argument that causality is a matter of habit/custom involving psychological principle of association." Diagram (A) plus §3 plus the objections; "critically analyse" demands a verdict.
- **2021 Q1(e), 10 marks** — "constant conjunction" is the quoted phrase; the answer is §1 plus the impression of reflection.
- **2019 Q4(b), 15 marks** — §2 is the whole hinge: not in objects, yes in the mind.
- **2025 Q2(c), 15 marks** — §§1–3 then §5, in that order.
- **2018 Q1(a), 10 marks** — the fork from Session 10 plus §4's conceivability point.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                     | Correction                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Hume denies causation"                  | He denies the <b>idea of necessary connexion in objects</b> ; causal inference continues, compelled by custom |
| "Hume's causation = mere succession"     | Constant conjunction <b>plus</b> priority <b>plus</b> contiguity <b>plus</b> the felt necessity               |
| Giving only one definition of cause      | Both are required; naming both is the highest-value move here                                                 |
| Answering 2019 with a flat "no"          | The question asks "any element", so distinguish objects from mind                                             |
| Treating Kant as refuting Hume's premise | Kant <b>accepts</b> the negative result and attacks the atomism instead                                       |
| Calling Hume a Pyrrhonian                | His scepticism is explicitly <b>mitigated</b>                                                                 |

## Revision notes

- Observed: constant conjunction, priority, contiguity. Not observed: power or tie.
- Internal search fails too: no impression of how the will moves the limb.
- Idea of necessity copied from an **impression of reflection**; mechanism is **custom or habit**.
- Two definitions: regularity-based (philosophical) and thought-conveying (natural); unreconciled.
- Induction: UP not demonstrable (denial conceivable), not probable (circular) → custom.
- Step 3 of the dilemma is the target of Kant, Popper and Strawson.
- Kant: Second Analogy; cause is an a priori rule; synthetic a priori for possible experience; no claim about things in themselves.
- Mitigated, not Pyrrhonian; stable only if natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — HUME III: CAUSATION, INDUCTION AND SCEPTICISM

DEMAND THE IMPRESSION OF "NECESSARY CONNEXION"

|

+++> EXTERNAL SEARCH: only PRIORITY + CONTIGUITY + CONSTANT CONJUNCTION

+++> REPETITION adds nothing to the OBJECTS

+++> INTERNAL SEARCH: no impression of how the will moves the limb

|

v

FOUND ONLY: the MIND'S DETERMINATION to pass A -> B = IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION

NECESSITY IS RELOCATED: in the mind, not in objects

|

+++> TWO DEFINITIONS OF CAUSE

|

(i) philosophical: regular succession of similars

|

(ii) natural: appearance CONVEYS THE THOUGHT to the other

|

they pull apart and are never reconciled

|

v

INDUCTION AS A DILEMMA (Enquiry IV)

UP: the future resembles the past

not DEMONSTRABLE (denial conceivable) | not PROBABLE (circular)

-> no rational foundation -> CUSTOM, "the great guide of human life"

ATTACK POINT: step 3, the demonstrative/probable dichotomy = the FORK

KANT third category | POPPER no induction needed | STRAWSON dissolve demand

|

v

KANT'S SECOND ANALOGY: cause is an A PRIORI RULE distinguishing objective event-succession from subjective succession; synthetic a priori for possible experience; silent about things in themselves

|

v

MITIGATED SCEPTICISM (Enquiry XII): not Pyrrhonian suspension but bounded enquiry, proportioned belief and reliance on natural belief

TRAP: "denies causation" | mere succession | one definition | flat "no" in 2019  
ANSWER LINE: necessity is real, but it lives in the spectator

## SESSION 13 — COMPARISON, CRITICISMS AND REPLIES, ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVES AND PROVENANCE

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** This session turns the three systems into one comparison table, lists what each thinker's critics say and what he can answer, and then converts all of it into the sentences and structures that actually earn marks in the examination hall.

**Technical definition:** A synoptic treatment of British empiricism on **matched axes** — matter, qualities, substance, self, causation, God, scepticism and overall position — together with a criticism-reply-residual ledger for each thinker, graded verdicts at 10, 15 and 20 marks, a directive decoder, and the citation and provenance rules that protect factual accuracy.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Comparative questions in this item are lost by scripts that write three summaries and won by scripts that announce a **criterion** first: choose one axis — what each thinker will admit as an object of knowledge — and Locke's represented matter, Berkeley's ideas and spirits, and Hume's perceptions arrange themselves in a single argument, so that every subsequent difference about substance, self, causation and God is a consequence rather than a separate paragraph.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **matched axes** — the same question asked three times
- **criterion announced first** — the structural move that earns the comparison mark
- **criticism** → **reply** → **residual** — the three-column discipline
- **directive fidelity** — "examine", "critically analyse", "is there any...?"
- **provenance mark** — naming what is a later label and what is the author's own words
- **graded verdict** — a ruling scaled to the marks available

**How to use them:** open with the criterion, run the axes, then rule. Use the criticism ledger for the middle of any 15- or 20-marker, and close with a graded verdict rather than a summary.

### Plain-language visual — the same four questions, asked three times

ASK EACH MAN THE SAME FOUR QUESTIONS AND THE STORY TELLS ITSELF

|                           |            |               |                |  |
|---------------------------|------------|---------------|----------------|--|
| +-----+-----+-----+-----+ |            |               |                |  |
| QUESTION                  | LOCKE      | BERKELEY      | HUME           |  |
| +-----+-----+-----+-----+ |            |               |                |  |
| Is there matter           | yes, but   | no - the word | no impression, |  |
| behind the                | its nature | has no        | so no clear    |  |

|                 |               |               |               |         |
|-----------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------|
| qualities?      | is unknown    | content       | idea at all   |         |
| +-----+         | +-----+       | +-----+       | +-----+       | +-----+ |
| Is there a self | yes: a        | yes: an       | no: a bundle  |         |
| that owns the   | continuing    | ACTIVE spirit | in perpetual  |         |
| experiences?    | consciousness | known by      | flux          |         |
|                 |               | notion        |               |         |
| +-----+         | +-----+       | +-----+       | +-----+       | +-----+ |
| Is there real   | yes - real    | yes - but the | no - constant |         |
| causal power?   | power, with   | only agent is | conjunction   |         |
|                 | limited       | SPIRIT; laws  | plus habit    |         |
|                 | knowledge     | are SIGNS     |               |         |
| +-----+         | +-----+       | +-----+       | +-----+       | +-----+ |
| Can God be      | yes, by       | yes - and he  | no - every    |         |
| proved?         | DEMONSTRATION | is REQUIRED   | proof fails   |         |
|                 |               | by the system |               |         |
| +-----+         | +-----+       | +-----+       | +-----+       | +-----+ |
|                 |               |               |               |         |
| MODERATE        | THEISTIC      | MITIGATED     |               |         |
| REALISM         | IDEALISM      | SCEPTICISM    |               |         |

**In simple words:** a comparison is an argument, not a gallery. If you can say in one line *why* Berkeley must keep spirit while Hume need not, you have shown the examiner the mechanism, and the table then reads as evidence rather than as decoration.

| Remember first     | Meaning                                                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Axis               | one question asked of all three                          |
| Criterion          | the standard by which you will rank them                 |
| Residual           | what remains true after the reply is given               |
| Directive fidelity | doing exactly what the command word demands              |
| Provenance         | separating an author's words from the tradition's labels |
| Graded verdict     | a ruling proportioned to the marks                       |

**One-line memory:** announce the **criterion**, run the **axes**, then **rule**.

## VISUAL — the eight-axis comparison and the criticism ledger

| THE EIGHT-AXIS COMPARISON |            |                   |                  |
|---------------------------|------------|-------------------|------------------|
| =====                     |            |                   |                  |
| AXIS                      | LOCKE      | BERKELEY          | HUME             |
| -----+                    | -----+     | -----+            | -----+           |
| MATTER                    | real but   | does not exist    | no impression -> |
|                           | unknowable | (a fiction/       | fiction          |
|                           | substrate  | meaningless word) |                  |

|            |                                                              |                                                               |                                                                                      |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| QUALITIES  | primary<br>  (objective) vs<br>  secondary<br>  (subjective) | ALL mind-<br>  dependent; the<br>  distinction<br>  COLLAPSES | all are<br>  impressions; no<br>  basis for an<br>  objective/<br>  subjective split |
| SUBSTANCE  | "something I<br>  know not what"                             | spirit only (no<br>  material<br>  substance)                 | no substance at<br>  all - material<br>  or spiritual                                |
| SELF       | continuity of<br>  consciousness<br>  (memory)               | active spirit<br>  (real), known by<br>  NOTION               | bundle of<br>  perceptions<br>  (no self)                                            |
| CAUSATION  | real power<br>  (knowledge of<br>  mechanism<br>  limited)   | God's will<br>  producing ideas<br>  in us                    | constant<br>  conjunction +<br>  habit (no real<br>  power)                          |
| GOD        | demonstrated by<br>  a cosmological-<br>  style argument     | required to<br>  sustain<br>  unperceived ideas               | all proofs fail;<br>  scepticism                                                     |
| SCEPTICISM | rejected<br>  (moderate<br>  realism)                        | claims to REFUTE<br>  scepticism                              | embraced, but<br>  MITIGATED                                                         |
| OVERALL    | representative<br>  realism                                  | subjective<br>  (theistic)<br>  idealism                      | phenomenalism +<br>  scepticism                                                      |

=====

#### THE CRITICISM LEDGER - CRITICISM | SOURCE | REPLY | RESIDUAL

-----

##### AGAINST LOCKE

- 1 The primary/secondary distinction is unstable - can extension be conceived without any sensory quality? SOURCE: Berkeley  
REPLY: we can THINK extension abstractly through mathematical reasoning even if we always IMAGINE it with colour.  
RESIDUAL: the reply needs a non-imagistic idea, which strains Locke's own theory of ideas.
- 2 Representative realism generates scepticism - how can ideas be verified against reality? SOURCE: Berkeley and sceptics  
REPLY: God would not make us systematically deceived; inference to external causes is reliable enough for the conduct of life.  
RESIDUAL: this converts an epistemological problem into a theological guarantee.
- 3 Personal identity via memory is circular. SOURCE: Butler, Reid  
REPLY: distinguish the CONSTITUTIVE criterion (consciousness) from the EVIDENTIAL criterion (memory); repair transitivity with overlapping chains.  
RESIDUAL: "consciousness of it AS MINE" may re-import ownership.

-----

##### AGAINST BERKELEY

- 4 Common sense: surely tables exist unperceived.  
SOURCE: reported in Samuel Johnson's stone-kicking - RECEPTION only  
REPLY: the table DOES exist unperceived by you - God perceives it.  
The theory SAVES common sense rather than destroying it.  
RESIDUAL: continuity is bought with a theological premise.
- 5 Solipsism threat: if reality is my ideas, what of other minds?  
REPLY: other spirits are known by ANALOGY; God guarantees the whole system.  
RESIDUAL: knowledge of other spirits is less immediate than awareness of one's own activity.
- 6 Why invoke God at all? This is dogmatic, not empiricist. SOURCE: Hume  
REPLY: Berkeley accepts that he is a theist using empiricist methods to defend theism.  
RESIDUAL: God does exactly the work Locke's matter did.
- 7 How does subjective idealism differ from Hegel's absolute idealism?  
SOURCE: the 2024 examiner  
REPLY: Berkeley - reality is ideas in finite and divine minds;  
Hegel - reality is the self-development of Absolute Spirit.  
RESIDUAL: the two are different in KIND, not degree.
- 

#### AGAINST HUME

- 8 If there is no real causal power, science becomes inexplicable.  
SOURCE: Kant and scientists  
REPLY: science works by INDUCTIVE HABIT, not by rational insight into necessity; its success is a psychological fact, not a philosophical justification.  
RESIDUAL: an account of success is not an account of warrant.
- 9 What holds the bundle together? SOURCE: critics; HUME HIMSELF  
REPLY: none is offered - "all my hopes vanish" (Appendix).  
RESIDUAL: the failure indicts the atomism, not the self.
- 10 Self-refutation: is the FORK itself a relation of ideas or a matter of fact? If neither, it burns itself. SOURCE: critics  
REPLY: it is a clarification of the meanings of terms - a meta-level classification, not a first-order claim.  
RESIDUAL: the status of the meta-level remains contested.
- 11 Mitigated scepticism is inconsistent: Hume USES induction while denying its rational basis.  
REPLY: nature forces belief; philosophy reveals its groundlessness; both can be true without practical contradiction.  
RESIDUAL: stable only if natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification.

⚠ **Caption.** Use the ledger three columns at a time. A criticism without a reply is journalism; a reply without a residual is advocacy; only the third column shows judgement.

## 1. Why the empiricist sequence "slides" — the mechanism restated

LOCKE : all ideas from experience -> matter is real but unknowable  
 | Berkeley asks: if all we know is ideas, what grounds  
 | belief in MATTER?  
 BERKELEY: no impression of matter -> drop material substance  
 | Hume asks: apply the same razor to the SELF, to  
 | SUBSTANCE, to CAUSATION  
 HUME : no impression of self, no impression of necessary connexion  
 -> bundle, habit, mitigated scepticism

⚠ Each step is the **previous thinker's premise taken more consistently**. This is the master narrative of the whole item, and it is what provokes Kant to rescue knowledge by adding the *a priori* contribution of the mind.

## 2. Directive decoder — what each command word obliges you to do

| Directive                                             | What it demands                                                    | Structural obligation in this item                                                             | Fatal error                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Explain / Elucidate</b> (2025 Q4c, 2021 Q1c)       | make the doctrine intelligible by exhibiting its <i>derivation</i> | give the numbered argument — Berkeley's five, Hume's two — not the conclusion                  | restating <i>esse est percipi</i> or "constant conjunction" in synonyms |
| <b>Examine</b> (2021 Q1d)                             | state, then test                                                   | doctrine <b>and</b> objection, then a ruling on the objection's force                          | describing the doctrine and stopping                                    |
| <b>Critically examine / Critically discuss</b>        | assessment dominates                                               | three or four lines of reconstruction, then objection → reply → <b>adjudication</b>            | listing objections without ruling                                       |
| <b>Critically analyse</b> (2023 Q2a)                  | exposition <b>plus</b> a verdict                                   | both definitions of cause must appear, then the objections, then the ruling                    | the negative half only                                                  |
| <b>Discuss</b> (2019 Q4b, 2018 Q1a)                   | exposition plus assessment, roughly 60:40                          | for causation, both Humean definitions; for the fork, both boxes                               | a one-sided report                                                      |
| <b>Is there any element ...?</b> (2019 Q4b)           | a <b>yes-and-no with a distinction</b>                             | <i>not in objects; yes in the mind</i> , then the impression of reflection                     | a flat "no"                                                             |
| <b>Comment on the statement</b> (quotation-led parts) | locate the sentence in its own text and system first               | name the work and section, state the thesis it encodes, then two consequences, then a judgment | a generic essay on the thinker                                          |
| <b>How does X refute Y?</b> (2022 Q4c)                | a reconstruction of the refuting argument, premise by premise      | Locke's three grounds <b>and</b> the dispositional reply                                       | listing Locke's points only                                             |
| <b>Is A instrumental in B?</b> (2024 Q2a)             | a causal-explanatory verdict                                       | show <i>which</i> rejection does the work — likeness and abstraction, not relativity           | narrating both doctrines separately                                     |

### 3. Graded verdict bank — executable closing positions

| Sub-topic                              | 10-mark verdict                                                                                                                            | 15-mark verdict                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 20-mark verdict                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Innate ideas</b>                    | Locke defeats the naive innatist thesis of universally conscious innate content, but not the dispositional version Descartes actually held | ...Locke's decisive premise is that nothing can be in the mind unperceived; that premise, not the facts about children, does the work — and it is a stipulation                                                 | The dispute is not empirical but about what "in the mind" means. Locke wins the debate as staged and loses it as reformulated; innatism survives as a thesis about <b>structure</b> , which is precisely the form Kant vindicates                                                                            |
| <b>Abstract general ideas</b>          | Berkeley refutes abstraction only on an imagistic reading of ideas; on a determinable reading Locke stands                                 | ...Berkeley's positive account must specify the <b>respect</b> of representation — and the respect looks like the abstract idea readmitted                                                                      | The lasting casualty is not abstraction but the <b>ideational theory of meaning</b> that made abstraction necessary; the argument's true heir is Wittgenstein's family resemblance, not Hume's scepticism                                                                                                    |
| <b>Primary and secondary qualities</b> | The distinction survives as one between measurable-structural and response-dependent properties, but not as Locke's resemblance thesis     | ...Berkeley's parity argument defeats <b>resemblance</b> ; it does not defeat the scientific realist's <b>isomorphism</b> , since structural correspondence needs no qualitative likeness                       | Locke's mistake was to make the distinction depend on a picture rather than on explanatory role. Reconstructed as a claim about which properties enter physical explanation, it is defensible — which is why it survives in science while Locke's version does not                                           |
| <b>Berkeley's idealism</b>             | Berkeley is not denying the world; he denies an unperceivable substratum — his target is the philosopher's matter, not the grocer's apple  | ...He preserves ordinary object-talk at the price of an ad hoc asymmetry: ideas are known by ideas, spirits by "notions"                                                                                        | Berkeley's system is internally the most economical of the three but purchases its economy with God, who does exactly the work Locke's matter did. Immaterialism replaces an unknowable <b>substance</b> with an unperceivable <b>spirit</b> , a change of vocabulary before it is a gain in intelligibility |
| <b>Hume on causation</b>               | Hume does not deny causation; he relocates necessity from the object to the observer                                                       | ...His two definitions pull apart — the first objective and regularity-based, the second psychological — and he never reconciles them; this tension originates the modern regularity-versus-projectivist debate | Hume's result follows from the <b>atomism of impressions</b> , not from experience itself: if perceptions are separable atoms, no relation can be perceived, and the conclusion is guaranteed by the premise. Kant's answer is therefore correctly aimed — he attacks the atomism, not the inference         |

| Sub-topic         | 10-mark verdict                                                                                          | 15-mark verdict                                                                                                                                                                               | 20-mark verdict                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Induction</b>  | The problem is genuine and unsolved; Hume's own answer is descriptive (custom), not justificatory        | ...The argument is a dilemma, and every serious reply must break a horn — Kant by adding the synthetic a priori, Popper by denying science needs induction, Strawson by dissolving the demand | The sceptical conclusion depends on the exhaustiveness of the demonstrative/probable dichotomy. Since that dichotomy is itself the fork, Hume's scepticism about induction is the shadow cast by his classification of propositions — which is why it survives only as long as the fork does |
| <b>The self</b>   | Hume's bundle theory is the copy principle applied without exception to the perceiver                    | ...The Appendix retracts it: he cannot explain what unites the bundle, having denied both a substance and any real connexion. That honest failure is his most philosophically valuable page   | The bundle theory is not a positive doctrine but the last casualty of empiricist atomism; that Hume can find no principle of unity, and says so, shows the atomism and not the self to be at fault — a diagnosis Kant makes explicit                                                         |
| <b>Scepticism</b> | Hume's scepticism is <b>mitigated</b> , not Pyrrhonian: nature compels the beliefs reason cannot justify | ...This yields a stable position only if the natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification — which concedes that not all belief needs reason                                   | The slide from Locke to Hume is not decadence but rigour: each thinker applies the founding principle more consistently. That the principle consistently applied ends in a scepticism nobody can live shows the principle to be <b>incomplete</b> — the conclusion Kant draws                |

#### 4. Citation and provenance discipline

All three writers composed in **English**, so no translation issue arises — but edition and section discipline does.

| Text                                               | Citation practice                                                                                                                                                                                         | Cautions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Locke, <i>Essay Concerning Human Understanding</i> | Cite by <b>Book.Chapter.Section</b> : II.i.2 (white paper), II.viii (qualities), II.xxiii.2 (something I know not what), II.xxvii.9 (person), III.iii.6–11 (abstraction), IV.vii.9 (the general triangle) | ✓ Section references are edition-invariant. ⚠ The <i>Essay</i> was published in <b>1689</b> with <b>1690</b> on the title page, and the personal-identity chapter II.xxvii was <b>added in the second edition of 1694</b> — never describe it as part of the original text |
| " <i>Tabula rasa</i> "                             | ⚠ <b>Not Locke's wording.</b> He writes of the mind as "white paper, void of all characters" (II.i.2)                                                                                                     | Write: "the mind as 'white paper, void of all characters' — the doctrine traditionally labelled <i>tabula rasa</i> ." A free provenance mark                                                                                                                               |

| Text                                                                 | Citation practice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Cautions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Berkeley, <i>Principles</i> (1710) and <i>Three Dialogues</i> (1713) | Cite <i>Principles</i> by <b>section</b> : Intro §§6–25, and §§1–4, 8, 9–15, 22–23, 27, 30–33, 89, 140; cite the <i>Dialogues</i> by dialogue number                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ✓ "Esse est percipi" is Berkeley's own Latin ( <i>Principles</i> §3). ✗ "Esse est percipi aut percipere" is a <b>later expansion</b> by commentators to accommodate spirits — do not present it as a quotation                                                                                     |
| Berkeley on Locke's triangle                                         | Berkeley quotes <i>Essay</i> IV.vii.9 verbatim at <i>Principles</i> , Intro §13                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ✓ Safe to say "Berkeley quotes Locke's own words back at him" — it is literally true, and examiners notice                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Hume, <i>Treatise</i> (1739–40) and <i>Enquiry</i> (1748)            | Cite the <i>Treatise</i> by Book.Part.Section — I.i.1 missing shade; I.iii.14 necessary connexion; I.iv.2 belief in body; I.iv.6 personal identity; <b>Appendix</b> for the retraction — and the <i>Enquiry</i> by <b>Section</b> — II copy principle, IV induction, V custom, VII necessary connexion and the two definitions, X miracles, XII mitigated scepticism | ⚠ Do not merge the two works: Hume disowned the <i>Treatise</i> as a juvenile work, and the <i>Enquiry</i> <b>drops</b> personal identity. Say which text you are using. The <i>Enquiry</i> appeared in 1748 as <i>Philosophical Essays concerning Human Understanding</i> and was renamed in 1758 |
| "Commit it then to the flames"                                       | <i>Enquiry</i> XII, final paragraph                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ✓ Safe verbatim; note it is aimed at "divinity or school metaphysics"                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| "Reason is, and ought only to be, the slave of the passions"         | <i>Treatise</i> II.iii.3 — <b>Paper II / ethics material</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ✗ Do not deploy it as an epistemology quotation; it belongs to the theory of motivation                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| "Constant conjunction"; "custom is the great guide of human life"    | <i>Enquiry</i> V                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | ✓ Safe verbatim                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Samuel Johnson's stone                                               | Reported anecdote                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ⚠ <b>Reception, not argument.</b> Berkeley never denied that the stone is felt                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

✗ **Never write:** that Hume "denied causation" or that Berkeley "denied the existence of the external world." Both are examiner-flagged misreadings; Hume denies *observable objective necessity*, Berkeley denies *matter as an unperceiving substratum*.

## 5. Answer spines — three worked skeletons

10-MARK SPINE: "Locke's concept of personal identity" (2021 Q1d)

L1 Personal identity = continuity of consciousness; person at T2 = person at T1 iff present consciousness can appropriate T1's experiences.

Body (i) NOT sameness of soul-substance (ii) NOT sameness of body  
(iii) consciousness is constitutive, memory is vehicle and evidence  
(iv) FORENSIC: identity tied to accountability; prince and cobbler

Obj Butler/Reid circularity; Reid's Brave Officer breaks transitivity  
Close "Examine" = state + test; rule on the circularity charge's force.

15-MARK SPINE: "Hume's refutation of causal relation and Kant's response" (2025 Q2c)

Frame Hume's challenge: causation is not rationally grounded. Kant's answer.

Body A no impression of necessary connexion; constant conjunction + custom; BOTH definitions of cause; consequence - induction unjustified.

Body B Kant: cause is an A PRIORI CATEGORY; the mind imposes causal order; "every event has a cause" is synthetic a priori for possible experience; this rescues science without knowledge of things in themselves.

Assess Does Kant answer Hume or relocate the problem? Kant attacks the ATOMISM, which is the correct target.

Close Hume demolished dogmatic metaphysics; Kant rebuilt science on critical foundations.

20-MARK SPINE: "Causality is habit/custom - critically analyse" (2023 Q2a)

Frame Causation is the hinge of empiricism's critique of metaphysics and of science's rational basis.

Body A Full analysis: constant conjunction + priority + contiguity; no impression of necessary connexion; custom as the source of expectation.

Body B The impression of reflection; the association mechanism; the DISTINCTION between the PRACTICE of inference and its JUSTIFICATION.

Body C Objections: (i) Kant - causality is a priori; (ii) pragmatic - science works, so there is real causal order; (iii) self-refutation worry - if causation is mere habit, Hume's own arguments lose force.

Assess Hume succeeds in showing EXPERIENCE ALONE cannot ground causal necessity. Whether the Kantian a priori or a naturalist solution is best remains open. The sceptical result stands as a permanent constraint on dogmatism.

Close "Critically analyse" = exposition + verdict; deliver one.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH — claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification

**Claim.** The three empiricist systems are best compared by a single criterion — what each will admit as an object of knowledge — because every other difference between them follows from that admission.

**Named evidence.** Locke admits ideas plus an inferred material world whose primary qualities his ideas resemble; Berkeley admits ideas plus spirits known by notion and denies that "matter" names anything, since it is compounded from the abstract idea of being and the relative notion of supporting; Hume admits only perceptions, and finds no impression corresponding to substance, to a simple self, or to necessary connexion.

**Analysis.** Once the criterion is fixed, the differences on substance, qualities, self, causation, God and scepticism cease to be six separate disagreements and become six consequences of one decision, which is why the systems form a sequence rather than a set.

**Qualification.** The sequence is a reconstruction rather than a historical necessity, since each step requires an added premise its predecessor could have refused — comparability for Berkeley and the atomism of impressions for Hume — so the honest conclusion is that empiricism consistently applied ends somewhere no one can live, which diagnoses the premise rather than refuting philosophy.

## Exam link

- **2018 Q3(a)** and **2024 Q2(a)** are decided in the comparison section; use matched axes and rule.
- Every 15- and 20-mark answer in this item should draw its middle section from the criticism ledger.
- The provenance table prevents the two most common factual errors in the whole item: quoting *tabula rasa* as Locke's words and quoting *esse est percipi aut percipere* as Berkeley's.

## UPSC traps

| Trap                     | Correction                                                                               |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Three parallel summaries | Announce a criterion, then use matched axes                                              |
| Criticism without reply  | Every ledger entry has three columns                                                     |
| Ungraded verdicts        | Scale the ruling to the marks: 10 states, 15 refines, 20 diagnoses                       |
| Ignoring the directive   | "Examine", "critically analyse" and "is there any element" each demand a different shape |
| Loose quotation          | Use the provenance table; mark later labels as later labels                              |

## Revision notes

- Eight axes: matter · qualities · substance · self · causation · God · scepticism · overall position.
- Ledger discipline: criticism → source → reply → **residual**.
- Directive fidelity: explain = derivation; examine = state and test; critically analyse = verdict.
- Graded verdicts scale: 10 states the ruling, 15 refines it, 20 diagnoses the premise.
- Provenance: *tabula rasa* and *esse est percipi aut percipere* are later labels; II.xxvii is a 1694 addition.
- Never write "Hume denied causation" or "Berkeley denied the external world".

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW — COMPARISON AND ANSWER CRAFT

```
ANNOUNCE THE CRITERION: WHAT WILL EACH ADMIT AS AN OBJECT OF KNOWLEDGE?
|
v
RUN THE EIGHT AXES: MATTER | QUALITIES | SUBSTANCE | SELF | CAUSATION |
GOD | SCEPTICISM | OVERALL POSITION
|
+--> LOCKE represented matter -> moderate realism
+--> BERKELEY ideas + spirits -> theistic subjective idealism
+--> HUME perceptions only -> mitigated scepticism
|
v
LEDGER: CRITICISM -> SOURCE -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL (3 Locke, 4 Berkeley, 4 Hume)
|
v
DIRECTIVE DECODER: explain = derivation | examine = state and test |
critically analyse = verdict | "any element?" = yes-and-no with a distinction
|
```

v

GRADED VERDICT: 10 states | 15 refines | 20 diagnoses the premise

|

v

PROVENANCE: tabula rasa is a label, not a quotation | esse est percipi aut percipere is a later expansion | II.xxvii added 1694 | Treatise  $\neq$  Enquiry

TRAP: three summaries | criticism without reply | ignoring the directive

ANSWER LINE: empiricism consistently applied ends where nobody can live - which diagnoses the premise rather than refuting philosophy

## OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH — NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

---

### Prerequisite check before using this block

Nothing below is needed to write a complete answer to any of the twelve routed questions. Use it only after the thirteen Basic sessions, the thirty-two diagnostics and the solved practice are secure, and then only as a single evaluative rider inside a fifteen- or twenty-mark answer. Every item here is a **live scholarly dispute** and is marked ? accordingly; presenting any of these readings as settled doctrine would be a mistake in the opposite direction from omitting them.

### A1. Locke on real essence and corpuscular explanation ?

- **The issue:** is Locke a humble realist about hidden structures, or does his talk of substratum and real essence amount to a sceptical placeholder?
- **Competing readings:** a realist or **corpuscular** reading, on which real essences are genuine internal constitutions awaiting discovery; an **anti-essentialist** reading that stresses nominal essence and epistemic modesty; and a middle reading on which real essence exists but rarely functions as usable knowledge.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* — "something I know not what" looks empty. *Counter-reply* — Locke can say it is an explanatory posit tied to stable powers and kinds, not a positively known object of intuition.
- **Safe use** ⚠: one brief refinement inside a Locke substance answer, or when explaining why Berkeley finds Locke unstable.
- **Do not over-study:** the debates on corpuscular chemistry are not marks-essential unless a question explicitly asks about real essence.

### A2. Berkeley's Master Argument after the textbook summary ?

- **The issue:** does Berkeley really prove that an unperceived object is inconceivable, or only that one cannot *at the same time* conceive an object while conceiving it as unconceived?
- **Competing readings:** a strong **conceivability** argument; an **anti-abstraction polemic** in which the challenge is a corollary of the Introduction; and a **dialectical** reading that targets Locke's representational assumptions more than common realism.

- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* — I can surely think of a tree standing unperceived in a forest. *Counter-reply* — Berkeley answers that the tree is still conceived *by you* in the very act of the thought; his target is "conceived-as-unconceived", not "not currently seen".
- **Safe use** ⚠️ : only after *esse est percipi* and the attack on abstract ideas are already in place.
- **Do not over-study:** do not turn the answer into a survey of the analytic literature on conceivability.

### A3. Hume the destructive sceptic versus Hume the naturalist ?

- **The issue:** does Hume merely dissolve reason into habit, or does he reconstruct philosophy on the basis of ordinary human practice?
- **Competing readings:** the **radical sceptic** reading; the **mitigated or naturalist** reading; and a combined reading on which sceptical critique clears the way for modest common life and science.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* — appealing to custom looks like surrender, not philosophy. *Counter-reply* — Hume's point is that human cognition inescapably runs on habit, and philosophy should explain that limit rather than pretend to escape it by rationalist fiat.
- **Safe use** ⚠️ : one closing evaluative paragraph in an answer on causation, the self or scepticism. It must never replace the copy principle, the bundle theory or the habit analysis.
- **Do not over-study:** Hume's political, historical and economic writings are outside this owner.

### A4. The reflexive status of Hume's fork ?

- **The issue:** into which of its own two boxes does the fork itself fall? If it is neither a relation of ideas nor a matter of fact, it appears to license its own consignment to the flames.
- **Competing readings:** the **self-refutation** charge; a **meta-level** reading on which the fork is a clarification of the meanings of terms rather than a first-order claim; and a **methodological** reading on which it is a proposal for enquiry, assessed by fruitfulness rather than by truth.
- **The residual** ? : each rescue makes the fork less like a discovery and more like a stipulation, which weakens every conclusion that leans on its exhaustiveness — most obviously the induction dilemma.
- **Safe use** ⚠️ : one clause in a scepticism or induction answer, after the dilemma has been set out properly.

### A5. The modal status of the copy principle after the missing shade ?

- **The issue:** is the copy principle an empirical generalisation, an analytic truth about what an idea is, or a methodological rule for detecting empty terms?
- **Competing readings:** an **empirical** reading, which is what Hume's own concession suggests; a **constitutive** reading, on which nothing would count as an idea without an antecedent impression; and a **regulative** reading, on which the principle is a test rather than a law.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* — if it is empirical, one admitted exception invites others, and the demolitions of substance, self and necessary connexion lose their force. *Counter-reply* — interpolation between impressions actually had preserves the dependence on experiential materials, so the exception is parasitic on the rule rather than a rival to it.
- **Safe use** ⚠️ : a single sentence when an answer needs to grade rather than merely report Hume's negative results.

## A6. Is Berkeley's God an advance on Locke's matter? ?

- **The issue:** immaterialism removes an unknowable substratum and installs an unperceivable spirit that performs the same two functions — causing our ideas and sustaining the unperceived.
- **Competing readings:** an **economy** reading, on which spirits are already required for perception so no new category is added; a **substitution** reading, on which the change is one of vocabulary; and a **theological** reading, on which the point is precisely to make the world's order personal rather than mechanical.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* — the notion doctrine is an exemption introduced to protect the favoured posit. *Counter-reply* — the exemption is forced, since a passive idea could never picture an activity, and Berkeley applies the doctrine to finite spirits and relations as well as to God.
- **Safe use** ⚠️ : as the residual column of the criticism ledger in a twenty-mark answer on immaterialism.

### Conceptual links — not current-affairs items

Static early-modern philosophy does not require a manufactured contemporary anchor, and none has been forced here. The genuine conceptual links, usable as a closing clause when a question invites breadth, are: the fork running forward into the verification principle of logical positivism; the problem of induction remaining unsolved in the philosophy of science; the bundle self standing beside the Buddhist doctrine of no-self as a **parallel** rather than an influence; and the primary–secondary distinction surviving in science as a contrast between measurable-structural and response-dependent properties. Each belongs to a **later or different owner** and should be named in a clause, not developed.

### Source trail for this block

Locke, *An Essay Concerning Human Understanding*, Books II–IV; Berkeley, *A Treatise concerning the Principles of Human Knowledge* and *Three Dialogues between Hylas and Philonous*; Hume, *A Treatise of Human Nature* Book I with the Appendix, *An Enquiry concerning Human Understanding* Sections II, IV, V, VII, X and XII, and the *Dialogues concerning Natural Religion*. The interpretive positions summarised above follow the repository's advanced Western Philosophy dossier, which names Michael Ayers, Kenneth Winkler, George Pappas, Norman Kemp Smith, Barry Stroud and Don Garrett as the standard modern discussants, together with the scope objection to the Master Argument associated with Russell and refined by Prior and Gallois.

## CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Compressed revision notes for the complete topic, arranged by examinable structure rather than by a fixed template. Read these last, and read them fast. Parts A to L cover every Basic session; the optional advanced material is deliberately excluded, because none of it is required for a core answer.

## A. The empiricist operating rule and the four printed test cases

- **Origin, not warrant.** Every **simple** cognitive content traces to experience: Locke's **sensation** (outer) and **reflection** (inner), Hume's **impressions**. Mental operations — comparing, combining, abstracting — are never denied.
- The syllabus prints four test cases: **theory of knowledge · substance and qualities · self and God · scepticism**. Show all four in any general answer.
- The added premise at each step: Locke assumes **resemblance**; Berkeley adds **comparability** ("an idea can be like nothing but an idea"); Hume adds the **atomism of impressions**.
- Landing points: **representative realism** → **subjective idealism** → **mitigated scepticism**.
- Memory chain: **R** → **I** → **S**; deletions **M-S-N** (Berkeley deletes Matter; Hume deletes the Substantial self and objective Necessity); verdicts on scepticism **H-A-M** (Humble, Anti-sceptical, Mitigated).
- ❌ Not anti-reason; ❌ not the five senses only; ❌ not three biographies.

## B. Locke — anti-innatism and the sources of ideas

three grounds -> white paper -> sensation + reflection -> simple ideas -> combine/compare/abstract -> complex ideas (modes | substances | relations)

- Three grounds: **universal assent fails · no unconscious ideas · a genetic account is available**.
- The decisive ground is the second, because "to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind" is a **stipulation** that blocks the dispositional retreat.
- *Essay* II.i.2: the mind as "**white paper, void of all characters**". ⚠️ *Tabula rasa* is the tradition's label, **not** Locke's phrase.
- Simple ideas passive; complex ideas actively made as **modes** (triangle, gratitude, number), **substances** (gold, man) and **relations** (cause, identity).
- ⚠️ Verdict: naive innatism destroyed; **dispositional** innatism survives. Leibniz's rejoinder — nothing in the intellect that was not in the senses, **except the intellect itself** — names the survivor, and Kant vindicates its structural form.

## C. Locke — knowledge, the three degrees, probability and the veil

- **Knowledge = the perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas.**
- Degrees: **intuitive** ("white is not black") → **demonstrative** (mathematics; the existence of God) → **sensitive** (particular existing things). The external world sits on the **weakest** rung.
- Below knowledge lies **probability and judgement**: testimony, analogy, natural history, everyday expectation.
- **Representative realism**: body → sense organ → **idea**, which is the only inspectable item; primary-quality ideas are said to **resemble**.
- Veil objection: the comparison can never be made. Locke's four defences — **involuntariness, inter-sensory agreement, pleasure and pain, divine non-deception**.
- ✅ Survives: **causal and structural** representation. ❌ Exposed: **qualitative resemblance**.
- Locke is epistemically humble, not sceptical: the candle burns bright enough for the conduct of life.

## D. Locke — abstraction, nominal essence and real essence

- Argument: all existents are particular (III.iii.1) → separate names impossible (III.iii.2–4) → general terms needed → words general by signifying **general ideas** (III.iii.6) → ideas made general by **separation from circumstances of time, place and concomitants** (III.iii.6–9) → a **general representative** → the **nominal essence** annexed to the name (III.iii.15) → universals are "the inventions and creatures of the understanding" (III.iii.11).
- Nominal essence** = the abstract idea attached to the general name (gold: yellow, heavy, malleable, soluble in aqua regia). **Real essence** = the internal constitution producing observable properties; generally unknown.
- Locke is a **conceptualist**, not a Platonic realist and not a bare nominalist.
- The concession (IV.vii.9): the general triangle is "neither oblique nor rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but all and none of these at once", and is "**something imperfect, that cannot exist**".
- Best reply: **partial, not contradictory** — a determinable with angles left undetermined. Price: the abstract idea stops being imagistic.
- Four presuppositions: ideational meaning · imagistic ideas · possible subtraction · one idea per general word.

## E. Locke — qualities and the substratum

|        | Primary                                             | Secondary                                   |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| List   | solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number | colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold |
| Status | really in the object; inseparable from body         | <b>powers</b> to produce sensations in us   |
| Ideas  | <b>resemble</b> the qualities                       | resemble nothing in the object              |
| Test   | every fragment retains them                         | vary with the perceiver's organs            |

- Two separable theses: **A** the explanatory division; **B** the resemblance picture.
- Berkeley's **parity** (§§9–15) attacks A — answered, since relativity is what a real shape would produce. Berkeley's **likeness** (§8) attacks B — this lands.
- Survivor: **measurable-structural versus response-dependent** properties, defended by **isomorphism**, not by likeness.
- Substratum (II.xxiii.2): "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" — **nature** unknown, **existence** not denied.
- Berkeley's next move: an unknowable support is an **abstract general idea** (being + supporting), so matter becomes **meaningless**, not mysterious.

## F. Locke — personal identity and God

- Three identities: **substance** · **man** (the continuing living organism) · **person**.
- Person (II.xxvii.9, chapter **added in the second edition of 1694**): "a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places".
- Criterion: the extension of **consciousness** by **appropriation**; memory is vehicle and evidence, not the definition. "Person" is a **forensic** term.

- **Prince and cobbler:** person follows consciousness, man follows the organism.
- Objections: **Butler and Reid** — circularity, since memory presupposes identity; **Reid's Brave Officer** — transitivity fails; **gaps** — sleep and amnesia.
- Repairs: **overlapping chains** of consciousness; continuous **capacity** rather than constant recollection.
- ⚠ Verdict: forensically indispensable, metaphysically incomplete.
- **God:** known by **demonstration** — nothing comes from nothing; I exist; therefore an eternal, most powerful and most knowing being. ⚠ The exposed premise is the causal principle Hume later refuses to certify. ❌ No innate idea of God.

## G. Berkeley — nominalism and the anti-abstraction base

- **Allowed:** separating parts that **could** exist apart (a hand, a headless torso). **Denied:** separating what **cannot** (extension without colour; motion without determinate speed; "man" without stature).
- Locke's triangle is quoted **verbatim** at *Principles*, Introduction §13, and declared self-contradictory.
- Replacement (§12): an idea is general "**by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort**" — a determinate particular, **selectively attended to**. The geometer draws this inch-long line and proves a theorem about all lines.
- §§19–20: words do not always stand for ideas; language also raises passion, prompts action and disposes the mind. ⚠ A genuine anticipation of the later claim that meaning is use.
- **Payload:** matter = the abstract idea of *being* + the relative notion of *supporting*; so **immaterialism rests on the nominalism, not the reverse**.
- Limits: the attack works against **imagistic** Locke; and Berkeley owes an account of what fixes the **respect** of representation.

## H. Berkeley — the five arguments and *esse est percip*

semantic (Sec.1-4) -> likeness (Sec.8) -> parity (Sec.9-15) ->  
master (Sec.22-23) -> continuity (Sec.6, 30-33, 48)

1. **Semantic:** objects of knowledge are ideas; "sensible things" means what is immediately perceived; an apple or a tree is a **collection of ideas**; ideas cannot exist unperceived; therefore *esse est percipi* (§3), and "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is unintelligible. ⚠ Step three is a **definition**, not a discovery.
2. **Liikeness (§8):** an idea can be like nothing but an idea; an unverifiable resemblance is empty. **Objection:** isomorphism needs no qualitative likeness.
3. **Parity (§§9–15):** Locke's own relativity considerations apply to primary qualities too. **Objection:** relativity does not entail mind-dependence.
4. **Master (§§22–23):** you cannot conceive a body unconceived. **Objection (Russell; refined by Prior and Gallois):** a scope or use–mention confusion. **Berkeley's reply:** question-begging only if immaterialism is already false.
5. **Continuity (§§6, 30–33, 48):** ideas are passive, sense-ideas arrive involuntarily in order, only spirits act, therefore God — and unperceived things persist in the infinite Mind. - Reality versus imagination: **involuntary, vivid, coherent, law-governed**. Illusion is an error of **judgment**, not of existence. - ❌ Never "Berkeley denies the external world". ⚠ *Esse est percipi aut percipere* is a **later expansion**, not his Latin.

## I. Berkeley — spirits, notions, God and the two required comparisons

- Ontology: **spirits** (active substances that perceive and will) + **ideas** (passive). Nothing else.
- Spirits are known by **notion** (§§27, 89, 140), not by idea, because a passive idea could never picture an activity. Critics call it ad hoc; Berkeley holds the asymmetry is forced.
- **God**: derived from the passivity of ideas plus the involuntary order of sense; secures **continuity**; the laws of nature are the settled grammar of a divine language — regularities are **signs**, not causes.
- Other finite minds: inferred by **analogy** from purposive signs. Solipsism blocked, but knowledge of other spirits is less immediate.
- Common sense: Berkeley claims to save it, and blames the **materialist** for inventing the unknowable world. ⚠ Strong about objects, weaker about causes. The Johnson stone anecdote is **reception**, not refutation.
- **Moore**: the act-object distinction — awareness of blue is not blue; transparency supports **direct realism**. **Russell**: ordinary objects are **logical constructions** from sense-data, perspectives and relations. Shared ground: no reduction of object to act. **The difference**: Moore *defends* the ordinary object, Russell *replaces* it.
- **Hegel contrast**: Berkeley — reality is ideas in finite and divine minds, and God is an infinite **perceiver**; Hegel — reality is the self-development of **Absolute Spirit**, objectivity a moment within dialectic. Different in **kind**, not degree.

## J. Hume — impressions and ideas, the fork, substance and the belief in body

- Perceptions = **impressions** (vivid) + **ideas** (faint copies); the criterion is **force and vivacity**.
- **Copy principle**: every simple idea derives from a simple impression. ? Conceded exception: the **missing shade of blue** (*Treatise* I.i.1; *Enquiry* II), which shows the principle is an empirical generalisation. **Reply**: interpolation between impressions actually had.
- **Association**: resemblance · contiguity in time or place · cause and effect. Psychological, not logical — and it powers both the fiction of the self and causal belief.
- **The fork**: relations of ideas (a priori, necessary, denial contradictory) versus matters of fact (a posteriori, contingent, contrary conceivable). Neither → "**commit it then to the flames**" (*Enquiry* XII), aimed at divinity or school metaphysics. Direct ancestor of the verification principle.
- **Substance**: no impression of a bearer → a **fiction of the imagination**; dissolves **material and spiritual** substance alike, which is where Hume passes Berkeley.
- **Belief in body** (*Treatise* I.iv.2): sense gives only interrupted perceptions; **constancy** and **coherence** lead the imagination to feign continued and distinct objects; the philosophers' **double-existence** theory is unverifiable because all comparison stays within perceptions. ⚠ Reason cannot justify the belief; **nature** compels it.

## K. Hume — the self, God and mitigated scepticism

- No constant and invariable impression of a self; only perceptions in **perpetual flux**.
- *Treatise* I.iv.6: the self is "**a bundle or collection of different perceptions, which succeed each other with an inconceivable rapidity**".
- The felt unity is a **fiction** produced by **resemblance** and **causation**: an easy transition mistaken for an identical object.
- **Appendix**: "all my hopes vanish when I come to explain the principles that unite our successive perceptions." ⚠ Having denied both substance and real connexion, no resource remains — the failure indicts the **atomism**. The *Enquiry* silently drops the topic.

- **Kant:** accepts that no soul-substance is found; the "**I think**" must be able to accompany all representations; the **transcendental unity of apperception** is a **formal condition**, not an entity. Humean rejoinder: a condition of description, not a discovered subject.
- **God — three fronts, all lost.** Causal: no impression of a first cause or of necessary connexion. Design (*Dialogues*): weak analogy; at most a **finite** architect; natural order without intelligence; the problem of evil. Miracles (*Enquiry X*): testimony is always less probable than its own falsehood.
- **Scepticism: excessive or Pyrrhonian** suspension is unliveable; **mitigated** scepticism limits enquiry to what experience can answer, proportions belief to evidence and relies on natural belief. ? Stable only if natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification.

## L. Hume on causation and induction; exam craft, PYQ routes and the trap sheet

observe: priority + contiguity + constant conjunction  
 not observed: power or tie  
 internal search: no impression of how the will moves the limb  
 found: the MIND'S DETERMINATION = impression of reflection  
 -> two definitions of cause -> custom -> the induction dilemma

- **Two definitions:** (i) an object followed by another where all similar objects are so followed — objective, regularity-based; (ii) an object whose appearance **conveys the thought** to the other — psychological. ⚠ Never reconciled; the origin of the regularity-versus-projectivist debate.
- **Induction (*Enquiry IV*):** the Uniformity Principle is neither **demonstrable** (its denial is conceivable) nor **probable** (every experiential argument presupposes it), so inference rests on **custom**, "the great guide of human life" (*Enquiry V*). Every serious reply attacks **step 3**, the demonstrative-or-probable division — Kant with the synthetic a priori, Popper by denying that science needs induction, Strawson by dissolving the demand.
- **Kant's Second Analogy:** the category of cause is an *a priori* rule needed to distinguish **objective** event-succession from the **subjective** succession of perceptions; "every event has a cause" is synthetic a priori for possible experience, with no claim about things in themselves.

### PYQ routes — all twelve, in one place

| Year | Part  | Marks | Route                                                                                                                      |
|------|-------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2018 | Q1(a) | 10    | The fork: relation of ideas versus matter of fact; conceivability test                                                     |
| 2018 | Q3(a) | 20    | Five arguments for immaterialism, then Moore's act-object realism versus Russell's logical construction, then the contrast |
| 2019 | Q4(b) | 15    | Not in objects, yes in the mind: the impression of reflection; both definitions                                            |
| 2020 | Q2(a) | 20    | Bundle self, fiction of unity, Appendix; then Kant's transcendental unity of apperception                                  |

| Year | Part  | Marks | Route                                                                                        |
|------|-------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2021 | Q1(c) | 10    | "Immediately perceived": the semantic argument and the removal of the veil                   |
| 2021 | Q1(d) | 10    | Person/man/substance; consciousness and appropriation; Butler–Reid; verdict                  |
| 2021 | Q1(e) | 10    | Constant conjunction is necessary, not sufficient; the felt determination completes it       |
| 2022 | Q4(c) | 15    | Three grounds; white paper; sensation and reflection; the three degrees                      |
| 2023 | Q2(a) | 20    | Full causal analysis; association and custom; three objections; ruling                       |
| 2024 | Q2(a) | 20    | Parity and likeness, abstraction as the deeper ground; Berkeley versus Hegel on matched axes |
| 2025 | Q2(c) | 15    | Hume complete, then the Second Analogy, then adjudication                                    |
| 2025 | Q4(c) | 15    | Locke's abstraction, Berkeley's refutation, the §12 replacement, the payload                 |

**Directive decoder in one line each.** Explain = give the **derivation**. Examine = state **and** test. Critically analyse = exposition **plus** verdict. Discuss = roughly 60:40 exposition to assessment. "Is there any element...?" = a **yes-and-no with a distinction**. "Is A instrumental in B?" = a causal-explanatory ruling.

**Provenance rules that protect marks.** *Tabula rasa* is a later label; Locke writes "white paper, void of all characters" (II.i.2). *Esse est percipi* is Berkeley's own Latin at §3; *aut percipere* is a commentators' expansion. II.xxvii was added in **1694**. The *Essay* appeared in **1689** with **1690** on the title page. The *Treatise* and the *Enquiry* must not be merged; the *Enquiry* drops personal identity, and it appeared in 1748 as *Philosophical Essays* before being renamed in 1758. "Reason is the slave of the passions" is *Treatise* II.iii.3 and belongs to ethics, not epistemology. Samuel Johnson's stone is reception, not argument.

### Trap sheet — ten lines

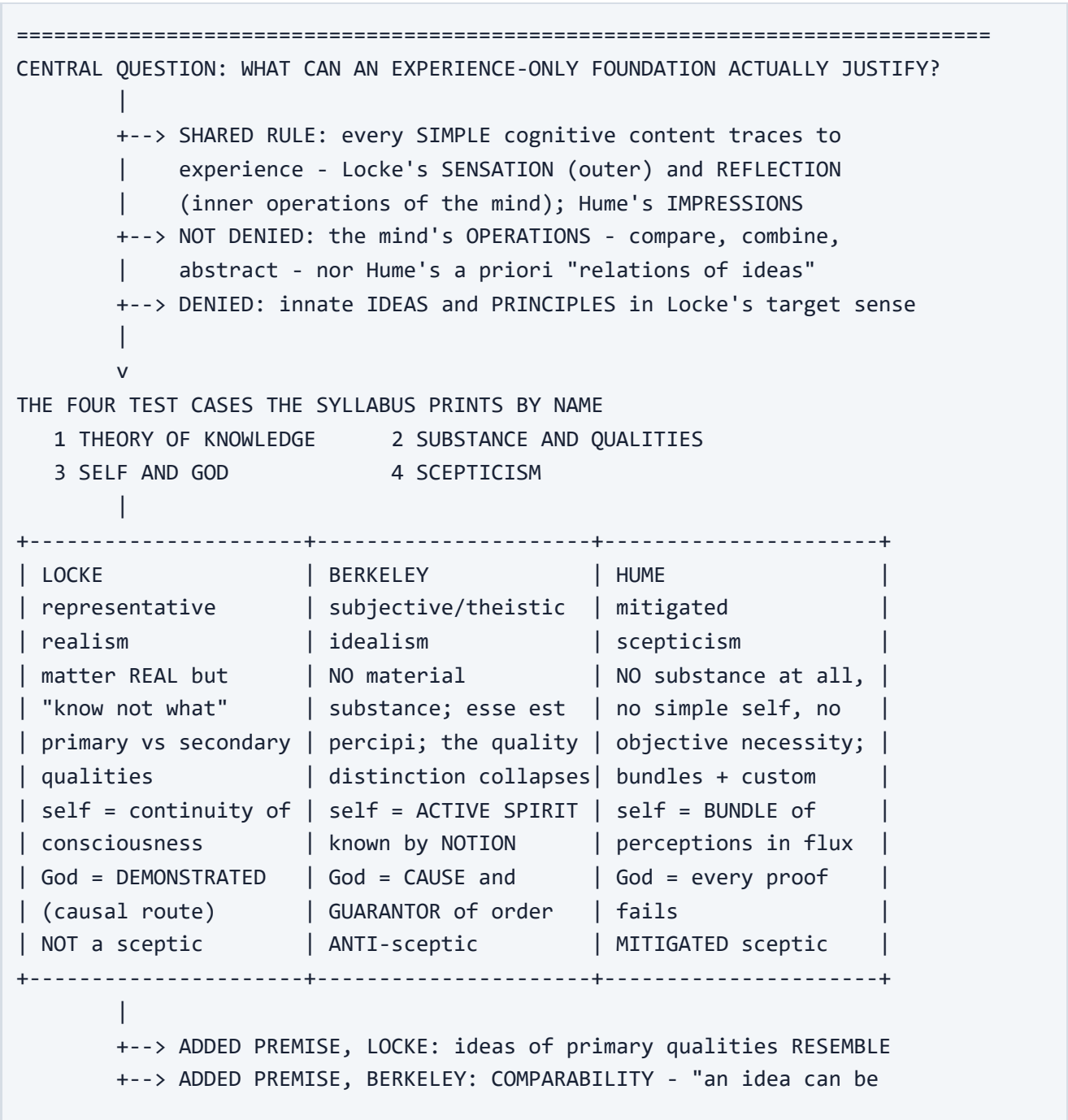
1. "Berkeley denies the external world" — he denies **matter as an unperceiving substratum**.
2. "Hume denies causation" — he denies **objective necessary connexion**, not causal inference.
3. "Secondary qualities are illusions" — they are **powers**.
4. "Locke denies substance" — he denies **knowledge of its nature**.
5. "*Tabula rasa*" quoted as Locke's words — it is the tradition's label.
6. "Hume says the self does not exist" — no **simple identical substance**; the perceptions are real.
7. "Kant proves the soul" — he supplies a **formal condition** of unified experience.

8. Berkeley called a sceptic — he is an **anti-sceptic** who blames the materialist.
9. Berkeley called an early Hegel — subjective versus absolute idealism differ in **kind**.
10. Quine's "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" imported here — it belongs to Topic 11.

**Memory chain — say it in fifteen seconds.** *One rule about the origin of content, applied three times. Locke keeps matter he cannot inspect; Berkeley deletes matter and keeps spirits and God; Hume deletes substance, the simple self and objective necessity, and keeps perceptions, custom and natural belief. Necessity moves from the object to the observer. Kant enters only where a question routes him — apperception for the self, the Second Analogy for causation.*

## COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

### ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/48: Central question, the shared rule and the realism-idealism-scepticism route



| like nothing but an idea" (Principles Sec.8)  
+--> ADDED PREMISE, HUME: ATOMISM of impressions - no relation  
is given WITH its terms

|  
v

MNEMONICS: slide "R -> I -> S" | deletions "M-S-N" (Matter, Substantial  
self, objective Necessity) | scepticism "H-A-M" (Humble, Anti-  
sceptical, Mitigated)

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/48: Central question, the shared rule and the realism-idealism-scepticism route (continued)

=====

SYLLABUS (verbatim): "Empiricism (Locke, Berkeley, Hume) : Theory of  
Knowledge; Substance and Qualities; Self and God; Scepticism."  
Paper I, Section A, item 3.

CORPUS SIGNAL: 12 primary-owned parts of 112 Western parts, 2018-2025;  
at least one part in EVERY year of the corpus.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/48: Chronology I - Locke's text, editions and the sections that matter

=====

1632-1704 JOHN LOCKE      born Wrington, Somerset; died Oates, Essex

1689    An Essay Concerning Human Understanding is published  
CAUTION: the title page prints 1690 and the work is almost  
always cited as 1690; both dates are correct in their own sense

1690    Essay as dated - Book I    anti-innatism  
                                  Book II    ideas, qualities, substance  
                                  Book III   words, abstraction, essence  
                                  Book IV   knowledge, degrees, probability, God

1694    SECOND EDITION ADDS II.xxvii "Of Identity and Diversity"  
CAUTION: personal identity is NOT in the original text; never  
date the doctrine to 1690

1700    Fourth edition - the text most modern editions follow  
(standard scholarly text: Nidditch, Clarendon 1975)

|

SECTION MAP - CITE BY BOOK.CHAPTER.SECTION, WHICH IS EDITION-INVARIANT

II.i.2      "white paper, void of all characters"

II.viii     primary and secondary qualities; the resemblance thesis

II.xxiii.2   "a supposition of he knows not what support of such  
                                  qualities"

II.xxvii.9   the definition of a person

III.iii.1    everything that exists is particular

III.iii.2-4   separate names for every particular are impossible

III.iii.6-9   abstraction: separation from time, place, concomitants

- III.iii.11 "the inventions and creatures of the understanding"
- III.iii.15 the abstract idea annexed to a sortal name = NOMINAL ESSENCE
- IV.vii.9 the general triangle: "all and none of these at once";  
"something imperfect, that cannot exist"

PROVENANCE: "tabula rasa" is SCHOLASTIC/ARISTOTELIAN vocabulary applied to Locke by the tradition. It is NOT his phrase. Write: the mind as "white paper, void of all characters" - the doctrine traditionally labelled tabula rasa.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/48: Chronology II - Berkeley and Hume, with the section map and cautions

```
=====
1685-1753 GEORGE BERKELEY Irish; Anglican bishop of Cloyne from 1734
1710 A Treatise concerning the Principles of Human Knowledge
1713 Three Dialogues between Hylas and Philonous
```

### SECTION MAP

```
Intro Sec.6-25 the attack on abstract general ideas
Intro Sec.12 "made to represent or stand for all other particular
 ideas of the same sort"

Intro Sec.13 Locke's triangle quoted VERBATIM back at him
Intro Sec.19-20 words do not always stand for ideas
Sec.1-4 the semantic argument
Sec.3 esse est percipi - Berkeley's OWN Latin
Sec.8 the likeness principle
Sec.9-15 the parity collapse of the quality distinction
Sec.22-23 the Master Argument
Sec.27, 89, 140 spirits known by NOTION, not by idea
Sec.6, 30-33, 48 God causes and sustains the order of ideas
CAUTION: "esse est percipi aut percipere" is a LATER COMMENTATORS'
EXPANSION made to accommodate spirits. Never quote it as Berkeley's.
```

|

```
1711-1776 DAVID HUME born and died in Edinburgh
1739-40 A Treatise of Human Nature
I.i.1 impressions and ideas; the missing shade of blue
I.iii.14 the search for the impression of necessary connexion
I.iv.2 constancy, coherence and the belief in body
I.iv.6 "a bundle or collection of different perceptions"
Appendix the RETRACTION: he cannot state the uniting principle
1748 An Enquiry concerning Human Understanding
CAUTION: published 1748 as Philosophical Essays concerning Human
Understanding; RENAMED 1758. Hume disowned the Treatise as a
juvenile work, and the Enquiry DROPS personal identity. Say which
text you are using.
II copy principle | IV induction | V custom, "the great guide of
```

human life" | VII necessary connexion + the TWO definitions |  
X miracles | XII mitigated scepticism; "commit it then to the  
flames" (aimed at "divinity or school metaphysics")  
1779 Dialogues concerning Natural Religion (POSTHUMOUS) - the  
critique of the design argument  
|  
18th c. JOSEPH BUTLER and THOMAS REID (Reid 1710-1796): the circularity

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/48: Chronology II - Berkeley and Hume, with the section map and cautions (continued)

```
=====
charge and the Brave Officer against Locke on personal identity
REPORTED Samuel Johnson kicks a stone - "I refute it thus!"
CAUTION: RECEPTION, not an argument. Berkeley never denied the
stone is felt; felt resistance is exactly what he calls a stone.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/48: Locke: the three grounds against innate ideas and the surviving innatism

```
=====
INNATIST CLAIM UNDER ATTACK (Essay, Book I): certain ideas and principles
- God, identity, non-contradiction, moral rules - are stamped on the mind
at birth.
```

```
|
+--> GROUND 1 UNIVERSAL ASSENT FAILS
```

```
| if innate, ALL humans - including children and "idiots" -
| would possess them; manifestly they do not
| TARGET: the innatist appeal to universal agreement
| STATUS: empirical; a dispositional innatist can absorb it
|
```

```
+--> GROUND 2 NO UNCONSCIOUS IDEAS <== DECISIVE
```

```
| a thought the mind does not think is self-contradictory,
| because for Locke "to be IN the mind" = "to be PERCEIVED by
| the mind"
| TARGET: the retreat to ideas present but unnoticed
| STATUS: a STIPULATION about the meaning of "idea", not an
| observation - and this is what closes the escape route
|
```

```
+--> GROUND 3 A GENETIC ACCOUNT IS AVAILABLE (redundancy)
```

```
every idea CLAIMED innate can be traced to sensation or
reflection; if experience suffices, innateness is idle
STATUS: empirical; inconclusive against a capacity claim
```

```
|
v
```

```
DESCARTES' DISPOSITIONAL REPLY: innate ideas were never claimed to be
```

consciously present from birth; they are CAPACITIES of the intellect, elicited on an appropriate occasion, as a family disease is innate before it appears.

|

v

#### ADJUDICATION

AGAINST NAIVE INNATISM (consciously possessed inborn propositions):

Locke wins outright.

AGAINST DISPOSITIONAL INNATISM: ground 1 misses, ground 3 is inconclusive, and everything turns on ground 2 - a stipulation.

THE SURVIVOR, NAMED: Leibniz - "nothing is in the intellect that was not first in the senses, EXCEPT THE INTELLECT ITSELF". Innatism survives as a thesis about STRUCTURE, the form Kant vindicates.

PYQ ANCHOR: 2022 Q4(c) demands why and how; 2023 Q2(c) is decided on the

### ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/48: Locke: the three grounds against innate ideas and the surviving innatism (continued)

=====

dispositional reply.

### ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/48: Locke: the two fountains and the construction of complex ideas

=====

EXPERIENCE HAS TWO CHANNELS - AND OMITTING THE SECOND WRECKS THE ANSWER

|                              |                                |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| SENSATION (outer sense)      | REFLECTION (inner sense)       |
| colour, sound, taste, smell, | thinking, doubting, believing, |
| warmth, solidity, extension, | willing, reasoning, knowing -  |
| figure, motion, number       | the mind observing ITSELF      |
| \                            | /                              |
| v                            | v                              |

SIMPLE IDEAS - PASSIVELY RECEIVED

the mind can neither make nor destroy one; a person born blind has no idea of scarlet

|

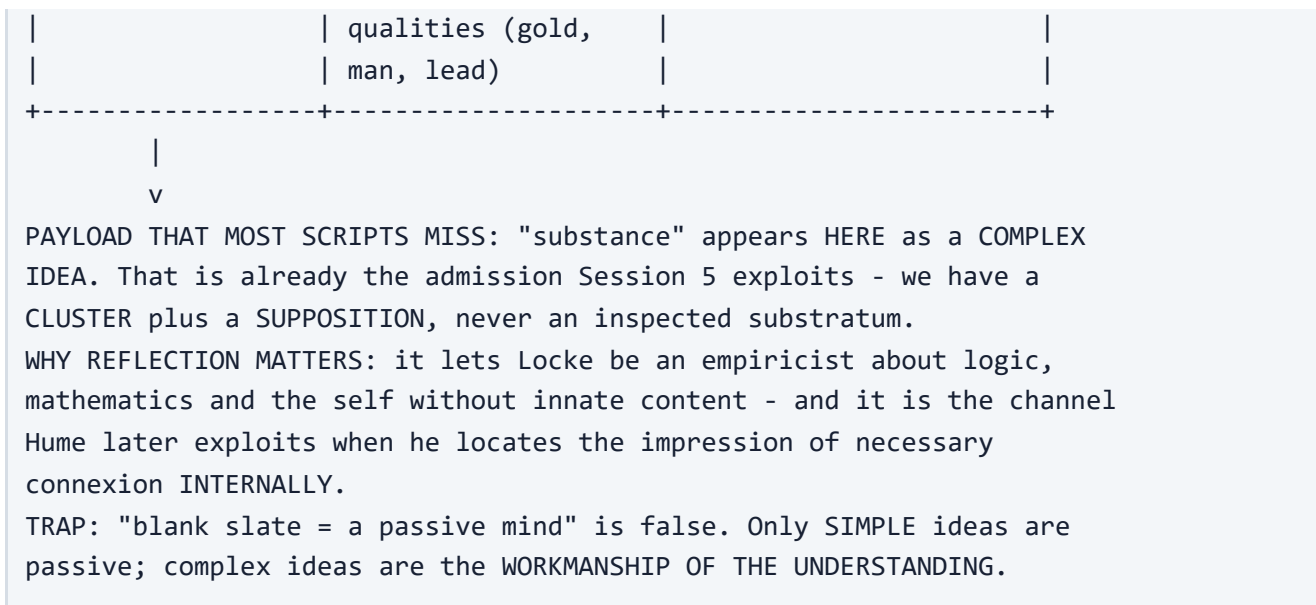
ACTIVE OPERATIONS: COMBINE | COMPARE | ABSTRACT

|

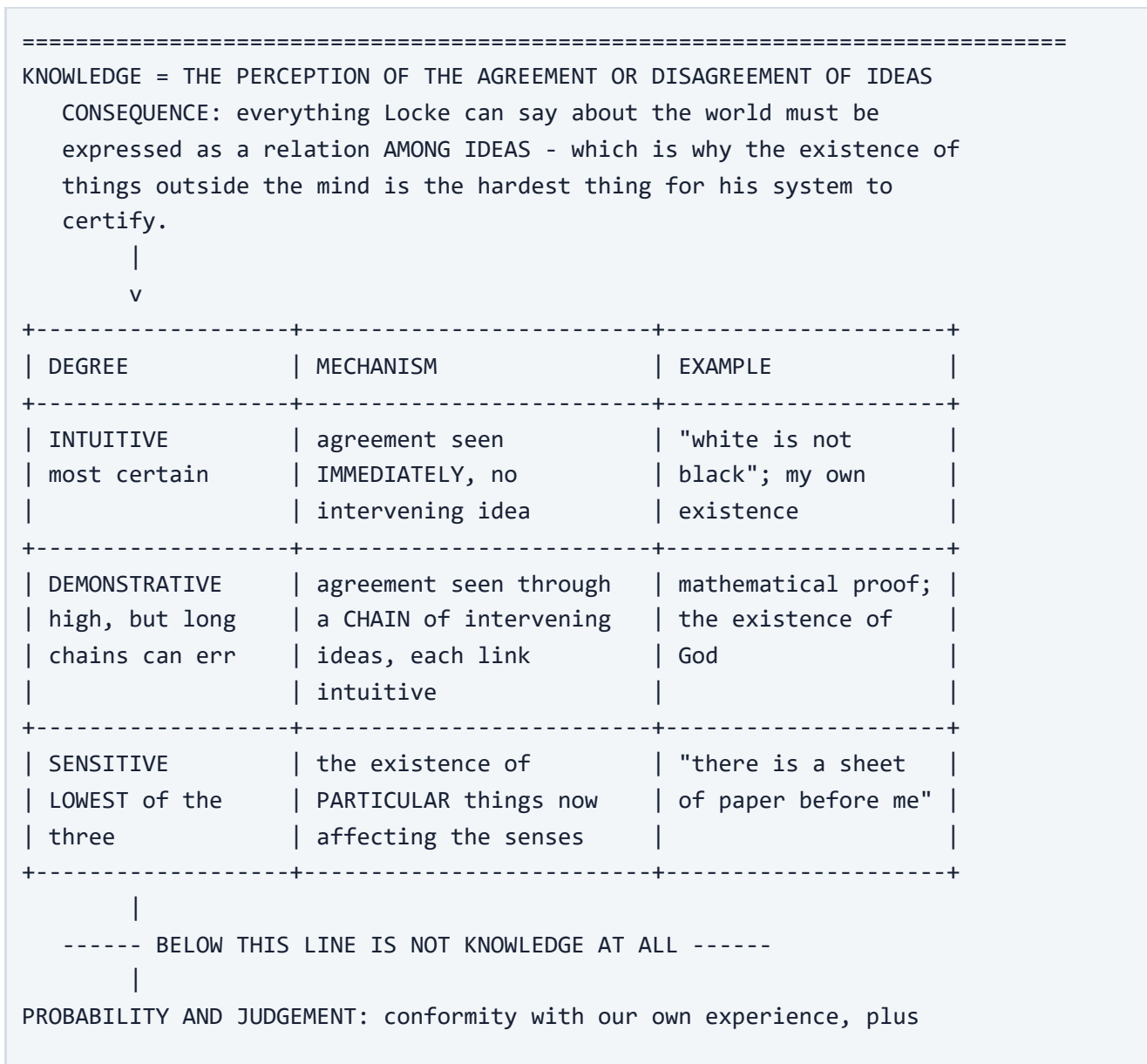
v

COMPLEX IDEAS - THREE KINDS

|                   |                      |                         |
|-------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| +-----+           | +-----+              | +-----+                 |
| MODES             | SUBSTANCES           | RELATIONS               |
| dependent combi-  | supposed INDEPENDENT | produced by COMPARING   |
| nations: triangle | bearers, represented | one thing with another: |
| gratitude, number | through clusters of  | cause, identity, moral  |
|                   | co-occurring         | relation                |



ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/48: Locke: knowledge, the three degrees and the domain of probability



testimony weighed by number, integrity, skill and consistency.  
Here live natural philosophy, all history and everyday reasoning.

|  
v

THE EXAMINABLE POINT: the EXTERNAL WORLD sits on the WEAKEST rung. Rich sources, NARROW certification. That asymmetry - not any sceptical intention - is what destabilises representative realism.

UNRESOLVED TENSION: sensitive knowledge and high probability shade into one another, and Locke never draws the boundary sharply.

PYQ ANCHOR: 2022 Q4(c), second limb - "the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology".

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/48: Locke: representative realism, the veil objection and what survives

```
=====
THE CHAIN LOCKE ACCEPTS
 EXTERNAL BODY --acts on--> SENSE ORGAN --produces--> IDEA IN MIND
 (has primary qualities; (mechanically (the ONLY thing
 real essence unknown) affected) ever inspected)
 |
 KNOWLEDGE OPERATES ONLY AT THE THIRD TERM: agreement AMONG IDEAS
 |
THE REPRESENTATION CLAIM
 ideas of PRIMARY qualities RESEMBLE their causes
 ideas of SECONDARY qualities resemble NOTHING in the object
 |
 v
THE VEIL OBJECTION - STATE IT YOURSELF BEFORE THE EXAMINER DOES
 To check that an idea resembles its cause I must COMPARE the two.
 But I can only ever inspect the IDEA. So the resemblance is a claim
 I am, IN PRINCIPLE, unable to test.
 ("Veil of perception" is the CRITICS' image, not Locke's phrase.)
 |
 +--> LOCKE'S FOUR DEFENCES
 | 1 sense ideas are INVOLUNTARY
 | 2 DIFFERENT SENSES AGREE about the same body
 | 3 pleasure and pain accompany real bodies in ways
 | imagination cannot reproduce
 | 4 God would not construct us to be SYSTEMATICALLY DECEIVED
 | in what matters for the conduct of life
 |
 v
WHAT SURVIVES / WHAT IS EXPOSED
 SURVIVES: a CAUSAL and STRUCTURAL representation claim - this idea
 was produced by that body, and measurable structure corresponds
```

EXPOSED: the further QUALITATIVE RESEMBLANCE claim - and that is the exact target of Principles Sec.8

|

v

LOCKE IS NOT A SCEPTIC: he denies knowledge of real essences and of the intrinsic nature of substance, not knowledge sufficient for "the conveniences of life and the information of virtue".

NEVER WRITE: "Locke leads to scepticism" as if he endorsed it. Write: his structure MAKES A SCEPTICAL CHALLENGE AVAILABLE, and Berkeley claims

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/48: Locke: representative realism, the veil objection and what survives (continued)

=====

to remove the challenge by removing the veil.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/48: Locke: abstraction - the eight numbered steps and the general representative

=====

THE PROBLEM: everything that EXISTS is particular; almost every WORD is general. How can a mind furnished only with particular ideas use general words?

|

v

THE ARGUMENT, NUMBERED Essay III.iii and IV.vii.9

- 1 Everything that exists is PARTICULAR III.iii.1
- 2 A separate name for every particular is impossible -  
memory could not hold them and communication would fail III.iii.2-4
- 3 THEREFORE language requires GENERAL TERMS
- 4 Words are general ONLY by being signs of GENERAL IDEAS III.iii.6  
(meaning is always mediated by an idea in the mind)
- 5 Ideas become general when the mind SEPARATES them from  
circumstances of time, place and every concomitant idea III.iii.6-9
- 6 What remains serves as a "GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE" of all  
particulars of the same sort
- 7 The abstract idea annexed to a sortal name IS the  
NOMINAL ESSENCE by which we classify III.iii.15  
-> classification is the WORKMANSHIP OF THE UNDERSTANDING,  
not a reading-off of real essences
- 8 "General and universal belong not to the real existence of  
things; they are the inventions and creatures of the  
understanding, made by it for its own use, and concern  
only signs" III.iii.11

|

v

POSITION NAMED: LOCKE IS A CONCEPTUALIST - neither a Platonic realist about universals nor a bare nominalist. Naming the position is a one-word gain in precision most scripts never make.

|

v

WHY THE DOCTRINE IS NOT OPTIONAL: without it Locke has no account of classification, of definition, or of the nominal essences on which the whole of Book III depends. Berkeley understood this exactly, which is why he attacks ABSTRACTION FIRST, in the INTRODUCTION, before saying a word about matter.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 13/48: Locke: the general triangle, the two essences and four presuppositions

```
=====
THE CANONICAL EXAMPLE - AND THE ADMISSION Essay IV.vii.9
+-----+
| The general idea of a triangle "must be neither oblique nor |
| rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but ALL |
| AND NONE of these at once." |
| Locke concedes it is "SOMETHING IMPERFECT, THAT CANNOT EXIST", and |
| that framing it "requires some pains and skill." |
| -> Berkeley quotes this passage VERBATIM at Principles Intro Sec.13 |
+-----+
|
| v
TWO ESSENCES - KEEP THEM APART
+-----+-----+
NOMINAL ESSENCE	REAL ESSENCE
the abstract idea annexed to	the internal constitution -
the general name: "gold" =	Locke's arrangement of
yellow, heavy, malleable,	"insensible corpuscles" -
soluble in aqua regia	which observable properties
	flow
KNOWN - we made it	UNKNOWN - we posit it
fixes CLASSIFICATION	fixes nothing we can use
+-----+-----+	
CONSEQUENCE: species boundaries are CONVENTIONAL IN THEIR SHARPNESS	
though not arbitrary in their materials. Locke is AGNOSTIC about	
real essences without DENYING that things have them.	
v	
FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS THE ARGUMENT NEEDS
P1 MEANING IS IDEATIONAL - a word signifies by standing for an idea
P2 IDEAS ARE IMAGISTIC and particular in origin
P3 MENTAL SUBTRACTION is possible and leaves something contentful
```

P4 ONE IDEA PER GENERAL WORD - generality lives in the IDEA, not in the USE of the word

BERKELEY destroys P2 and P3. WITTGENSTEIN later destroys P1 and P4.

|

v

LOCKE'S BEST REPLY - AND THE PRICE

REPLY: the abstract idea is PARTIAL, not CONTRADICTIONARY - three-sidedness with the angles LEFT UNDETERMINED, not with contradictory

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 14/48: Locke: the general triangle, the two essences and four presuppositions (continued)

=====

angles ASSIGNED. Determinables need not be determinate.

PRICE: this requires giving up the IMAGISTIC model of ideas that Locke elsewhere retains; the abstract idea becomes a non-imagistic act of the understanding, and so is no longer an "idea" in his own official sense.

EXECUTABLE VERDICT: Berkeley wins against the IMAGISTIC Locke and loses against the DETERMINABLE Locke. The lasting casualty is the IDEATIONAL THEORY OF MEANING, whose true heir is Wittgenstein, not Hume.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 15/48: Locke: primary and secondary qualities - the table and the two theses

=====

| +-----+-----+                  |                              |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------|
| PRIMARY QUALITIES              | SECONDARY QUALITIES          |
| +-----+-----+                  |                              |
| solidity, extension, figure,   | colour, sound, taste, smell, |
| motion/rest, number            | warmth/cold                  |
| really IN the object           | POWERS in the object to      |
|                                | produce sensations in us     |
| our ideas of them RESEMBLE the | our ideas do NOT resemble    |
| qualities themselves           | anything in the object       |
| INSEPARABLE from body - every  | DEPEND on the perceiver's    |
| fragment retains them          | sense-organs                 |
| +-----+-----+                  |                              |

BASIS OF THE DIVISION: primary qualities are those ANY body must have however small; they enter the explanation of what bodies do. Secondary qualities are RELATIONAL - primary-quality configurations ACTING ON our sense-organs.

TEST TO REMEMBER: cut the sugar cube to invisibility. Shape survives the slicing; sweetness does not, because sweetness was always a relation to a taster.

|

v

TWO SEPARABLE THESES - SEPARATING THEM IS THE 2024 ANSWER

THESIS A the EXPLANATORY division: which properties a physics must attribute to bodies

THESIS B the RESEMBLANCE picture: ideas of the first group PICTURE their causes

|

---> BERKELEY'S PARITY ARGUMENT (Sec.9-15; Dialogues I) hits A  
| extension cannot be conceived without colour; motion/rest  
| are relative to the observer; figure is inseparable from  
| extension. Apparent size varies with distance, motion with  
| frame, shape with angle.

| ANSWER: perceptual relativity does NOT entail mind-  
| dependence. Looking different from different positions is  
| exactly what a mind-INDEPENDENT thing with a real shape  
| should produce.

|

---> BERKELEY'S LIKENESS PRINCIPLE (Sec.8) hits B - AND LANDS  
"an idea can be like nothing but an idea"; and if the

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 16/48: Locke: primary and secondary qualities - the table and the two theses (continued)

=====

originals are unperceivable, no comparison is possible, so  
a resemblance we could never check is EMPTY.

RESCUE FOR LOCKE: ISOMORPHISM - structural or mathematical  
correspondence needs no qualitative likeness; a map  
corresponds to terrain without being terrain-coloured.

|

v

EXECUTABLE VERDICT: the distinction survives as MEASURABLE-STRUCTURAL vs  
RESPONSE-DEPENDENT properties, but NOT as Locke's resemblance thesis.

His mistake was to make the division depend on a PICTURE rather than on  
EXPLANATORY ROLE - which is why physics keeps the distinction and  
Locke's version of it does not.

TRAP: "secondary qualities are illusions" - they are POWERS.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 17/48: Locke: the substratum, stated exactly, defended fairly, and attacked

=====

WE MEET CLUSTERS THAT REGULARLY GO TOGETHER

yellow + heavy + malleable + soluble in aqua regia = "gold"

|

WE CANNOT CONCEIVE QUALITIES AS SUBSISTING BY THEMSELVES

```

|
v
SO WE SUPPOSE A SUBSTRATUM THAT SUPPORTS THEM
Essay II.xxiii.2 - the exact words:
"a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities"
|
+--> WHAT IS DENIED: any POSITIVE IDEA of the substratum; any
| knowledge of the REAL ESSENCE it embodies
+--> WHAT IS AFFIRMED: that something is qualified - qualities
 do not float
|
v
THE FAIREST DEFENCE: the substratum is an EXPLANATORY POSIT tied to the
stability of qualities and kinds, NOT a claimed object of intuition.
|
v
BERKELEY'S REPLY - AND WHY IT IS DECISIVE FOR HIS SYSTEM
"Support" here is a DEAD METAPHOR borrowed from pillars and floors.
Strip the metaphor and what remains is the ABSTRACT IDEA OF BEING
plus the RELATIVE NOTION OF SUPPORTING - which is precisely an
ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEA.
THEREFORE, if abstraction is impossible, "matter" is not a mysterious
UNKNOWN but a MEANINGLESS EXPRESSION.
THEREFORE Berkeley's IMMATERIALISM RESTS ON HIS NOMINALISM, not the
reverse.
|
v
FIX THE THREE POSITIONS BY THEIR VERBS - THEY ARE EASY TO SWAP
LOCKE SUPPOSES a support whose nature is unknown
BERKELEY DENIES THE SENSE of the expression "material substance"
HUME DISSOLVES substance into a stable BUNDLE of qualities, and
 does so for SPIRITUAL substance as well
TRAP: "Locke denies substance" is false. He denies KNOWLEDGE OF ITS
NATURE and affirms its existence.

```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 18/48: Locke: personal identity - three identities, the criterion, the case

```

=====
QUESTION: WHAT MAKES THE PERSON AT T2 THE SAME AS THE PERSON AT T1?
|
v
FIRST SEPARATE THREE QUESTIONS THAT PREDECESSORS RAN TOGETHER
+-----+-----+
| SAME SUBSTANCE | sameness of the material or immaterial |
| | bearer - unknowable to us in the |

```

|                                                                                                                                                                       |                                            |   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---|
|                                                                                                                                                                       | immaterial case                            |   |
| +                                                                                                                                                                     | +                                          | + |
| SAME MAN (human                                                                                                                                                       | participation in ONE CONTINUED LIFE of the |   |
| animal)                                                                                                                                                               | same organised living body                 |   |
| +                                                                                                                                                                     | +                                          | + |
| SAME PERSON                                                                                                                                                           | the extension of PRESENT CONSCIOUSNESS     |   |
|                                                                                                                                                                       | over past thoughts and actions             |   |
| +                                                                                                                                                                     | +                                          | + |
| LOCKE'S RADICALISM IS THE SEPARATION ITSELF: the same man may be two persons, or the same person two men.                                                             |                                            |   |
|                                                                                                                                                                       |                                            |   |
| v                                                                                                                                                                     |                                            |   |
| DEFINITION                                                                                                                                                            | Essay II.xxvii.9                           |   |
| a person is "a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places" |                                            |   |
| -> self-reflexive awareness is written INTO the definition, so the identity condition must be an AWARENESS condition                                                  |                                            |   |
| -> chapter ADDED IN THE SECOND EDITION, 1694                                                                                                                          |                                            |   |
|                                                                                                                                                                       |                                            |   |
| v                                                                                                                                                                     |                                            |   |
| CRITERION: present consciousness APPROPRIATES a past thought or action                                                                                                |                                            |   |
| MEMORY is the chief MECHANISM and EVIDENCE of the backward extension; the CONSTITUTIVE notion is CONSCIOUSNESS.                                                       |                                            |   |
| CAUTION: reducing the theory to bare memory INTENSIFIES the circularity problem - the precise formulation is itself a defence.                                        |                                            |   |
| FORENSIC CONCEPT: "person" belongs to law and to reward and punishment; we are accountable only for acts we can appropriate.                                          |                                            |   |
|                                                                                                                                                                       |                                            |   |
| v                                                                                                                                                                     |                                            |   |
| THE PRINCE AND THE COBBLER                                                                                                                                            |                                            |   |
| prince's consciousness --transferred into--> cobbler's body                                                                                                           |                                            |   |

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 19/48: Locke: personal identity - three identities, the criterion, the case (continued)

```
=====
THE PERSON who wakes is the PRINCE | THE MAN who wakes is the COBBLER
THEREFORE personal identity is NEITHER BODILY NOR SUBSTANTIAL
identity - established without any commitment about souls.
PYQ ANCHOR: 2021 Q1(d) "Examine" - doctrine AND test are both required.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 20/48: Locke: the objections to personal identity, the repairs and the verdict

```
=====
OBJECTION 1 - CIRCULARITY SOURCE: Butler, Reid
+-----+
| I can remember only MY OWN experiences. So "genuine memory" already|
| presupposes identity. If identity is DEFINED by memory, the |
| definition is circular. |
+-----+
 REPLY: distinguish the CONSTITUTIVE criterion (consciousness) from
 the EVIDENTIAL criterion (memory).
 RESIDUAL: "consciousness of X AS MINE" may smuggle the same
 ownership back in. The charge remains genuinely open.
 |
OBJECTION 2 - TRANSITIVITY FAILS: REID'S BRAVE OFFICER
+-----+
| BOY (flogged at school) <--remembers-- YOUNG OFFICER |
| YOUNG OFFICER <--remembers-- OLD GENERAL |
| BOY <--NOT remembered by-- OLD GENERAL |
| So: boy = officer, officer = general, but boy != general. |
| Identity is TRANSITIVE. Locke's criterion, read as bare episodic |
| memory, is not. |
+-----+
 REPAIR: OVERLAPPING CHAINS - identity is the ANCESTRAL of direct
 appropriation.
 RESIDUAL: transitivity is restored, but the theory is no longer the
 simple memory criterion the textbooks attribute to Locke.
 |
OBJECTION 3 - GAPS: dreamless sleep, anaesthesia, amnesia
 REPLY: continuous CAPACITY for appropriation, not constant
 recollection.
 RESIDUAL: capacity-talk strains the account, and Locke concedes that
 whether the same substance persists through a gap is unknowable.
 |
 v
EXECUTABLE VERDICT: best defended as a REPAIRED PSYCHOLOGICAL-CONTINUITY
account. On that reading it survives Reid; the circularity charge stays
open. FORENSICALLY INDISPENSABLE, METAPHYSICALLY INCOMPLETE.
 Saying exactly this is what the directive "examine" requires.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 21/48: Locke on God, and the premise Hume will later refuse to certify

```
=====
HOW IS GOD KNOWN? - PLACE IT ON LOCKE'S OWN LADDER
```

NOT by INTUITION (that would be the ontological strategy)  
NOT by SENSITIVE knowledge (reserved for particular present things)  
BY DEMONSTRATION - the SECOND degree

|  
v

#### THE CHAIN

- 1 I exist, and I know it with INTUITIVE certainty
- 2 Something cannot come from nothing
- 3 Therefore there has existed FROM ETERNITY a most powerful and most knowing being

|  
v

CLASSIFICATION: a COSMOLOGICAL-STYLE argument conducted INSIDE an empiricist framework. God is reached ABOVE the external world and BELOW self-knowledge on the ladder of degrees.

|  
v

#### THE EXPOSED PREMISE - THE CLEANEST LINK IN THE WHOLE ITEM

Step 2 is the CAUSAL PRINCIPLE. Hume will refuse to certify it, because there is NO IMPRESSION of causal necessity. Locke's proof of God therefore fails at exactly the point where Hume's analysis of causation bites.

-> Use this link in ANY comparative answer on God in this item.

|  
v

#### WHAT LOCKE DOES NOT SAY

There is NO INNATE IDEA OF GOD. That was one of the candidates Book I explicitly dismissed - so an answer that gives Locke an innate idea of God contradicts the foundation of his system.

COMPARISON PREVIEW: Locke uses God as a SUPPORT (guarantor of our faculties); Berkeley REQUIRES him as a MECHANISM (cause and continuity); Hume treats him as a CASUALTY (no proof survives).

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 22/48: Berkeley: the demolition of abstraction, the replacement and the payload

=====

BERKELEY'S DEMOLITION, NUMBERED Principles, Introduction Sec.6-25

- 1 I CONCEDE I can imagine particular things I have perceived, and compound and divide such ideas - a hand without a body, a headless torso. This is SEPARATION OF PARTS THAT COULD EXIST APART.
- 2 But ABSTRACTION PROPER requires separating what CANNOT exist apart: extension without any colour; motion without a determinate speed; "man" without any determinate stature or complexion.
- 3 Locke's own triangle - neither equilateral nor scalene, yet ALL AND NONE at once - is SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY; no such idea can be framed.

(Berkeley quotes the passage VERBATIM at Intro Sec.13.)

4 THEREFORE there are no abstract general ideas.

5 POSITIVE REPLACEMENT: an idea is general not by being abstract but "BY BEING MADE TO REPRESENT OR STAND FOR ALL OTHER PARTICULAR IDEAS OF THE SAME SORT" (Intro Sec.12). A determinate particular idea, SELECTIVELY ATTENDED TO, does duty for a class: the geometer draws THIS black inch-long line and proves a theorem about ALL lines.

6 COROLLARY AGAINST THE WHOLE TRADITION: words do not always stand for ideas at all; language also RAISES PASSION, PROMPTS ACTION and DISPOSES THE MIND (Intro Sec.19-20). This is a genuine anticipation of the later claim that meaning is USE.

7 METAPHYSICAL PAYLOAD: Locke's MATERIAL SUBSTANCE IN GENERAL and SUBSTRATUM are precisely abstract general ideas - the abstract idea of BEING plus the relative notion of SUPPORTING. If abstraction is impossible, "matter" is not a mysterious unknown but a MEANINGLESS EXPRESSION. IMMATERIALISM RESTS ON THE NOMINALISM, NOT THE REVERSE.

|

v

WHAT IS DENIED AND WHAT IS NOT

DENIED: ABSTRACT general ideas.

NOT DENIED: general ideas, general words, general knowledge. Geometry proceeds perfectly well on Berkeley's account.

|

v

TWO LIMITS TO STATE YOURSELF

LIMIT 1 The argument works only against an IMAGISTIC reading of ideas. Locke's DETERMINABLE reply - undetermined, not contradictory - escapes step 3.

LIMIT 2 THE UNPAID BILL: what fixes the RESPECT under which the particular idea represents its class? If the answer is a further

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 23/48: Berkeley: the demolition of abstraction, the replacement and the payload (continued)

=====

idea of the respect, the abstract idea has RETURNED under another name; if it is a practice of use, Berkeley has moved beyond the theory of ideas altogether - the direction step 6 points.

PYQ ANCHOR: 2025 Q4(c) is this panel plus the Locke doctrine it refutes.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 24/48: Berkeley: arguments 1 and 2 - the semantic argument and the likeness principle

=====

ARGUMENT 1 - SEMANTIC / ANALYTIC

Principles Sec.1-4

1 The objects of human knowledge are IDEAS: (a) imprinted on the

senses, (b) perceived by attending to the passions and operations of the mind, (c) formed by memory and imagination.

2 "SENSIBLE THINGS" MEANS things IMMEDIATELY perceived by sense.

(This is the sense of the phrase quoted in PYQ 2021 Q1(c).)

3 An apple, a stone, a tree, a book are NOTHING BUT COLLECTIONS of such immediately perceived ideas.

4 It is impossible that ideas should exist unperceived - their ESSE is PERCIPI; existence for them CONSISTS IN being perceived.

5 THEREFORE for sensible things ESSE EST PERCIPI (Sec.3), and to speak of their "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is UNINTELLIGIBLE.

PRESUPPOSITION: step 3 is a DEFINITION, not a discovery. Grant it and immaterialism follows in four lines; deny it and nothing follows.

THE WORD DOING THE WORK: "IMMEDIATELY". Locke held we perceive ideas that REPRESENT objects, so the object is reached MEDIATELY, by inference. Berkeley's definition removes the inference, and with it the veil and the sceptical problem the veil generated.

BERKELEY'S OWN ILLUSTRATION (Sec.3): "The table I write on, I say, exists; that is, I see and feel it."

|

#### ARGUMENT 2 - THE LIKENESS PRINCIPLE

Principles Sec.8

1 Locke says our ideas of primary qualities RESEMBLE qualities in bodies.

2 But "AN IDEA CAN BE LIKE NOTHING BUT AN IDEA" - a colour or figure can be like nothing but another colour or figure.

3 If the supposed originals are UNPERCEIVABLE, no comparison with them is even possible; a resemblance-claim we could NEVER IN PRINCIPLE CHECK is empty.

4 THEREFORE the representative-realist relation of resemblance between idea and material quality is UNINTELLIGIBLE.

PRESUPPOSITION: resemblance requires COMPARABILITY BY A PERCEIVER.

STRONGEST OBJECTION: STRUCTURAL or MATHEMATICAL resemblance

(ISOMORPHISM) does not require qualitative likeness - a map resembles terrain without being terrain-coloured. This is the standard modern RESCUE OF LOCKE, and it concedes the qualitative point while saving the representational relation.

### ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 25/48: Berkeley: arguments 3 and 4 - parity and the Master Argument

#### ARGUMENT 3 - PARITY

Principles Sec.9-15; Dialogues I

LOGICAL FORM: a PARITY argument. Every relativity consideration Locke accepts for SECONDARY qualities - variation with observer, with organ, with medium - applies equally to PRIMARY ones:

apparent SIZE varies with distance

MOTION and rest are relative to the frame of reference  
SHAPE varies with the angle of view  
EXTENSION cannot be conceived without colour or some visual  
quality; FIGURE is inseparable from extension

- 1 Locke ADMITS secondary qualities are mind-dependent.
  - 2 Primary qualities are EQUALLY mind-dependent by the same tests.
  - 3 THEREFORE all qualities are ideas.
  - 4 THEREFORE there is NOTHING LEFT for "material substance" to be.
- PRESUPPOSITION: perceptual relativity ENTAILS mind-dependence.  
OBJECTION: it does NOT. That a thing looks different from different  
positions is what one should EXPECT of a mind-INDEPENDENT thing with  
a real shape. So parity is suggestive, not decisive - which is why  
the 2024 answer must identify the LIKENESS principle as the weapon  
that actually does the work.

|

#### ARGUMENT 4 - THE MASTER ARGUMENT

Principles Sec.22-23

- 1 Berkeley stakes everything on one challenge: CONCEIVE ONE EXTENDED  
MOVABLE BODY EXISTING UNCONCEIVED, and he will concede materialism.
  - 2 You reply that you can easily conceive a tree standing alone in a  
park with nobody by.
  - 3 But IN DOING SO YOU ARE CONCEIVING IT - so you have framed ideas in  
your own mind and have NOT conceived the tree UNCONCEIVED at all.
  - 4 THEREFORE the supposition is SELF-REFUTING; unperceived existence  
cannot even be entertained.
- PRESUPPOSITION (AND THE FATAL ONE): that conceiving "X EXISTING  
UNCONCEIVED" requires the ACT of conceiving to be part of the CONTENT  
conceived.
- STRONGEST OBJECTION (Russell; refined by Prior and Gallois): a SCOPE  
or USE-MENTION confusion. What is inconceivable is "I conceive OF X  
THAT IT IS NOT CONCEIVED BY ME"; what is required is only "I conceive  
THAT X exists and is not conceived" - perfectly coherent, exactly as  
I can THINK ABOUT an unthought-of number.
- BERKELEY'S BEST REPLY: for him there is no OBJECT over and above the  
IDEA, so the distinction the objector needs is precisely what is at

### ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 26/48: Berkeley: arguments 3 and 4 - parity and the Master Argument (continued)

=====

issue - the argument begs the question only if immaterialism is  
already false.

ANSWER-CRAFT: use the Master Argument FOURTH, never first. It is the  
weakest of the five and has a well-known reply.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 27/48: Berkeley: argument 5 - continuity, spirits, notions and the divine language

=====

ARGUMENT 5 - GOD AS GUARANTOR Principles Sec.6, 30-33, 48; Dialogues II

1 IDEAS ARE PASSIVE and inert; they cannot cause anything.

2 Yet the ideas of sense come to me INVOLUNTARILY and in a steady, regular order.

3 Whatever produces them must be an ACTIVE SPIRIT, and one whose power and wisdom EXCEED MINE.

4 THEREFORE GOD. The "laws of nature" are the SETTLED GRAMMAR of God's LANGUAGE of ideas - regularities are SIGNS, not causes.

5 THEREFORE objects PERSIST unperceived by finite minds because they are always perceived by the INFINITE MIND.

"Does the tree exist when no one perceives it?" YES - God perceives.

PRESUPPOSITION: only spirits are active causes (Berkeley's VOLUNTARISM).

OBJECTION: this makes "existence unperceived" back into a HYPOTHESIS ABOUT AN UNOBSERVED BEING - the very move Berkeley forbade Locke.

|

v

THE FINAL ONTOLOGY - TWO CATEGORIES, NOTHING ELSE

SPIRITS (ACTIVE substances that perceive and will)

GOD - infinite; produces the ideas of sense; sustains continuity

FINITE SPIRITS - my own known by inner awareness; OTHERS by ANALOGY from purposive signs and behaviour

IDEAS (PASSIVE)

OF SENSE - involuntary, vivid, coherent, LAW-GOVERNED

OF IMAGINATION - comparatively voluntary, faint, irregular

|

v

HOW SPIRIT IS KNOWN: BY NOTION, NOT BY IDEA Sec.27, 89, 140

REASON: an idea, being PASSIVE, could never PICTURE an ACTIVITY.

Notions also cover RELATIONS, which are likewise not pictured.

CRITICS: the asymmetry is AD HOC - an exemption introduced to protect the favoured posit.

BERKELEY: the asymmetry is FORCED, not chosen; the objection assumes that all knowledge is idea-shaped, which is what he denies once ACTIVITY enters the ontology.

HUME'S TEST: he refuses the exemption and dissolves SPIRITUAL substance too - which is exactly how much weight it was carrying.

|

v

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 28/48: Berkeley: argument 5 - continuity, spirits, notions and the divine language (continued)

```
=====
BERKELEY KEEPS THE SELF. HUME DOES NOT. That single contrast organises
every comparison of the two on the syllabus limb "Self and God".
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 29/48: Berkeley: common sense, illusion, science, other minds and anti-scepticism

```
=====
THE REVERSAL THAT MUST BE STATED OR THE POSITION IS MISDESCRIBED
 Berkeley insists he is NOT denying tables and chairs; he denies only
 the PHILOSOPHER'S FICTION of matter. The ordinary person never
 believed in Locke's veil of perception - they believe they perceive
 things DIRECTLY, AND SO DOES BERKELEY.
 He accuses the MATERIALISTS of undermining common sense by positing
 an unknowable world behind appearances, and of thereby manufacturing
 the sceptical problem they then fail to solve.
 HONEST LIMIT: the defence is strong about OBJECTS and weaker about
 CAUSES. The plain man also believes that fire heats water, whereas
 for Berkeley fire is a SIGN and God is the AGENT.
 |
 v
THE FOUR STANDARD OBJECTIONS AND HIS ANSWERS
+-----+-----+
Reality vs imagination?	ideas of SENSE are involuntary, vivid,
	coherent and law-governed; ideas of
	IMAGINATION are voluntary, faint,
	irregular
+-----+-----+	
Illusion - the bent oar,	the presented idea GENUINELY EXISTS;
the distant tower?	error lies in the JUDGMENT about what
	further ideas will follow
+-----+-----+	
Does this destroy science?	NO. Natural laws describe stable
	sequences in God's language of ideas
	and support prediction. What is denied
	is MATERIAL EFFICIENT POWER, not
	empirical regularity
+-----+-----+	
Solipsism - other minds?	other finite spirits are INFERRED BY
	ANALOGY from purposive signs; God
	explains the comprehensive involuntary
	order
+-----+-----+
```

RESIDUAL: crude solipsism is blocked, but knowledge of other spirits and of God is LESS IMMEDIATE than awareness of one's own activity.

|  
v

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 30/48: Berkeley: common sense, illusion, science, other minds and anti-scepticism (continued)

=====

BERKELEY IS AN ANTI-SCEPTIC

He claims to REFUTE scepticism: it is the MATERIALIST who produces doubt by positing an unknowable world behind ideas. Identify reality with ideas immediately perceived and certainty returns; God guarantees continuity. His position is DOGMATIC THEISTIC IDEALISM - a thesis about what EXISTS, not a doubt about knowledge.

NEVER WRITE: "Berkeley denies the external world" or "Berkeley is a sceptic". Both are examiner-flagged misreadings.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 31/48: The two routed comparisons - Berkeley against Moore, Russell and Hegel

=====

COMPARISON A - 2018 Q3(a): MOORE AND RUSSELL AGAINST BERKELEY

| AXIS                    | MOORE                                                                                                                                        | RUSSELL                                                                                          |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Core attack             | the idealist CONFLATES the ACT of awareness with its OBJECT: awareness of blue is NOT identical with blue                                    | idealism mistakes the data of sense for the whole of the object                                  |
| Positive result         | DIRECT REALISM - the object is presented THROUGH but not CONSTITUTED BY consciousness (the transparency argument)                            | LOGICAL CONSTRUCTION - objects are inferred or built from sense-data, perspectives and relations |
| Method                  | analysis of common-sense certainties                                                                                                         | analysis into STRUCTURE                                                                          |
| Shared ground           | both REFUSE to reduce object to act or idea                                                                                                  |                                                                                                  |
| THE DIFFERENCE          | MOORE DEFENDS the ordinary object and calls it directly known; RUSSELL REPLACES it with a construction and keeps only STRUCTURAL objectivity |                                                                                                  |
| the examiner is testing | -> Moore restores COMMON SENSE, Russell restores SCIENCE                                                                                     |                                                                                                  |

ANSWER-CRAFT: the 2018 question has THREE limbs - establish, react,

and DIFFER. Scripts that report both reactions and never contrast them forfeit a third of the marks.

|

COMPARISON B - 2024 Q2(a): BERKELEY AGAINST HEGEL

|                     |                             |                       |  |
|---------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|--|
| +-----+-----+-----+ |                             |                       |  |
| AXIS                | BERKELEY - SUBJECTIVE       | HEGEL - ABSOLUTE      |  |
| +-----+-----+-----+ |                             |                       |  |
| Basic reality       | finite spirits, God, ideas  | self-developing       |  |
|                     |                             | Absolute Spirit       |  |
| Why objects         | sensible existence CONSISTS | objectivity is a      |  |
| are mind-           | in being perceived          | MOMENT within         |  |
| dependent           |                             | dialectical self-     |  |
|                     |                             | development           |  |
| Role of the         | an infinite PERCEIVER who   | the Absolute is NOT   |  |
| divine/system       | causes and coordinates      | an external perceiver |  |

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 32/48: The two routed comparisons - Berkeley against Moore, Russell and Hegel (continued)

|                     |                                                  |                      |  |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------|--|
| =====               |                                                  |                      |  |
|                     | ideas                                            | preserving private   |  |
|                     |                                                  | idea-collections     |  |
| Method              | anti-abstraction plus                            | dialectical develop- |  |
|                     | immaterialist argument                           | ment through         |  |
|                     |                                                  | DETERMINATE NEGATION |  |
| VERDICT             | both reject independently self-subsisting matter |                      |  |
|                     | as final reality, but theistic SUBJECTIVE        |                      |  |
|                     | idealism is NOT an early version of OBJECTIVE /  |                      |  |
|                     | ABSOLUTE idealism. They differ in KIND, not in   |                      |  |
|                     | degree. "Berkeley the early Hegel" is a CATEGORY |                      |  |
|                     | ERROR the 2024 paper is designed to detect.      |                      |  |
| +-----+-----+-----+ |                                                  |                      |  |

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 33/48: Hume: impressions and ideas, the copy principle, the missing shade, association

=====

ALL CONTENTS OF THE MIND = PERCEPTIONS

|                                    |                               |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| IMPRESSIONS (FORCE AND VIVACITY)   | IDEAS (FAINT COPIES)          |
| of SENSATION: colours, sounds,     | MEMORY: retains order and     |
| tastes, pains                      | vivacity                      |
| of REFLECTION: passions, emotions, | IMAGINATION: free to separate |
| the felt determination of the mind | and recombine                 |

CRITERION: force and vivacity - a difference of DEGREE. Hume accepts that in fever or madness the difference can blur; this is a working psychology, not a definition by essence.

|  
v

#### THE COPY PRINCIPLE

every SIMPLE idea derives from a corresponding SIMPLE impression.  
COMPLEX ideas may be new combinations (a golden mountain).  
If no source impression can be located, the alleged idea is SUSPECT,  
OBSCURE OR FICTITIOUS - not automatically "meaningless" in the later  
logical-positivist sense. That stronger reading belongs to Topic 07.

|  
v

#### THE CONCEDED EXCEPTION - THE MISSING SHADE OF BLUE

Treatise I.i.1; Enquiry II

A man acquainted with every shade of blue but one, shown the spectrum  
with a gap, CAN form the idea of the missing shade from imagination  
alone - a simple idea with no antecedent impression. Hume calls the  
instance "SO SINGULAR" that it is not worth altering his maxim for it.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR MARKS: it shows the copy principle is an EMPIRICAL  
GENERALISATION, not an analytic truth - so the demolitions of  
substance, self and necessary connexion rest on a premise its own  
author admits admits an exception. Deploying it converts a  
DESCRIPTIVE answer into a CRITICAL one.

HUME'S AVAILABLE REPLY: the shade is generated by INTERPOLATION  
BETWEEN impressions actually had, so the principle's SPIRIT  
survives even if its LETTER does not.

|  
v

#### THE THREE PRINCIPLES OF ASSOCIATION - the mind's gentle force

RESEMBLANCE | CONTIGUITY in time or place | CAUSE AND EFFECT

These are PSYCHOLOGICAL mechanisms, NOT logical relations - and they  
are decisive later: resemblance and causation together produce the

### ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 34/48: Hume: impressions and ideas, the copy principle, the missing shade, association (continued)

=====

FICTION OF A UNIFIED SELF, and repeated conjunction produces the felt  
determination Hume identifies as the source of the idea of NECESSARY  
CONNEXION. Naming association early makes the later results look  
inevitable rather than surprising.

### ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 35/48: Hume: the fork, the dissolution of substance and the belief in body

=====

HUME'S FORK

+-----+-----+

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                               |  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|--|
| RELATIONS OF IDEAS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MATTERS OF FACT               |  |
| known A PRIORI, by thought                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | known A POSTERIORI, require   |  |
| alone                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | experience                    |  |
| NECESSARY and certain; denial                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | CONTINGENT; the contrary is   |  |
| is SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | ALWAYS CONCEIVABLE            |  |
| "2+2=4"; "a bachelor is                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | "the sun will rise tomorrow"; |  |
| unmarried"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | "fire causes heat"            |  |
| do NOT depend on what exists                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | DEPEND on how the world       |  |
| in the world                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | actually is                   |  |
| +-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                               |  |
| CONSEQUENCE: anything that is NEITHER is meaningless - "COMMIT IT THEN TO THE FLAMES" (Enquiry XII), aimed at "divinity or school metaphysics".                                                                                                                                                                |                               |  |
| ANCESTRY: the direct ancestor of the logical positivists' verification principle - worth ONE CLAUSE, not a paragraph.                                                                                                                                                                                          |                               |  |
| 2018 Q1(a) IN ONE LINE: "2+2=4" is a relation of ideas whose denial is contradictory; "the Sun will rise tomorrow" is a matter of fact whose denial remains perfectly CONCEIVABLE. NOT the same necessity, and NOT merely a difference of probability.                                                         |                               |  |
| REFLEXIVE OBJECTION: is the FORK itself a relation of ideas or a matter of fact? If neither, it burns itself. HUME'S AVAILABLE ANSWER: it is a clarification of the MEANINGS OF TERMS - a meta-level classification, not a first-order claim.                                                                  |                               |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                               |  |
| v                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                               |  |
| FIRST CASUALTY - SUBSTANCE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                               |  |
| Do we have an IMPRESSION of substance? NO. We have impressions of particular qualities - redness, hardness, sweetness - never of an underlying substrate. THEREFORE "substance" is a FICTION OF THE IMAGINATION: the mind's habit of grouping constantly conjoined qualities and INVENTING a support for them. |                               |  |
| SCOPE: MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance alike. THIS IS WHERE HUME PASSES BERKELEY, who retained spirit.                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                               |  |
| RESULT: an OBJECT is a stable BUNDLE; the SELF is a flowing bundle.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                               |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                               |  |
| v                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                               |  |
| THE BELIEF IN BODY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Treatise I.iv.2               |  |

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 36/48: Hume: the fork, the dissolution of substance and the belief in body (continued)

|                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| =====                                                                                                                                               |
| Sense presents only INTERRUPTED perceptions; it does not present an object existing CONTINUOUSLY while unperceived or DISTINCTLY beyond perception. |
| CONSTANCY of similar perceptions + COHERENCE in their reappearance                                                                                  |

-> the IMAGINATION FEIGNS continued objects and smooths the gaps.  
The philosophers' DOUBLE-EXISTENCE theory - private perceptions representing independent objects - CANNOT BE VERIFIED, because all comparison remains WITHIN perceptions.  
CRUCIAL QUALIFICATION: Hume does NOT demonstrate that no external world exists. Sceptical reflection undermines the RATIONAL JUSTIFICATION; NATURE restores the unavoidable belief in bodies.  
THE PATTERN OF HUMEAN NATURALISM: explain why a belief is psychologically inevitable AFTER showing that reason cannot establish its metaphysical object.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 37/48: Hume: the bundle self, the Appendix retraction and Kant's reply

```
=====
THE ARGUMENT Treatise I.iv.6
1 Apply the COPY PRINCIPLE to the self: from which impression is the
 idea of a self copied? It would have to be CONSTANT AND INVARIABLE
 through the whole course of a life.
2 INTROSPECTION delivers only particular perceptions - heat, cold,
 light, shade, love, hatred, pain, pleasure - in PERPETUAL FLUX.
3 NO constant impression is found.
4 THEREFORE the self is "NOTHING BUT A BUNDLE OR COLLECTION OF
 DIFFERENT PERCEPTIONS, WHICH SUCCEED EACH OTHER WITH AN INCONCEIVABLE
 RAPIDITY, AND ARE IN A PERPETUAL FLUX AND MOVEMENT."
WHAT IS DENIED: a SIMPLE, IDENTICAL SELF-SUBSTANCE.
WHAT IS NOT DENIED: the perceptions, which are REAL.
 |
 v
WHY THE ILLUSION OF UNITY?
 RESEMBLANCE - present ideas resemble past memories, creating a felt
 continuity
 CAUSATION - one perception seems to produce the next; memory links
 them into a chain
-> the IMAGINATION passes SMOOTHLY along the series and MISTAKES AN
 EASY TRANSITION FOR AN IDENTICAL OBJECT: the FICTION of identity
 |
 v
THE APPENDIX RETRACTION - THE PAGE THAT EARNS MARKS
Hume cannot explain what BINDS the bundle: "ALL MY HOPES VANISH WHEN
I COME TO EXPLAIN THE PRINCIPLES THAT UNITE OUR SUCCESSIVE
PERCEPTIONS."
DIAGNOSIS: he has denied BOTH a substance AND any real connexion
 between distinct existences, so he has removed in advance every
 resource a principle of unity could have used.
THEREFORE the honest verdict: THE FAILURE INDICTS THE ATOMISM OF
```

IMPRESSIONS, NOT THE SELF.

TEXTUAL NOTE: the Enquiry SILENTLY DROPS personal identity.

|

v

KANT'S REPLY - THE 2020 SECOND LIMB, STATED EXACTLY

- 1 Kant ACCEPTS that no impression or inner intuition reveals a simple soul-substance. He is NOT restoring a Cartesian ego.
- 2 He argues that the "I THINK" MUST BE ABLE TO ACCOMPANY ALL MY

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 38/48: Hume: the bundle self, the Appendix retraction and Kant's reply (continued)

```
=====
 REPRESENTATIONS if they are to belong to ONE experience at all.
3 The TRANSCENDENTAL UNITY OF APPERCEPTION is therefore a FORMAL
 CONDITION of synthesising a manifold under rules - NOT another
 perceived item inside the bundle.
4 LIMIT: this answers the missing unity at the level of POSSIBLE
 EXPERIENCE; it does not prove an immortal soul or settle every
 practical question of identity through time.
5 HUMEAN REJOINER: Kant has stated a condition of DESCRIPTION rather
 than discovered an ENTITY. Kant ACCEPTS the non-entity point and
 insists that rule-governed unity is PRESUPPOSED by judgment.
CROSS-TRADITION BRIDGE - ONE CLAUSE ONLY: the bundle strikingly
 resembles the Buddhist doctrine of no-self (nairatmyavada). It is a
 PARALLEL, not an influence, and the syllabus owner is Indian Philosophy.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 39/48: Hume on God, and the three fronts on which the proofs fail

```
=====
FRONT 1 - THE CAUSAL / COSMOLOGICAL ARGUMENT
 We have NO IMPRESSION of a "first cause" or of causation as NECESSARY
 CONNEXION. We therefore cannot legitimately infer from experienced
 effects to an UNEXPERIENCED TRANSCENDENT CAUSE.
 CONSEQUENCE: the argument LOCKE used is cut off AT ITS PREMISE - the
 cleanest single link between Locke's God and Hume's scepticism.
 |
FRONT 2 - THE DESIGN / TELEOLOGICAL ARGUMENT
 Dialogues concerning Natural Religion
 FOUR SEPARATE OBJECTIONS - give all four, not "weak analogy" alone:
 1 THE ANALOGY IS WEAK: universe : designer :: watch : watchmaker.
 The universe is not sufficiently similar to a MANUFACTURED ARTIFACT.
 2 EVEN IF GRANTED it proves at most a FINITE ARCHITECT working on
 GIVEN MATTER - not an omnipotent, omniscient, morally perfect
 creator.
 3 ORDER MIGHT ARISE from natural principles - matter's inherent
```

organising tendencies - WITHOUT invoking intelligence.

4 THE PROBLEM OF EVIL undermines any inference from the world to a PERFECTLY GOOD designer.

|

FRONT 3 - MIRACLES

Enquiry X

A miracle violates the laws of nature. Testimony in favour of a miracle is ALWAYS LESS PROBABLE than the testimony being false. THEREFORE it is never rational to believe miracle-reports on TESTIMONY ALONE.

OWNERSHIP NOTE: the miracle argument is SECONDARY ENRICHMENT here; Hume's critique of the PROOFS is CORE, because "God" is printed in the syllabus clause.

|

v

CROSS-PAPER LINK: the design-argument critique is also the required content for Paper II questions on proofs for God's existence. Same argument, different paper - do not duplicate ownership.

|

v

THE GOD AXIS ACROSS THE THREE EMPIRICISTS - THE WITHDRAWAL TEST

LOCKE      God is a SUPPORT: a demonstrated conclusion plus a guarantee of our faculties. WITHDRAW HIM and the epistemology survives; the demonstration and the defence

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 40/48: Hume on God, and the three fronts on which the proofs fail (continued)

```
=====
of representative realism are lost.
BERKELEY God is a MECHANISM: the cause of involuntary ideas and the
 guarantor of continuity. WITHDRAW HIM and the system
 COLLAPSES - no cause of order, no continuity, no
 distinction between real and imaginary beyond felt
 vivacity.
HUME God is a CASUALTY: no proof survives. WITHDRAW HIM and
 NOTHING IS LOST, because nothing rested on him.
DEEPEST CRITICISM OF IMMATERIALISM: God performs EXACTLY the two
functions Locke assigned to MATTER - causing our ideas and sustaining
the unperceived. Berkeley's economy is a SUBSTITUTION of posits
rather than an ELIMINATION of them.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 41/48: Hume on causation - the negative argument and the two definitions

```
=====
(A) THE NEGATIVE ARGUMENT ON NECESSARY CONNEXION
```

Treatise I.iii.14; Enquiry VII

- 1 COPY PRINCIPLE: every simple idea derives from a simple impression.
- 2 So if we have a genuine idea of NECESSARY CONNEXION, locate its SOURCE IMPRESSION.
- 3 EXTERNAL SEARCH: in any SINGLE instance of causation - one billiard ball striking another - sense delivers only PRIORITY, CONTIGUITY and the SUCCESSION of qualities. No impression of a POWER or TIE.
- 4 REPETITION ADDS NO NEW QUALITY TO THE OBJECTS: the hundredth collision is qualitatively no different from the first.
- 5 INTERNAL SEARCH: volition does no better. I have NO IMPRESSION of HOW the will moves the limb; the actual mechanism - nerve, muscle - is unknown to consciousness. This rules out the CARTESIAN and the OCCASIONALIST appeal alike. (SCRIPTS OMIT THIS STEP; IT IS WHAT MAKES THE CONCLUSION GENERAL RATHER THAN ANECDOTAL.)
- 6 But repetition DOES produce a change in THE MIND: after constant conjunction the mind is DETERMINED to pass from the idea of A to the idea of B. That felt determination is an IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION.
- 7 THEREFORE the idea of necessary connexion is COPIED FROM THAT INTERNAL IMPRESSION. Necessity "IS SOMETHING THAT EXISTS IN THE MIND, NOT IN OBJECTS."
- 8 THEREFORE TWO DEFINITIONS OF CAUSE FOLLOW:

|                                |                                |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| +-----+-----+                  |                                |
| (i) OBJECTIVE / PHILOSOPHICAL  | (ii) SUBJECTIVE / NATURAL      |
| an object followed by another, | an object followed by another, |
| where ALL OBJECTS SIMILAR to   | whose appearance CONVEYS THE   |
| the first are followed by      | THOUGHT to the other           |
| objects similar to the second  |                                |
| regularity-based, EXTERNAL     | psychological, INTERNAL        |
| +-----+-----+                  |                                |

NAMING BOTH IS THE SINGLE HIGHEST-VALUE MOVE IN ANY HUME-ON-CAUSATION ANSWER. TENSION TO FLAG: the two pull apart and Hume NEVER RECONCILES them - the origin of the modern REGULARITY vs PROJECTIVIST debate.

MECHANISM: CUSTOM OR HABIT, "the great guide of human life" (Enq. V).

PRESUPPOSITIONS

- P1 the copy principle is exceptionless
- P2 single and repeated instances can be compared for ADDED content -  
i.e. causation must be visible in ONE instance if objective at all
- P3 impressions are ATOMIC and SEPARABLE, so no relation is given WITH

**ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 42/48: Hume on causation - the negative argument and the two definitions (continued)**

=====

its terms

P4 "necessity" must be either OBSERVED or PROJECTED - no third option  
such as an inferred theoretical posit

CANONICAL EXAMPLES: the two billiard balls (Enquiry IV, VII); bread nourishing the body (Enquiry IV) - the sensible qualities of bread give no clue to its NUTRITIVE POWER.

2019 Q4(b) IN TWO LINES: in the OBJECTS - NO necessity. In the MIND - YES, the impression of reflection. A flat "no" fails the directive.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 43/48: Hume: the induction dilemma, Kant's Second Analogy and mitigated scepticism

```
=====
(B) THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION AS A FORMAL DILEMMA Enquiry IV
1 All reasoning about matters of fact beyond present sense and memory
 rests on the relation of CAUSE AND EFFECT.
2 Causal inference rests on the UNIFORMITY PRINCIPLE (UP): the future
 will resemble the past; unobserved cases resemble observed ones.
3 UP can be established ONLY DEMONSTRATIVELY OR PROBABLY.
 <== THE VULNERABLE STEP: this is the FORK APPLIED REFLEXIVELY
4 NOT DEMONSTRATIVELY: "the course of nature may change" implies no
 contradiction - it is perfectly CONCEIVABLE.
5 NOT PROBABLY: every probable or experiential argument ALREADY
 PRESUPPOSES UP, so the argument would be CIRCULAR.
6 THEREFORE UP has NO RATIONAL FOUNDATION.
7 THEREFORE inductive inference is produced not by REASON but by
 CUSTOM OR HABIT.
 EVERY SERIOUS REPLY ATTACKS STEP 3:
 KANT supplies a THIRD category - the SYNTHETIC A PRIORI
 POPPER denies that science needs induction at all
 STRAWSON argues that demanding a justification of induction AS A
 WHOLE misapplies the very standards induction constitutes
EXECUTABLE VERDICT: the sceptical conclusion depends on the
EXHAUSTIVENESS of a dichotomy that IS the fork - so Hume's scepticism
about induction is the SHADOW CAST BY HIS CLASSIFICATION OF
PROPOSITIONS, and survives only as long as the fork does.
 |
 v
(C) KANT'S RESPONSE - THE ROUTED REPLY IN 2025 Q2(c)
- Kant AGREES that necessary connection is not copied from a sensory
 impression. HE ACCEPTS THE NEGATIVE RESULT.
- SECOND ANALOGY: the category of CAUSE is an A PRIORI RULE required
 to distinguish OBJECTIVE event-succession from the merely
 SUBJECTIVE succession of my perceptions. Without a rule, the
 difference between a SHIP DRIFTING DOWNSTREAM and MY EYE WANDERING
 OVER A HOUSE cannot be drawn.
- "Every event has a cause" is therefore SYNTHETIC A PRIORI FOR
 POSSIBLE EXPERIENCE: the understanding supplies necessary temporal
 ordering to phenomena.
```

- LIMIT: this rescues objective empirical causation WITHOUT claiming knowledge of causality among THINGS IN THEMSELVES.
- HUMEAN CHALLENGE: has Kant PROVED the category, or BUILT IT INTO

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 44/48: Hume: the induction dilemma, Kant's Second Analogy and mitigated scepticism (continued)

=====

the definition of objective experience? KANT'S REPLY is  
TRANSCENDENTAL - without such rule-governed synthesis, experience  
of an EVENT would not be possible at all.

- ADJUDICATION: Kant is CORRECTLY AIMED, because Hume's result follows from the ATOMISM OF IMPRESSIONS, and it is the atomism, not the inference, that Kant attacks.

|  
v

(D) MITIGATED SCEPTICISM - THE POSITIVE DOCTRINE                      Enquiry XII  
EXCESSIVE / PYRRHONIAN: total suspension of judgment - UNLIVEABLE  
MITIGATED: limit enquiry to what experience can answer; avoid  
speculation beyond possible experience (substance, God, the soul);  
PROPORTION BELIEF TO EVIDENCE; rely on the natural beliefs custom  
compels  
STANDING OBJECTION: Hume USES induction while denying its rational  
basis. REPLY: nature forces belief; philosophy reveals its  
groundlessness; both can be true without practical contradiction.  
RESIDUAL: stable ONLY IF natural beliefs are exempt from the demand  
for justification - which concedes that not all belief needs reason.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 45/48: The eight-axis comparison grid and the criticism-reply-residual ledger

| AXIS      | LOCKE                                                  | BERKELEY                                                | HUME                                                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MATTER    | real but<br>unknowable<br>substrate                    | does not exist -<br>an empty word                       | no impression -><br>fiction                                                 |
| QUALITIES | primary<br>(objective) vs<br>secondary<br>(subjective) | ALL mind-<br>dependent; the<br>distinction<br>COLLAPSES | all are impres-<br>sions; no basis<br>for an objective/<br>subjective split |
| SUBSTANCE | "something I<br>know not what"                         | spirit only - no<br>material substance                  | none at all -<br>material OR<br>spiritual                                   |
| SELF      | continuity of<br>consciousness                         | ACTIVE SPIRIT,<br>known by NOTION                       | BUNDLE of<br>perceptions                                                    |

|                                                   |                                                                                                                                |                  |                      |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------------|
| CAUSATION                                         | real power,                                                                                                                    | God's will       | constant conjunc-    |
|                                                   | knowledge of                                                                                                                   | producing ideas  | tion + habit; no     |
|                                                   | mechanism limited                                                                                                              | in us            | real power           |
| GOD                                               | DEMONSTRATED by                                                                                                                | REQUIRED to      | all proofs fail;     |
|                                                   | a cosmological-                                                                                                                | sustain unper-   | scepticism           |
|                                                   | style argument                                                                                                                 | ceived ideas     |                      |
| SCEPTICISM                                        | REJECTED                                                                                                                       | claims to REFUTE | EMBRACED, but        |
|                                                   | (moderate                                                                                                                      | scepticism       | MITIGATED            |
|                                                   | realism)                                                                                                                       |                  |                      |
| OVERALL                                           | representative                                                                                                                 | subjective       | phenomenalism +      |
|                                                   | realism                                                                                                                        | (theistic)       | scepticism           |
|                                                   |                                                                                                                                | idealism         |                      |
| ===== CRITICISM   SOURCE   REPLY   RESIDUAL ===== |                                                                                                                                |                  |                      |
| AGAINST LOCKE                                     |                                                                                                                                |                  |                      |
| 1                                                 | The primary/secondary distinction is unstable.                                                                                 |                  | [Berkeley]           |
|                                                   | REPLY: extension can be THOUGHT abstractly through mathematical reasoning even if always IMAGINED with colour.                 |                  |                      |
|                                                   | RESIDUAL: the reply needs a NON-IMAGISTIC idea, straining Locke's own theory of ideas.                                         |                  |                      |
| 2                                                 | Representative realism generates scepticism.                                                                                   |                  | [Berkeley; sceptics] |
|                                                   | REPLY: God would not make us systematically deceived; inference to external causes is reliable enough for the conduct of life. |                  |                      |
|                                                   | RESIDUAL: an epistemological problem is converted into a THEOLOGICAL GUARANTEE.                                                |                  |                      |
| 3                                                 | Personal identity via memory is circular.                                                                                      |                  | [Butler, Reid]       |

**ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 46/48: The eight-axis comparison grid and the criticism-reply-residual ledger (continued)**

=====

REPLY: constitutive (consciousness) vs evidential (memory) criteria;  
overlapping chains repair transitivity.

RESIDUAL: "consciousness of it AS MINE" may re-import ownership.

AGAINST BERKELEY

4 Surely tables exist unperceived. [reported: Johnson's stone-kicking]  
REPLY: the table DOES exist unperceived BY YOU - God perceives it.  
RESIDUAL: continuity is bought with a THEOLOGICAL PREMISE.

5 Solipsism threat: what of other minds?  
REPLY: other spirits are known by ANALOGY; God guarantees the system.  
RESIDUAL: knowledge of other spirits is LESS IMMEDIATE than awareness  
of one's own activity.

6 Why invoke God? This is dogmatic, not empiricist. [Hume]  
REPLY: Berkeley accepts he is a THEIST USING EMPIRICIST METHODS.  
RESIDUAL: God does exactly the work LOCKE'S MATTER did.

7 How does subjective idealism differ from Hegel's absolute idealism?  
[the 2024 examiner]

REPLY: Berkeley - ideas in finite and divine minds; Hegel - the self-development of Absolute Spirit.

RESIDUAL: they differ in KIND, not in degree.

AGAINST HUME

8 Without real causal power, science becomes inexplicable.

[Kant; scientists]

REPLY: science works by INDUCTIVE HABIT; its success is a PSYCHOLOGICAL FACT, not a philosophical justification.

RESIDUAL: an account of SUCCESS is not an account of WARRANT.

9 What holds the bundle together? [critics; HUME HIMSELF]

REPLY: none is offered - "all my hopes vanish" (Appendix).

RESIDUAL: the failure indicts the ATOMISM, not the self.

10 Is the FORK itself a relation of ideas or a matter of fact?

REPLY: a clarification of the MEANINGS OF TERMS - meta-level.

RESIDUAL: the status of the meta-level remains CONTESTED.

11 Mitigated scepticism is inconsistent - Hume USES induction.

REPLY: nature forces belief; philosophy reveals its groundlessness.

RESIDUAL: stable only if natural beliefs are EXEMPT from the demand for justification.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 47/48: PYQ routes, directive decoder, answer spines, provenance, traps and conclusion

=====

THE TWELVE ROUTED PYQs AND THEIR ANSWER ROUTES (2018-2025)

|      |       |    |                                                                                                                                                  |
|------|-------|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2018 | Q1(a) | 10 | the fork; conceivability test; NOT the same necessity                                                                                            |
| 2018 | Q3(a) | 20 | five arguments for immaterialism, then Moore's act-object realism vs Russell's logical construction, THEN the explicit contrast (the third limb) |
| 2019 | Q4(b) | 15 | not in objects, YES in the mind - the impression of reflection; both definitions of cause                                                        |
| 2020 | Q2(a) | 20 | bundle self, fiction of unity, the Appendix; THEN Kant's transcendental unity of apperception                                                    |
| 2021 | Q1(c) | 10 | "IMMEDIATELY perceived": the semantic argument; removal of the veil; esse est percipi at Sec.3                                                   |
| 2021 | Q1(d) | 10 | person/man/substance; consciousness and appropriation; Butler-Reid; the Brave Officer; graded verdict                                            |
| 2021 | Q1(e) | 10 | constant conjunction is NECESSARY but NOT SUFFICIENT; the felt determination completes the analysis                                              |
| 2022 | Q4(c) | 15 | three grounds; white paper; sensation and reflection; the three degrees of knowledge                                                             |
| 2023 | Q2(a) | 20 | full causal analysis; association and custom; three objections; a delivered ruling                                                               |
| 2024 | Q2(a) | 20 | parity AND likeness, abstraction as the deeper ground; Berkeley vs Hegel on matched axes                                                         |
| 2025 | Q2(c) | 15 | Hume complete FIRST, then the Second Analogy, then                                                                                               |

adjudication

2025 Q4(c) 15 Locke's abstraction; Berkeley's refutation; the Sec.12 replacement; the metaphysical payload

CORPUS SIGNAL: 12 primary-owned parts of 112; at least one in EVERY year 2018-2025.

DIRECTIVE DECODER - ONE LINE EACH

EXPLAIN / ELUCIDATE = give the DERIVATION, not a synonym for the conclusion

EXAMINE = state AND test; rule on the objection's force

CRITICALLY ANALYSE = exposition PLUS a delivered verdict

DISCUSS = roughly 60:40 exposition to assessment

"IS THERE ANY ELEMENT ...?" = a YES-AND-NO WITH A DISTINCTION

"IS A INSTRUMENTAL IN B?" = a CAUSAL-EXPLANATORY ruling

COMMENT ON THE STATEMENT = locate the sentence in its own text first

ANSWER SPINES

10-mark: thesis line -> doctrine in three moves -> one objection -> graded verdict

## ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 48/48: PYQ routes, directive decoder, answer spines, provenance, traps and conclusion (continued)

```
=====
15-mark: frame -> Body A (the empiricist argument, complete) ->
 Body B (the routed reply) -> assessment -> close
20-mark: frame -> full analysis -> positive account -> three
 objections -> ruling that names the load-bearing premise
PROVENANCE RULES THAT PROTECT MARKS
"tabula rasa" is a LATER LABEL; Locke writes "white paper, void of
 all characters" (II.i.2)
"esse est percipi" is Berkeley's own Latin (Sec.3); "aut percipere"
 is a COMMENTATORS' EXPANSION
Essay II.xxvii was ADDED IN 1694; the Essay appeared in 1689 with
 1690 on the title page
Treatise != Enquiry: the Enquiry DROPS personal identity; published
 1748 as Philosophical Essays, RENAMED 1758
"Reason is the slave of the passions" is Treatise II.iii.3 - ETHICS,
 not epistemology
Samuel Johnson's stone is RECEPTION, not argument
TRAP SHEET - TEN LINES
1 "Berkeley denies the external world" -> he denies MATTER AS AN
 UNPERCEIVING SUBSTRATUM
2 "Hume denies causation" -> he denies OBJECTIVE NECESSARY CONNEXION
3 "Secondary qualities are illusions" -> they are POWERS
4 "Locke denies substance" -> he denies KNOWLEDGE OF ITS NATURE
5 "tabula rasa" quoted as Locke's words -> it is the tradition's
6 "Hume says the self does not exist" -> no SIMPLE IDENTICAL
```

SUBSTANCE; the perceptions are real

7 "Kant proves the soul" -> he supplies a FORMAL CONDITION

8 Berkeley called a sceptic -> he is an ANTI-SCEPTIC

9 Berkeley called an early Hegel -> different in KIND

10 Quine's "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" imported here -> Topic 11

#### QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

Empiricism consistently applied ends in a scepticism nobody can live.

That outcome DIAGNOSES the founding rule as INCOMPLETE rather than refuting philosophy - which is exactly the conclusion Kant draws when he keeps Hume's negative results and attacks the ATOMISM OF IMPRESSIONS that produced them. The slide from Locke to Hume is therefore RIGOUR, not decadence, and the next syllabus item begins where this one ends.